

CONSUL

PREMIUM PROFILE



16Personalities

What's in This Profile?

This profile is designed to cover all the main aspects of Consuls' personality as it affects different areas of their life, including Consuls' key strengths and weaknesses, relationships, academic path, career and professional development, as well as their communication and social skills, parenting tips and advice, and much, much more. It combines personality type theory with practical, real-world advice from others who share the Consul personality type.

Personality types have been the topic of many discussions, some of them dating back to ancient times. It's wise to draw from this source of knowledge and experience, especially when unsure of how to handle a specific situation. This kind of knowledge offers the power to control and understand oneself. As Aristotle said millennia ago, "The hardest victory is the victory over self." Consider this profile a plan for success.

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Who is “The Consul?”



This book explores how Consuls’ traits influence their personalities – and their lives. As we’ll explain, these traits produce a unique set of tendencies and behaviors that affect their personal growth, relationships, and academic and professional development. The following paragraphs provide a brief overview of the Consul personality type, laying the groundwork for topics discussed more extensively in later chapters.

Personal Growth

For a Consul, the bedrock of a worthwhile existence is a robust and stable social life, from friends to family, to a stranger at the grocery store who happens to have picked out one of their favorite items. Like other members of the Sentinel type group, Consuls feel a strong need to belong – whether to a family, community, or some other social group. Devoted and caring, they will do everything in their power to fulfill their duties and deliver on their promises.

Consuls’ innate practicality is tempered by a deep desire to be of service to others. Given their inner sense of responsibility, many people with this personality type feel

called to advise, mentor, or assist others. Social mores and conventions matter to them, informing the standards they set for themselves and others. As a result, Consuls often grow into “model citizens,” serving as pillars of their communities. Thanks to the combination of the Observant and Judging traits, Consuls live in a concrete world of clear distinctions. They have a firm sense of right and wrong, true and false, and they often use specific, well-defined values to guide their decisions.

Given their firm convictions and fundamentally social approach to life, these types are at risk of imposing their values on others. When they encounter someone who fails to meet their standards, Consuls may take this behavior personally. They're willing to make personal sacrifices to meet their obligations and help others, and it hurts them when the people in their lives won't do the same.

Relationships

As Extraverts, Consuls love connecting with other people. Their social lives often revolve around group gatherings, and they're equally at home at a bustling party or a mellow cookout. Group dynamics energize Consuls, and so a one-on-one cup of coffee with an old friend may hold less appeal for them than a big reunion.

Consuls find it easy to meet people anywhere, but they feel especially drawn to connect with others through traditional, respected institutions, such as civic organizations or faith communities. In their free time, they find themselves nurturing these connections and participating in related events, from fundraisers to board meetings. Consuls hate to let people down, and whether they've made plans with a few friends or committed to a meeting, others can count on them not to flake at the last moment. In return, they firmly expect the people in their lives to be consistent and reliable.

That said, Consuls take care not to let their social responsibilities compromise their family life. Many of them consider family among their top priorities, so it isn't surprising that this personality type is the most likely to want children. They may even view parenthood as the most important endeavor of their lives, not to mention a meaningful way to carry on the time-honored traditions that they received from their parents.

Many Consuls gain a sense of security and personal significance from the presence of their nearest and dearest. This quality can contribute to their relationships, enabling people with this personality type to feel deeply connected with the people they love. When Consuls become dependent on other people for reassurance, however, this trait can quickly turn into a weakness. They may become hypersensitive to others' behavior, feeling wounded whenever a friend or family member seems to pull away, ignore them, or disregard their advice. These types can become trapped in this unbalanced dynamic, deriving their self-worth from their relationships rather than from within.

Fortunately, Consuls bring many strengths to their relationships, including an incredible sense of warmth. Devoted and attentive, they care deeply about their friends and family, and do everything in their power to ensure their vision of a pleasant and stable life for the people they love.

Academic and Professional Development

In work or school, Consuls do their best to exceed expectations. As in other areas of their lives, they feel moved to assist and help others – whether their colleagues, their classmates, or the public. Through all stages of their academic and professional

development, they enjoy it when others acknowledge them for their efforts, and they thrive on feeling seen and appreciated.

Unlike Intuitive types, Consuls don't live in a land of abstractions and theories. Instead, they stay attuned to the present moment, especially regarding the people around them. Whether in the workplace or the classroom, Consuls enjoy working in teams, and they're sensitive to the dynamics of working as part of a group. As students, they're eager to please their teachers and uplift their classmates whenever possible. As colleagues, they feel compelled to step in and help whenever they sense that the people they work with are uneasy or overwhelmed.

Rather than experimenting or improvising, Consuls feel most comfortable if they can follow an established, clear-cut path to success. For example, they might choose extracurricular activities that will maximize their chances of getting into a good university, select majors that seem “employable,” and pursue internships to help them land their first jobs. Traditional definitions of success are meaningful for people with this personality type, and during their school years, they may strive to achieve academic honors, participate in team sports, and attend prominent, well-respected schools.

Consuls respect rules and guidelines, and their loyalty and sense of duty make them reliable, productive employees and students. They can be trusted to pay attention to detail and stick to protocol, even when it would be easier to do otherwise. Because they feel compelled to meet deadlines and deliver on assignments, they may need to protect themselves from people who try to foist extra work or obligations on them.

Not surprisingly, people with this personality type gravitate toward fields where they can have a positive influence on others' lives, such as medicine, education, social

work, or counseling. Beyond these classic “helping” positions, Consuls do well in a range of outward facing roles – from customer service and retail to publicity and public relations. Thanks to their detail-oriented natures, Consuls shine in administrative or clerical roles, and given their warmth and sensitivity to group dynamics, they can also excel in human resources or recruitment.

These types feel compelled to give to others and exceed expectations in all aspects of their lives, from their family life to their careers and schooling. This can lead them to sacrifice their own self-care, or even abandon subjects or careers that interest them to please others. As a result, they often find themselves heavily invested in other people’s behavior. If this happens, Consuls might find themselves disproportionately hurt by perceived slights, or they may become overbearing in their desire to guide and assist the people around them.

Even so, Consuls’ dedication often makes them irreplaceable. They rarely – if ever – drop the ball when it comes to their commitments, and their social awareness can help reunite teams or groups that are on the verge of falling apart. As long as Consuls learn to manage their expectations of others, they can grow into the cornerstones of their schools and workplaces.

On That Note...

In this section, we’ve explored what makes people with the Consul personality type distinctive. That said, a brief introduction can’t do justice to the full scope of Consuls’ strengths and gifts, let alone how they can counterbalance their weaknesses. In the following chapters, we will discuss these areas in detail, providing deeper insights as well suggestions and resources for improvement. Understanding one’s personality type is incredibly valuable, and we hope that the following information proves useful.

Theory Overview

Five Personality Aspects

Introverted (I) vs. Extraverted (E)

People have long noted that some among them are more outgoing and comfortable interacting with their surroundings, and others are more at ease remaining in quiet solitude with their thoughts. You can see the two types in almost any home, office, or classroom. In our first scale, we focus on the difference between Introversion and Extraversion, which we call the Energy scale.

The Energy scale describes how we see and approach the outside world, including people, objects, and activities within it. There are significant links between this scale and things like willingness to volunteer, boredom, thrill seeking, motivation, and romantic assertiveness, to name just a few. The links may not prove one causes the other. However, it does hint at a relationship.

Introverted People: Attuned Inwards

More Internal: Introverts ground themselves more easily in solitude and derive energy from their own thoughts.

More Selective: Introverts are careful when choosing the people with whom they spend time and prefer a quieter environment when they have a choice.

Slow to Offer Opinions: Within reason, Introverts like a little time to process their thoughts and ideas and are slow to offer opinions, fearing they may be too rash.

Extraverted People: Outwardly Engaged

More Outgoing: Extraverts tend to be outgoing both socially and in their willingness to interact with new and interesting environments.

Energetic: Extraverts have an energy that is almost replenished by its expression. They are energized by being energetic and putting themselves in stimulating situations.

Quick with Opinions: Extraverts are generally more comfortable with a flurry of opinions that typically are a part of casual conversations. It's almost like brainstorming ideas on the spot while saving the editing for later.

Intuitive (N) vs. Observant (S)

The second scale in our model is called Mind and addresses Intuitive and Observant styles. Each trait determines what kind of information we focus on and how it is used. It's the foundation on which all the other approaches are built.

All personality types include either those who favor the Intuitive style or those who prefer the Observant style. But before we start, it's important to say that this has nothing to do with how they take in information. The word "Observant" might suggest it does. But Intuitive and Observant types use their five senses in the same way. Rather than how they absorb information, these qualities show how each of these traits manages it once it's received.

Intuitive People: Living in the World of Ideas

Focus on Ideas: Intuitive people are fascinated by the world of ideas and love to discover the connections between various concepts and realities.

Are Deeply Curious: Within the realm of ideas, Intuitive individuals have a strong curiosity that leads them to somewhat adventurous discoveries.

Highly Imaginative: Those who prefer this trait typically stretch concepts to include possibilities beyond the obvious. “What if this not only means... but what if it could also mean...”

Observant People: Feet On the Ground

A Practical Focus: Observant people are more in touch with the concrete world and work within it. They favor consistent actions and measurable results.

Facts Over Theory: These individuals leave theorizing and brainstorming to others, preferring to effectively apply established facts.

More in the Moment: While Observant individuals have a respect for the past and the future, they see them through the lens of what they can do now. The task at hand is always the most important.

Thinking (T) vs. Feeling (F)

The Thinking and Feeling traits determine how we decide matters and cope with emotions. While we all have feelings, there are significant differences in how we react to them and what role those feelings play in our lives. This then influences several other areas, mostly related to our interactions with other people. This is what our third trait, Nature, focuses on.

Thinking People: Where Reason Rules

Rational and Objective: Thinking individuals are most comfortable dealing with things that come from rational thought and involve proven principles.

Logic Over Feelings: While these types often feel quite deeply, they typically place their rationality and logic above any emotional responses.

Constantly Assessing: Thinking people constantly scan ideas and actions to decide whether they make sense or not. They can be valuable in any process that requires any level of critical thinking.

Feeling People: Those Who Follow Their Feelings

Lead from the Heart: Feeling types listen to their feelings, care about how others feel, and are unafraid of sharing this perspective.

Focus on Morals and Ethics: People and their welfare are usually prioritized above any other consideration with the individuals who exhibit the Feeling trait.

A Different Kind of Rationality: While the Feeling type's way of choosing a direction may not always be totally objective, that doesn't mean that they lack rationality. There is practical wisdom in including feelings and consideration for the well-being of oneself and others in the decisions one makes.

Judging (J) vs. Prospecting (P)

The Tactics scale – Judging and Prospecting – is about how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, "Do you

prefer spontaneity or certainty?" "Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?" "Do you need more choices or fewer?"

At its core, this scale determines our attitude toward certainty and structure in our lives, both at mental and physical levels.

Judging People: A Steady Hand

Predictability Rules: Judging types are most at home when there is a clear-cut, well-considered plan that provides sure steps and promotes certain outcomes.

Work Hard: Judging individuals tend to work hard, perhaps seeing strong effort as a way of ensuring predictability.

By the Book: Individuals with this trait usually like to do things by the book and respect reasonable protocols, established techniques, and duties. They sometimes see doing things any other way as "reinventing the wheel."

Prospecting People: Possibilities in the Moment

Relaxed Spontaneity: Prospecting types tend to deal with life and all its opportunities as it comes at them.

Creative: This trait can promote "coloring outside the lines." This can lead to discovering new creative solutions.

Serial Passions: Prospecting individuals may find themselves passing quickly through many interests in their lives. Because of these experiences, they can possess a broad array of knowledge and ideas.

Assertive (-A) vs. Turbulent (-T)

Assertive and Turbulent – the Identity scale – measures how confident one is and how that confidence influences all other traits. The degree that people move more boldly or more timidly affects the way they make choices. It determines how they express their skills. Whether one is too confident to accept criticism or puts too much weight on the criticism of others because they lack self-confidence can make a major difference. The caution or lack of caution people apply to the things they do can color everything.

Assertive People: A Confident Approach

Confident Style: People with the Assertive identity are self-confident and resist stress.

Often Success-Oriented: Because these individuals don't spend hours fretting, it might be assumed they aren't interested in results. For many of them, nothing could be further from the truth.

Responsive and Proactive: Assertive people may jump into a task quickly, not being as burdened with the need to think endlessly about what may go wrong.

Turbulent People: Always Improving

Useful Worry: Turbulent people often worry and engage in self-doubt. While that might sound negative, the flipside of the coin is that it fuels much of their drive and productivity.

Driven to Succeed and Improve: Turbulent individuals are constantly seeking to do better and be better. This pushes them to put great effort into life.

Problem Spotters: Because of their cautious nature and tendency to worry, those with the Turbulent trait often spot problems early and are able to contain them quickly.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

In our system, we group personality types in two different ways:

- **Roles** determine our goals, interests, and preferred activities.
- **Strategies** reflect our preferred ways of doing things and achieving our goals.

You can think of Roles and Strategies as two ways of organizing personality types into categories. These two categorization methods each highlight different facets of the types. For examples, Roles can show us why certain types share similar interests, and Strategies can explain why certain types approach socializing the way they do.

We discuss Strategies in depth at the end of this e-book, in *The Puzzle of Personality*. With that in mind, let's explore the importance of Roles.

Roles

There are four Roles, each of which groups together four personality types.

- The **Analyst Role** includes Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP).

- The **Diplomat Role** includes Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP).
- The **Sentinel Role** includes Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ).
- The **Explorer Role** includes Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP).

So, why do we organize the types in this way? To put it simply, Roles help us to recognize important common ground between personality types.

The types within each Role all share the same Mind trait – either Intuitive or Observant. As you might remember, this trait is incredibly important because it determines how we view the world. As a result, the types within a given Role are alike in a very important respect: they share similar ways of understanding the world and their place within it.

In addition to the Mind trait, the types within a given Role also share the same Nature trait (Thinking or Feeling) or the same Tactics trait (Judging or Prospecting).

Does this seem like information overload? If so, don't worry. To help you get a better grasp of the Roles, let's go through them one by one and find out what makes them tick.

Analysts: Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects, Logicians, Commanders, and Debaters – are known for their irreverent curiosity. Thanks to the Intuitive trait, these types are rarely satisfied with the status quo. Instead, they'll go deep in their search

for ways to make things better, more efficient, and more effective. Meanwhile, the Thinking trait means that they value rationality over emotionality.

Analysts' greatest strengths include:

Driven to learn. Analysts want to know how the world works. In their quest for knowledge, they push the boundaries of their understanding. The result? Their expertise in certain areas can be remarkable.

Questioning natures. Analysts rarely accept things at face value. Ever questioning, they look beyond superficial appearances. This enables them to come up with deep, unexpected insights.

Intellectual energy. Full of fresh, counterintuitive ideas, Analysts know how to spark a lively debate. Conversations with these candid, sharp-witted types can be a breath of fresh air.

Born to improve. Analysts are relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all their rationality, imagination, and ambition to make it right.

Analysts' forceful imaginations, when trained and focused, enable them to achieve incredible results. But, like anyone, these types can have their Achilles heels, such as:

Lost in thought. Thinking up great ideas gives Analysts a rush. As a result, they're at risk of staying in the realm of thought, never acting out their ideas.

Ever the critic. In the same vein, some Analysts are more comfortable thinking about and critiquing other people's work than jumping into the fray themselves. In time, these types may be frustrated to find themselves outpaced by people with real-world experience.

Hunting for flaws. If taken too far, Analysts desire for improvement can have them hunting down the flaws in everything. As a result, they may undervalue the people and opportunities they encounter.

Emoti-what? Analysts feel more comfortable in the realm of thought than the messy world of emotions. But like anyone, they need to develop emotional literacy in order to deepen their relationships and fully understand themselves.

Fortunately, Analysts have enough creativity and ambition to move beyond these stumbling blocks. When they take action, look for the positive, and train their curiosity on the realm of emotions, these types can grow into their full potential.

Diplomats: Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Diplomats – Advocates, Mediators, Protagonists, and Campaigners – tend to be warm, caring, and generous. Bringing together the Intuitive and Feeling traits, they shine in their understanding of emotions – both their own and other people’s. This ability helps them shine when it comes to diplomacy, counseling others, and communication in general.

Diplomats’ gifts and talents include:

Emotional literacy. Even when it’s far from obvious, Diplomats can often perceive how others are feeling. From the outside, this might look like mind-reading. But in truth, it’s a combination of self-reflection and radical compassion that helps Diplomats understand others’ emotional states.

Only connect. Diplomats don’t use their people skills to manipulate others. Instead, they aim to nurture genuine connections with the people they encounter. Moreover, many Diplomats feel called to serve others however they can.

Do no harm. Deep down, Diplomats want what's best for everyone. For them, causing someone else distress would feel like a wound to their own psyche. As a result, these types aim to promote cooperation and harmony rather than conflict.

Creators at work. Profoundly creative, Diplomats are always on the hunt for inspiration. Whether or not they take up artistic pursuits, these types tend to enjoy self-exploration and self-expression.

Diplomats have high ideals. For them, kindness and altruism burn as brightly as a fire on a chilly winter's night. But if left unchecked, this idealism can have its downsides, including:

Impractical magic. Tempering passion with cold practicality is a challenge for Diplomats. These types are often reluctant to make tough decisions – especially if those decisions require them to compromise on their ideals or hurt someone's feelings.

Beautiful ideas. Diplomats have the best of intentions, and they have countless ideas about ways to help people. They're at risk, however, of staying stuck in the realm of ideas instead of taking action and sticking to a plan.

Taking on too much. In their efforts to make a difference, Diplomats may overcommit themselves – emotionally, physically, or even financially. If they don't deliver everything they'd hoped, they may feel overwhelmed or disappointed in themselves.

Easily hurt. Sensitive to criticism and rejection, these types may react strongly if other people question the value of their ideals. Disagreement and conflict can leave Diplomats feeling discouraged and hurt.

In all their actions, Diplomats crave a sense of meaning and purpose. Specifically, they feel called to cultivate positive change and gentle beauty in the world around them. Motivated by intangible rewards felt in the heart and soul, these types have a conviction to serve the greater good.

Sentinels: Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Sentinels – Logisticians, Defenders, Executives, and Consuls – are cooperative and practical. This grounded approach helps them feel comfortable with themselves just as they are. Steadfast and hardworking, these types pride themselves on their character and competence.

Here are some of the ways that Sentinels contribute to their homes, workplaces, social circles, and beyond:

Loving duty. These types feel a deep responsibility for those they care about. Specifically, Sentinels feel duty-bound to keep their loved ones safe and to help them lead good lives.

Always on time. Sure, Sentinels might occasionally fall behind schedule. But most of the time, they pride themselves on being unfailingly reliable. As a result, friends, loved ones, and coworkers can trust that Sentinels won't flake on their commitments.

Keepers of tradition. Sentinels work hard to maintain the ways things are done. In their home life, this means they love to continue family traditions. At the workplace, these types keep track of and defend best practices.

Unwavering diligence. Sentinels aren't afraid of hard work. On a daily basis, they practice their virtues of consistency and persistence, refusing to take shortcuts or

stop before their work is done. And in situations where someone needs to step up and take responsibility, Sentinels can be counted on to come through.

Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make it a priority to hold up their end of the bargain. But even these dependable types can have their challenges, including:

Resistance to change. For Sentinels, trying new ways of doing things can feel wrong – almost like breaking an unwritten set of rules. These types can be skeptical of change, and they may stick with suboptimal choices on the grounds of “that’s how it’s always been done.”

Stubbornness toward others. Similarly, Sentinels may feel personally affronted when other people upset the status quo. What someone else might describe as “experimenting with new ideas” may seem reckless or disrespectful to Sentinels. As a result, these types might dig in their heels, even if that means forestalling progress.

Imposing their values. Sentinels love to give advice and shepherd people toward better lives – at least, what Sentinels consider better lives. It may be hard for these types to accept that not everyone holds stability, tradition, and respectability among their core values. And when other people don’t follow their advice, Sentinels may want to judge them harshly.

Sentinels’ loyalty and steadfastness shine in many situations. When they balance their firm convictions with curiosity and openness, these types can become nothing short of inspirations to the people in their lives.

Explorers: Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

Explorers – Virtuosos, Adventurers, Entrepreneurs, and Entertainers – are self-reliant and quick-thinking. They're always ready to tackle a challenge or act on the spur of the moment. This spontaneity doesn't only help them solve problems – it also enables them to find opportunities for enjoyment in their everyday lives.

Here are a few of Explorers' notable strengths:

Surfing the waves. Many people struggle with change, but not Explorers. These types can adapt to new situations with minimal regret or second-guessing. In fact, they often enjoy change and appreciate breaks from routine.

Socially dynamic. Because of their openness, many Explorers enjoy meeting new people and trying out new social experiences. This helps them to build a network of diverse and interesting friends and acquaintances.

Getting things done. Explorers don't overthink things. Instead, they leap into action and get the job done. These types spend their energy on taking concrete steps, only pausing to consider abstract ideas or nitty-gritty details when it's absolutely necessary.

Picking up techniques. Utilitarian in their way, Explorers love to master new tools and techniques. Whatever their hobbies and passions, these types enjoy the challenge of building their skills and picking up new ways of doing things.

Explorers enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. Like most traits, this has its upsides and its downsides. Here are some tendencies that Explorers may need to counteract:

Losing interest. We all lose interest in our activities from time to time. But Explorers often run out of motivation as soon as a project no longer feels fun, novel, or exciting.

What planning? Explorers prefer to deal with challenges on the fly rather than plan ahead. Alas, sometimes an ounce of planning really is worth a pound of cure.

Risky business. Explorers are drawn to pleasure, risk, and – sometimes – risky pleasures. As they grow and mature, however, they often learn that some risks simply aren't worth taking.

Explorers connect with the world in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. It can be a challenge for them to work for things with a distant or unexciting payoff, but when they harness their passion and administer just enough self-discipline, they can move heaven and earth.

Now, let's talk about you.

Personal Growth



Consuls have an amazing talent for being both the life of the party and the mother hen. They are one of the most outgoing personality types, able to connect to others regardless of their individual circumstances. At the same time, they are always mindful of those around them and are likely to check on the well-being of those around them (paying close attention to perceived stragglers). Innately warm people, Consuls tend to be popular individuals, and this can be attributed to the three pillars that define their value system – cooperation, socialization, and community.

Everybody has gifts and strengths, and personal growth revolves around reinforcing the good and developing upon the bad. Just as an athlete may grow skills and muscles, Consuls may slowly build upon traits like resilience, perseverance, and open-mindedness to name a few.

However, just as Consuls have strengths, they also have their weaknesses. Personal development reduces the obstacles that lie on the path of fulfillment, or compensation for faults. Most of the time, finding balance reduces the problems caused by weaknesses. But sometimes, the greatest way to reduce the impact of a

weakness is by accepting them and, consequently, taking the power from them. If people understand weaknesses are there and blend them into their lives, they might discover a way to work around them in a more natural way. It's as author George R.R. Martin penned in his novel 'A Game of Thrones':

"Never forget what you are, for surely the world will not. Make it your strength. Then it can never be your weakness. Armor yourself in it, and it will never be used to hurt you."

Working Smarter Not Harder

Consuls have the tendency to take on a lot of work, much of it being the tasks of others. Their reliability and dependability are a couple of their defining traits, and they make sure that others know that they can be counted on. This isn't for recognition or glory, but because Consuls embrace helping others as part of their contribution towards the community. However, to give fully, one must also take from themselves. Consuls work until they're drained of energy and enthusiasm, and struggle to halt their duties even if they're miserable. Growth for them is often a matter of learning to balance their lives and how to restore vibrancy once they've lost it.

Most find balance and happiness in the everyday. On the other hand, Consuls do tend to overload their lives. They can become rigidly loyal and neglect getting the rest they need. "A little hard work never hurt anyone" is true, but too much can do damage. Some may forget that they have a right to take care of themselves while they're taking care of others. Balance and self-care often hold a crucial place in Consuls' personal development.

In the next sections, four areas of strength and related weaknesses will be explored with some suggestions for Consuls who want to achieve a more balance.

Self-Responsibility

Balanced Self-Responsibility

Thomas Edison said, “The three great essentials to achieve anything worthwhile are, first, hard work; second, stick-to-itiveness; third, common sense.” “Hard work, stick-to-itiveness, common sense” might serve as mantras for most Consuls. While not all are fully successful at fulfilling these goals, still, Consuls strive to realize these qualities.

Belief in Personal Choice

Whether at home or at work, Consuls cultivate the ability to organize and accomplish things in their life. They practice healthy habits to ensure optimal performance - training themselves to study material until they thoroughly understand it, for example. They are likely to view themselves at least partially responsible for any successes or failures throughout their lives and will work to praise or correct themselves.

Consuls have very strong loyalty to their community, and especially their family. They strive to achieve goalposts that their community has deemed as safe and successful, but even with that being said, Consuls, when balanced, understand that they have a choice to choose a different route if they'd like. Community opinion is important, yes, but they are ultimately the captain of their own ship.

Belief in Moderation

Consuls have the gift of tolerance. Of course, they will interject their opinion, if needed, but are slow to lose faith in a system (or person) that may be temporarily

failing them. They tend to push through situations even if it requires some personal sacrifice.

This high tolerance threshold also lends itself to how they work. The most mundane work is no problem for Consuls if they grasp its purpose or if it's paired with a strong sense obligation. Consuls would rather work overtime and lose sleep than turn in shoddy or incomplete work, and if they know that the work they're doing is helping others, this sense of duty intensifies.

However, just as they know work is important, they also understand the need for relaxation and self-care. If Consuls feel their ends fraying, they will take a moment to take themselves out of a stressful situation, to meditate upon it, and then make a decision that is in their best interest.

Unbalanced Self-Responsibility

Personal and professional growth occurs when Consuls use their sense of responsibility and dedication to move forward in life. However, as with all good things, diligence can shift from a powerful tool to a demanding tyrant if not properly balanced against other considerations.

Too Much Responsibility; Too Little Self-care

Consuls' self-esteem and confidence are built upon their successful execution of responsibilities. When they are not feeling great about themselves or their lives, their sense of responsibility may "overheat" in search of a positive sense of themselves. Instead of integrating self-care and rest into their lives, they may push relentlessly to feel that sense of responsible accomplishment.

Without taking time for themselves and finding some way to relax, Consuls are likely to experience burn-out. When someone is burnt out, they become exhausted and lose their zeal for things that may have once excited them. It makes them lose motivation. The exhausted Consul might find it hard to get out of bed in the morning or to carry out even the most routine activities.

When Burn Out Burns Others

When Consuls aren't feeling well, they tend to be vocal about it. It's bad enough to consider how burn-out may affect Consuls, but one should also consider how it will spill over to their relationships. While they think they are pleasing the boss, the boss may see a worn-out employee who may not be working as efficiently as they should despite their over-the-top efforts instead.

One should also consider how people who become burnt-out typically have short-fuses. Excessive stress has damaged many a home, and Consuls, when stressed, will take their aggressions out on those around them without realizing their own faults. In the end, Consuls may harm the very people they intend to look after by not dealing with stress.

The health implications of stress are well-known and can easily be researched on the Internet. There are long term consequences when stress is not managed. Consuls who don't deal with stress may find their capacity to take care of others becomes limited in the future.

Rebalancing Self-Responsibility

Assessment: Is the Stress Worth It?

Consuls who find themselves suffering from responsibility overload may need to take some strong measures to remedy any related problems. Might want to decide if their relentless efforts are paying off or not. Working exceedingly hard may indeed be the appropriate thing to do at times. But it can also exact a toll on an individual. Matching the cost to the benefit is essential. It can be counter-productive for Consuls to assume that strenuous work is the solution to all concerns.

Consuls will typically choose action over ruminating over things. The action doesn't necessarily have to be bold. It could be as simple as tying up a loose end or attending to minute details that need completing. This can be a wonderful asset for the productive person. However, learning to prioritize that which has proven to be important and balancing it with self-care can make vigorously exerting oneself a more reasonable approach. Asking "why?" a bit more can help set a clearer path - especially when the Consuls' need to feel responsible begins to overheat.

Stress Management for Those Who Roll Their Eyes at the Idea

When stressed, Consuls will do well to remember the following – spend more time with the people who bring out their best, rather than their stress. For Consuls, the best form of stress management is to be with those who have the talent to calm them down. Social engagement plays a huge role in destressing Consuls, and they can find a soothing presence in a friend, parent, or even counselor.

When Consuls do feel overwhelmed, having a space to drop emotional baggage can be most helpful. Spending some time writing out their concerns and their reactions

to life can be like talking to a friend. A useful alternative might be the Consul actually talking to a supportive friend or spouse. For some Consuls, it may take thinking about venting as something that is useful and not just a self-indulgence – although there is nothing wrong with indulging oneself.

To gain credibility with Consuls, it may be important to note that stress management is not called “stress elimination.” Stress, when balanced, has its place, and Consuls uniquely know where reasonable tension fits in their lives. Stress keeps Consuls alert and motivated. It is only problematic when stressors are the only game pieces on the board and no other choice is available. It is something to be managed but not necessarily sidestepped.

Often hard-working people like Consuls roll their eyes at the concept of stress-management courses, but stress-management is about becoming more productive in one’s own life. It should streamline actions and use of energy. Stress management involves finding some pie to balance diligence with some relaxation and even some pleasure. A thorough stress-management course not only teaches how to deal with stress in the moment. It can also help Consuls plan their days, weeks, months, even their entire lives, in a way that allows them to pace themselves better. (Interested Consuls can find stress management material online and human resources at many companies offer such training.)

Self-Determination

Balanced Self-Determination

The Feeling trait is foundational to the way Consuls decide matters. Their decisions usually support their primary role of nurturer. It fosters their sincere desire to see

those who are important to them being safe, happy, and prosperous in the world. They mold their lives around decisions from the heart. As is often the case with those who share the feeling trait, Consuls value harmony and this also influences their decisions.

Practical Organizing from the Heart

Like a three-legged stool, the Consuls' practical combination of Observant and Judging traits, along with the Feeling trait, help Consuls meet their harmonious goals. It's a complete package. Bringing real-time order and stability to the people they care about is the Consul version of nurturing. The welfare of the people in their lives provides their motivation and informs their choices. They will be there when they are needed.

Because of their Observant traits, Consuls connect with the physical world and this allows them to pick up the cues of those around them readily and to respond accordingly. Their attentive and responsive natures lead people to regard Consuls as nurturing individuals. They fall naturally into the role of parent, giving friend, understanding spouse, nurse, teacher, support staff or even a caring manager at work. They notice when there are signs of distress or discomfort and express their personality by deciding how to ease those problems. Consuls are imaginative problem-solvers when the problems are practical, and their solutions are characteristically useful.

Acceptance of Existing Things

Consuls, when Balanced, are one of the most tolerant types out there. While their first instinct is to fix something that's out of place, or to correct someone's hurtful behavior, they will instead consider the context of the situation. Considering personal

relationships, Consuls will always try to give the other person the benefit of doubt. They'll think things like *'Perhaps they're so busy at work they don't have any time to call'* or *'They're going through a hard time right now, and that's why they're acting up'*.

Consuls are hyper-aware of other's feelings, and they see doing what's traditional as the clearest path to happiness. These traits combined make for people who make their opinion known (whether or not others asked for it). However, balanced Consuls understand that sometimes the best course of action is to let someone be and allow them to live their life as they chose.

Unbalanced Self-Determination

Meddling

Consuls don't like conflict, but they will engage in it if they must. They try to fix someone's perceived incorrect behavior for that person's own good. This can be something minor like telling a person that being more cleanly will make them happier, to something major like convincing their friend to break up with a no-good spouse. In both situations, the Consul will state their opinion regardless of whether or not they were asked.

While this can sometimes be irritating to Consuls' friends and family, those who know the Consul know that they are stating this opinion out of a place of love and concern. However, Consuls, when unbalanced, can make the mistake of believing that their way is the *only* right path available. This rigid point of view can lose Consuls' loved one's very quickly, as love and concern can be easily misconstrued for judgement and harsh criticism.

Hurt Feelings: The Other Side of Sensitivity

The sensitivity that makes Consuls so aware of the needs of others, can also work against them if they are feeling the least bit insecure. They might become too sensitive to even the mildest slight. The subtlest dismissive gesture from a loved one may begin to feel like an overwhelming slam: “I work so hard to take care of them, and this is how they treat me?” Taken a step further, when someone blatantly criticizes the Consul, it may devastate these sensitive souls.

When they feel hurt, Consuls may resort to tactics like the cold-shoulder or severe passive aggressiveness. Consider a Consul who is angry at their friend. Rather than speaking to their friend, an unbalanced Consul may pretend that things are well and good, smiling even when they feel awful and hurt. They may say snide things or seek retribution in small, petty ways like not answering their friend’s texts. Though they ultimately hate conflict, they are prone to speak on everything but how awful they may be feeling at that moment, until it ultimately ends up eroding the relationship.

Rebalancing Self-Determination

Some Consuls may become so attached to the idea of harmony that they will do anything to preserve it – leading to conflict avoidance and difficult problems remaining unsolved. So, how do they become unstuck?

The Assertive Consul

Fortunately, there are ways to deal with conflict and problems that avoids any aggressive behaviors. Assertive behavior sits at the midpoint between passive behavior and aggressive behavior. Learning to be more assertive offers a method for

standing up for oneself while avoiding hostility, and it's something anyone can learn.
(Google: "Assertiveness training")

One of the assertiveness techniques that might prove helpful for Consuls is a reliance on "I feel..." statements. Coming at others using an accusatory "You..." statement puts them in a defensive position, leading many times to a fight. Consuls may not be comfortable with statements that feel aggressive. If they can instead use a statement which explains how things are affecting them, it will feel less like they are hostile to others. In addition, it's hard for someone to start a fight based on someone else's feelings. People are allowed their feelings, and it's difficult to tell them they shouldn't have them.

For example: Instead of "I work cleaning this house all day and then you come in and you just throw your stuff everywhere. And you just leave it there until I pick it up," they might try: "I feel like you don't care about the time I spent or the work I put into cleaning the house when you don't put your stuff away." The first sets up a fight, but most won't try to argue against a feeling as expressed in the second. The second allows the Consuls to talk about how this affects them and reflects their emotional states. Not only might such an approach be more palatable to the harmony-loving Consuls, it also allows them to bring difficult subjects to the surface more easily. This gives both parties a better chance of resolving any problems.

Self-Adjustment

Balanced Self-Adjustment

The Guardians of Continuity

Consuls are the watchers over a culture's traditions and accepted standards, and it speaks to their love of order and predictability and serves to foster stability. Protocols are reliable like the Consuls themselves. If everything were in a constant state of change, then life would become messy. Imagine arriving at work every day, never knowing if the job requirements and procedures had shifted overnight. Change is important and inevitable, and the mature Consul knows when to adapt. However, within that framework, some constants and points of references must be held in place to prevent chaos. Upholding these standards are an intrinsic part of the Consul's nature.

The Consul home is likely to be traditional with accepted values and norms practiced. At the workplace or at school, they will find themselves aligning with the procedures and expectations of the institution. Consuls will know rules and not only obey them, but if someone ignores the decrees, they will defend and enforce them. As Feeling Extraverts, it may not be in the caring Consuls' basic nature to take on a rule-breaker, but order may mean enough to them that they will. Stability is the Consuls' superpower, and they will probably protect it.

Without a doubt, like a love song from yesteryear or a meal that conjures pleasant memories, there is a sense of comfort in the familiar. Balanced Consuls exude a perpetual sense of "home." That sense of home might be literal or a metaphor for some form of reliability. Consuls protect "what always has been" and provide society

with a sense of healthy continuity. Because of people like Consuls, society is a lot more predictable and steady.

Unbalanced Self-Adjustment

The Challenge of Change

Certainly, Consuls are among those people would call “the salt of the Earth.” They are practical traditionalists. However, if not balanced, this can carry dangers. Being the salt of the Earth doesn’t mean they own the planet. Clinging to old ideas—even as things rapidly change—can produce a protective intolerance if the Consuls can’t balance established standards with change. It may be difficult for Consuls to view changing morals, evolving methods and disregard for traditional standards and not cast severe judgment in their direction. Some may perpetually pit the old against the new rather than adapt.

Change is difficult for everybody, but Consuls and other Sentinels are the hardest hit when drastic shifts occur. Some Consuls may reject change consistently, and in the 21st Century, they will undoubtedly be socially or professionally handicapped. What was once a Consul fostering traditional standards can become rigidity. What was a mastery of steadiness and stability can devolve into stubbornness.

Intolerance

Hate is not a natural part of the Consuls’ character by any measure. Any intolerance they experience towards others is likely to be the product of fear more than disdain. If they associate a person or a group of “others” with undermining the traditional standards they fight to uphold, they may regard them as enemies. This can, paradoxically, disturb the harmony they labor so hard to create.

Much of this happens because Consuls' have not ventured out outside the boundaries set by the community, and if they have, then they're very reluctant to let go of traditions of old. The fear that comes with change will propel them to try change the different into something more familiar.

Rebalancing Self-Adjustment

Tradition as a Guide

W. Somerset Maugham said, "Tradition is a guide and not a jailer." This might serve as a powerful insight for Consuls. Using it as a guide, Consuls don't diminish tradition, but they also don't enslave themselves to it either. To restore balance against excessive rigidity and intolerance, it may be crucial to put tradition in a more realistic perspective.

Accepting the inevitability of change can be a first step. Learning to blend the old into the new can help Consuls create a more balanced view. Spotting the difference between maintaining stability and being stubborn can also help the Consul navigate the changing world better. Self-talk and self-examination can be useful here. "Am I really offering helpful insights into how things work, or am I just finding change difficult to handle?" Asking this and similar questions may help.

Reconsidering the Change Agents

Intolerance is an attitude and there is little that combats it apart from changing one's attitude. It may help Consuls who face this problem to think in terms of efficiency rather than constancy. How many good people or innovative ideas are left behind because of intolerance? Instead of finding individuals threatening, what if instead the

word “interesting” was applied. Reframing is deciding to look at something from a different perspective.

Finally, making it a point to look for the good during change or a departure from that which Consuls already know can make change less dire and threatening. Searching for the silver lining and how it applies personally to the goals and interests of the Consul can make change easier for them. It may even surprise them how much the change works in their favor.

Self-Recognition

Balanced Self-Recognition

Duty Stills Needs a Reward

Consuls will never seek recognition. Doing so makes little sense to them because it's not part of their primary motivation. They see all they do as an expected duty. For them, that would be like others celebrating that they brushed their teeth when they rose in the morning. It's just what one does.

While Consuls may protest when others try to show appreciation for their diligence, it likely pleases them. When others appreciate them, Consuls feel stronger, and feel enthusiastic to continue helping others. They don't need a brass band. A simple “thank you and well-done” is enough for these social and hardworking people.

Finding Way to Celebrate Victories

While having the praise and approval of others is gratifying, the only guaranteed source is from oneself. Consuls may find they need to be or develop their own

cheering section. They might do this in a variety of ways depending on personal preferences. If they prefer introspection they might list their accomplishments or keep a journal, reviewing their challenges and victories daily. Often people set goals and then reward themselves in some small way as a celebration: Consuls might treat themselves to a local concert after they complete a report, for example.

If the Consuls needs a more social context, as even Introverts sometimes do, they may enlist others with whom they can share a mutual “brag” session. The Consuls' willing spouses, family members or friends may be natural partners to help celebrate victories and accomplishments. One can imagine it turning into a dinner-time ritual with their treasured families, whether natural or extended. “What was your day like?” is likely to assume more weight than just a conversational nicety around a Consul's table. Regardless of how they do it, balanced Consuls will discover some means of assuring they enjoy a sense of belonging. They will uncover methods for reinforcing their sense of value.

Unbalanced Self-Recognition

While the amount of recognition one gets might sound like a vanity concern, it can go deeper. Without some expression of appreciation, people can forget they belong or have a purpose. Motivation ideally comes from within, but humans are social animals, and they are the rare individuals who don't desire some recognition for their contributions. Unsung heroes may appear noble as they secretly crave someone noticing.

Consuls who don't receive recognition for their work may imagine others not caring about what they do, that someone is taking advantage of them or that they aren't a vital part of a group. And since Consuls don't typically like to confront others, they

may allow these thoughts to fester. None of these negative ideas foster a sense of belonging. They are likely to drain energy and enthusiasm.

Consuls may also try to cope ineffectively using one or both of two methods:

Artificially Proving Importance

The first is proving one's importance. This can take a wrong turn if it feels forced and care is not taken to soften it. Think of the stereotypical TV sitcom version of the bureaucrat behind the counter at the DMV who won't cut the customer a break under any circumstances nor will they even take the time to hear them out. The hidden message is, "See I'm important enough to belong here." On TV, they exaggerate situations for laughs. Milder, more realistic versions might seep into the everyday life of some Consuls if they aren't getting the recognition they deserve.

The Passive-Aggressive Approach

The second is passive-aggressive behavior. That's striking out at others by not doing something as an alternative to a direct assault. The person who typically makes a beautiful breakfast everyday suddenly presents undercooked eggs with blackened toast. The hidden message, "Now you'll pay attention when I do it well." (And the cook may not even do it consciously.)

People will usually find a way to feel valued – even if they have to do so in maladaptive ways. If it feels like the Consuls are forcing others to acknowledge their value, it will come across as demanding and abrasive. Finding a more organic means of accomplishing the same thing can create pleasant experiences and help cement respectful relationships and some methods will be explored below.

Rebalancing Self-Recognition

Self-promotion and the Basic Need for Recognition

A sense of belonging is a basic human need, and Consuls dislike self-promotion for the sheer sake of self-promotion. Aided by their Extraverted qualities, they can feel easily lonely if there aren't people around them. Some people are naturals at self-promotion and some people are not.

For some people, self-promotion might be thought of as a stress-management technique because it helps individuals relax more into their lives and feel more comfortable in their skins. Rather than experiencing stress at feeling left behind because flashier types seem to be hogging all the glory, Consuls and other grounded people may want to explore strategies for getting the attention they deserve. This can help them get ahead and feel like a vital part of any group to which they belong.

Self-promotion as a Relation with One's Self and With Others

At first, Consuls may want to promote themselves to... themselves. Taking inventory of one's own value can be the first step to gaining the confidence needed to shine publicly. Even if self-promotion goes no further, the Consuls can assure themselves of their belonging in a group,

Consuls can be insular and that alone can cause them to fade into the wallpaper. But they still value relationships. If they can think of self-promotion as part of a relationship, they might find it easier to tell others who they are and what they do. This perspective may feel less like they are "blowing their own horn" and more like they are sharing themselves openly with others.

The Elevator Pitch

And, lastly, there's the old reliable elevator speech: the 30 second speech that could be given during the span of typical elevator ride that sums up who the one giving the pitch is. It is a way to brand oneself and to get others to pay healthy attention. It doesn't have to be confined to professional use.

As an example, Bobby's Consul dad might present himself to Bobby's fifth grade teacher and other parents at the PTA meeting in the following fashion: "I'm Bobby's dad, chauffeur, knee-scrape doctor, and home study hall supervisor. While he depends on his mom to help him with everyday homework, I'm around for his larger projects. So, if the diorama doesn't cut it, you can blame Bobby, but my hand was involved in the crime as well." (Obviously, running around a room repeating this can sound odd, so variations on a theme are acceptable and perhaps preferred.)

This is a breezy yet defining description of what Bobby's dad does for him. It's even slightly self-effacing for those who are more comfortable being humble. Bobby's dad may have a work version of this or even a golf course version. It's like a commercial slogan that repeats the speakers' attributes and gives others a chance to know them and their role in the group. It can be very effective at bringing someone who is usually in the background more to the forefront.

Conclusion

Like a seedling poking its head through the soil in the early Spring, growth rarely happens without something emerging from the comforts of the familiar. As much as they love the familiar, Consuls love effectiveness more. Consuls who embrace balance and self-care will discover they are more effective. This alone should prove

motivating for Consuls seeking to be their best selves. They are not slouches. They are unlikely to let any of the discomforts or risks of growth deter them.

More importantly, Consuls are protectors and nurturers. Consuls who develop a satisfying quality of life are likely sharing that satisfaction with the people they love. Happy Consuls carry with them a bubble of happiness that influences and engulfs others. There are so many ways nurturing oneself contributes to nurturing others. Finding the proper mix of self-care to caring for others is likely the key to Consul growth.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your personal growth? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Locus of Control Test](#)

Dig deeper into who or what you feel is responsible for your life satisfaction, happiness, and level of fulfillment.

[Emotional Intelligence Test](#)

Find out how good you are at understanding your own emotions as well as paying attention to the emotions of others with this test.

[Confidence Test](#)

How much do you believe in your competence and ability to successfully follow through on the choices you make? Let's find out.

[Dark and Light Side Test](#)

Your moral choices may not be as simple as you think. This test asks you to go deep and take an honest look at your attitudes.

[Resilience and Grit Test](#)

Some people are hard to knock down; some find it easy to get back up; and some are both or neither. Which group do you belong to?

Coping Styles Test

There are four primary ways to cope with crisis. This test explores the dominant and secondary techniques you're likely to turn to.

Optimism and Pessimism Test

This simple test measures your levels of both optimism and pessimism in a novel way. Find out where you fall in each of these areas.

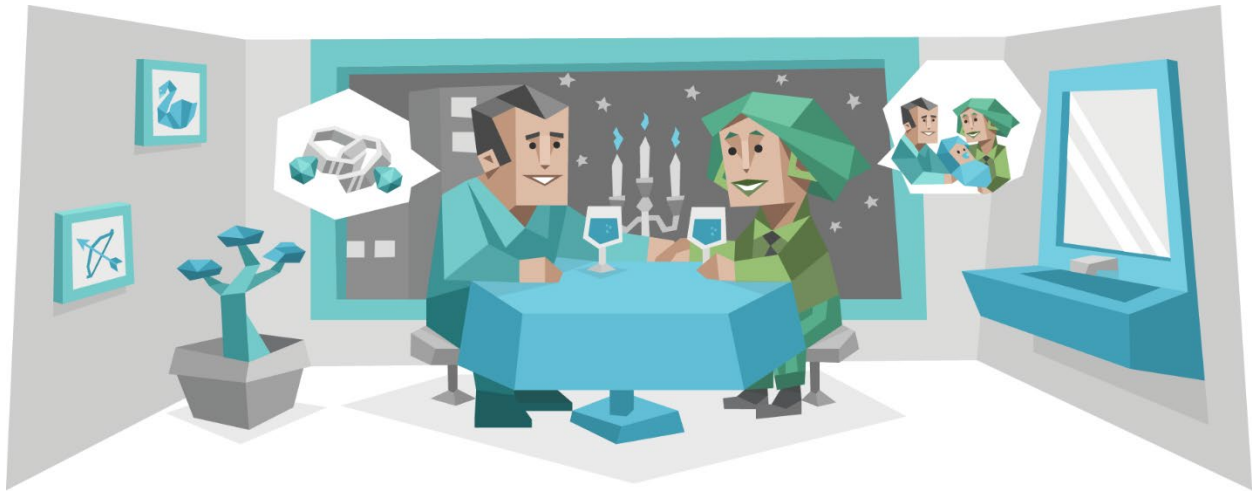
Imagination and Magic Beliefs Test

How does your imagination work? What is your belief about magic? Explore the role of imagination, magic, and belief in your life.

Traveling Preferences Test

This simple test delves into your preferred choices during those times when you leave home to explore the world.

Romantic Relationships



Devoted and attentive in their relationships, Consuls are willing to make sacrifices to support their partners. Although they might not ask for it directly, Consuls – in their heart of hearts – hope to find someone who will do the same for them. Above all, Consuls long for a partner who shares their values and makes them feel deeply appreciated.

Love brings Consuls a sense of stability, and they may feel more complete when they're in a partnership. Outgoing by nature, people with this personality type connect readily with others, and they may find it easy to meet potential matches and embark on new relationships. Family is a top priority for Consuls, and many are eager to find a life partner with whom to raise children.

It would be a mistake, however, to think of Consuls as needy or desperate. Balanced Consuls wait until they find someone who stands by them, honoring their feelings and opinions without necessarily pandering to them. In return, balanced Consuls offer their partners a loving, stable foundation for their lives together. This includes

a strong social foundation, as Consuls excel at establishing themselves and their partners within their communities.

Consuls care a great deal about their relationships, and they aim to notice the nuances of their partners' emotional state. Dedicated and steadfast, Consuls are willing to work hard to make a relationship flourish as long as they feel respected and valued.

That doesn't mean such relationships are invulnerable. They can still succumb to the forces that break couples apart, particularly if Consuls feel criticized or have the unrealistic expectation that their partner should fulfill all of their emotional needs. That said, Consuls can rarely – if ever – be accused of withholding their affections or not investing enough attention in their relationships.

Dating and the Single Consul

Sociable and outgoing, Consuls find it easy to branch out and meet new people. They understand the social conventions related to dating, and they stick to them. On the plus side, this means that Consuls rarely embarrass themselves when approaching a potential partner, and they don't waste undue time and effort pursuing someone who ignores or rejects them. Deep down, Consuls hope to find a partner who cherishes and validates them, and even before the relationship begins, they expect a potential partner to be enthusiastic about the match.

Consuls take all relationship stages seriously. Even if they have just started dating someone, they care about making a good impression and fostering a connection. Consuls enjoy identifying similarities between themselves and their new partners, from shared interests to similar upbringings. In a balanced Consul, this tendency can create common ground and make their partner feel at ease. An unbalanced Consul,

however, may make assumptions about their date that prove untrue. For example, they might assume that a well-dressed date is professionally successful and cares about financial security, even though this isn't necessarily the case.

Firm in their convictions, Consuls often have clear ideas about how dating should work. For example, they might hold strong opinions about who should pay, which types of outings are appropriate, what their date should wear, or even how quickly text messages should be returned. If their potential partner fails to conform to these ideals, Consuls might be tempted to move on. As part of their personal development, Consuls must learn to distinguish between expectations and core values. This discernment enables Consuls to accept that people who don't fulfill every last one of their expectations can still be a match on a more fundamental level.

Consuls in the Bedroom

Consuls are very much in touch with the physical world, and when combined with their emotional intelligence, this quality makes them great sexual partners. Affectionate and sensual, Consuls see intimacy as a fantastic way to make their partner happy. As in other areas of the relationship, Consuls do their best to anticipate and fulfill their partners' needs in the bedroom. For many Consuls, their pleasure is only amplified by their partners' pleasure.

That said, Consuls' traditional orientation can make them uncomfortable with sexual experimentation, particularly anything they perceive as taboo. Depending on their background, they may have narrow personal definitions of acceptable sexual behavior. If a Consul's partner suggests something outside of their comfort zone, Consuls may feel pressured or turned off.

Consuls are generally bold in communicating their preferences, but this trait may not extend to their sex lives, particularly if they were raised in a relatively straitlaced household. As a result, Consuls may not be comfortable expressing what feels good to them sexually, let alone what isn't working. In these cases, Consuls might feel hurt or even resentful that their partners can't read their minds.

Alas, it's never fair to expect another person to intuit our needs or desires. As many Consuls discover, this type of expectation only leads to disappointment and frustration. Learning to communicate honestly and unreservedly about their own sexual preferences is essential for this type, and a wise priority to address early in a sexual relationship.

Breakups: Taking the High Road

Consuls like steady and predictable advancement in life, and a breakup is an assault on those goals. When someone breaks up with them, Consuls feel deeply hurt or criticized. They may take the end of the relationship very personally, dwelling on the ways their former partner has let them down.

That said, Consuls are generally willing to initiate a breakup when their partner doesn't share their vision for advancement. Many Consuls have a specific idea of what a "successful" life looks like – from what kind of house they'd like to live in to where they'd send their children to school. If their partner disagrees, that may well be a deal-breaker.

Alas, Consuls sometimes pull the trigger on a breakup too soon. For unbalanced Consuls, relationship molehills can quickly grow into mountains, particularly if they rehash old arguments. Consuls generally feel as if they are in the right, and it may be difficult for them to recognize the ways in which they've contributed to relationship

conflicts – which, in turn, prevents them from recognizing the ways in which they could resuscitate the relationship.

After a breakup, Consuls are wise to seek the company of friends and family. This type is energized by social contact, and the company of their loved ones can remind them that a bad experience with one person doesn't diminish their ability to connect with someone else. Hugs, attention, and gestures of emotional support go a long way with Consuls, helping them to bounce back from the pain of a breakup.

That said, these interactions shouldn't devolve into ex-bashing. Consuls may need to resist the temptation to dwell on things their former partner did wrong or ways their partner hurt them. Although venting can be healthy, Consuls won't be able to progress and grow if they indulge in harangues or tell everyone about their exes' shortcomings. By moving on respectfully, Consuls can take the high road after even a contentious breakup, accepting what didn't work while honoring the lessons that they've learned.

Potential Personality Pairings

The Right Approach

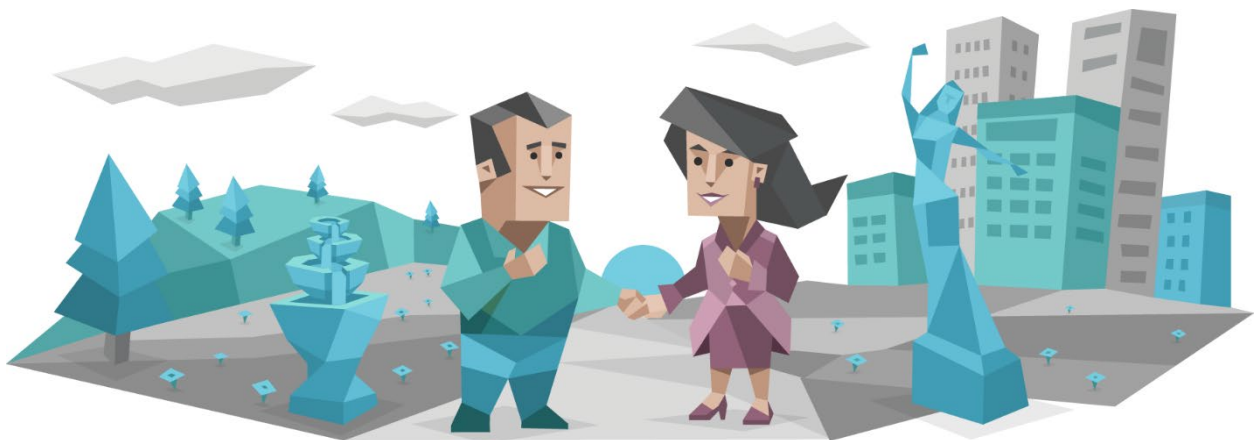
Balanced Consuls don't impose their opinions or their ways of doing things on their partner. Instead, they value the quirks and tendencies that make their partner unique. Although they strongly prefer a partner who shares their core values, balanced Consuls are self-assured enough to share their lives with someone who may not agree with them on every count. In other words, they expect respect and acceptance from their partners, not constant validation.

While romance is far from an exact science, balanced Consuls understand that putting their best foot forward achieves the best results. With so many personality variables in play, this often means proceeding into the unknown with an open mind, knowing that while they cannot control other people's behavior, maintaining a positive, accepting attitude brings out the best in others.

The information presented in this section will help Consuls build and navigate successful relationships. Knowledge of personality tendencies enables Consuls do what they do best: connect with others. This personality type is devoted and caring, but since true love is unlikely to be found in a perfect package, they must cultivate flexibility and openness in order to maintain a healthy relationship.

With that in mind, we offer a helpful look at some of the ways Consuls and other types are likely to interact, as well as insights to help Consuls maximize their chances for happiness by creating fulfilling, balanced relationships with those types.

Consul-Analyst Relationships



Balanced Consul-Analyst Relationships

A Romantic Mental Checklist

Consuls and Analysts both approach finding a partner with a mental checklist of what they want. Although Consuls may not do this consciously, they are drawn to people who feel familiar – ideally people who share similar traditions and experiences. The characteristics that Consuls desire in a partner have a great deal to do with societal expectations and potentially also traditional gender roles.

Fortunately, Analysts can satisfy a number of items on most Consuls' lists. Many Analysts are ambitious and decisive – two traits that Consuls deeply appreciate. Personal integrity is also important to many Analysts, and their forthright, honest natures appeal to Consuls, who want a partner they can trust and respect.

Of course, a checklist can't guarantee a successful relationship. At times, Consuls may need to relax their expectations for potential partners, prioritizing only those that truly matter. That said, by honestly communicating what they want, both Consuls and Analysts can establish a foundation that increases their potential to find a compatible partner and build mutually satisfying love.

Love and Efficiency

Consuls may initially be attracted to Analysts' penchant for solving life's puzzles – as long as it's not overdone. This trait helps to advance the relationship, as Consuls feel especially appreciated and loved whenever their Analyst partners do something to help them or make their lives easier. Provided that Analysts take the time to express their ideas in concrete terms, they can also satisfy Consuls' desires for clarity, certainty, and efficiency. In return, the fact that Consuls don't get lost in ideas

stabilizes ever-imaginative Analysts, something especially needed by those with the Prospecting trait.

As time progresses, a focus on efficiency and accomplishment can help Consuls and Analysts weather the storms of everyday life together. Consuls crave order and security, and so their actions tend to be grounded and practical, aimed at clear, steady advancement. When they fall into ruts, balanced Consuls appreciate their Analyst partners' innovative, unconventional approach to solving problems and wringing the greatest benefit out of life. As long as each partner taps into the other's strengths, Consuls and Analysts make a formidable pair.

The Long Haul

For distinct reasons, both Consuls and Analysts seek longevity in a relationship. Consuls want to make a "home" – in a real or a metaphorical sense – where they can ground their sense of identity and potentially start a family. Beyond this domestic drive, they also want reliable partners who assist them in reaching their goals, and balanced Analysts, ever logical, fulfill this need.

In turn, sensible, energetic Consuls can serve as a stabilizing force in Analysts' lives, ensuring that practical matters aren't neglected. Consuls can support Analysts in less obvious ways as well. Although they are rational to the bone, Analysts actually cherish a loving partner like a Consul. Many Analysts struggle to interpret others' emotions, and it may be a relief to find someone who so obviously cares about them.

The result? Even though they are driven by different motivations, Consuls' and Analysts' sense of loyalty are a solid match.

Unbalanced Consul-Analyst Relationships

Snowballing Disagreements

In the initial phases of a relationship, Consuls and Analysts often find themselves united in their drive for achievement and advancement. Over time, however, the harmony and predictability that Consuls crave may be disrupted by Analysts' desire to continually improve things. Balanced Analysts love to explore new ideas and possibilities, but they know when to embrace things as they are. Unbalanced Analysts, on the other hand, may pursue change after change, trying to improve every aspect of their lives through constant upheaval.

Consuls strive to build stable, predictable home lives, and they may be frustrated or confused when their partners seem to want something different. Even worse, Consuls may feel personally judged and criticized when Analysts cast about for new solutions and ways to improve things. Unless addressed, this sense of hurt can corrode the relationship from the inside.

In this situation, Consuls may find themselves digging in their heels and single-mindedly defending on the status quo. Their Analyst partners might, in turn, accuse them of being unimaginative. As a result, small conflicts can snowball into hurtful arguments that highlight fundamental differences in the relationship. This dynamic can ensue during any type of disagreement – whether over an ethical issue or where to eat dinner.

As an example, Consuls might insist on a traditional, formal style of home décor, whereas Analysts might favor something simpler. In this case, a relatively small issue – how to decorate the house – can escalate into a heated exchange, with Analysts accusing their Consul partners of a shallow or small-minded preoccupation with

appearances and Consuls feeling personally and unfairly attacked. Unless they cultivate mutual respect, couples in this situation may find themselves trapped in increasingly frequent patterns of conflict and disagreement.

Details vs. the Big Picture

Thanks to their Observant trait, Consuls are attentive to concrete details and practical matters, and they crave stability and predictability. They have a firm sense of how every aspect of their life should be ordered, from their schedules to their medicine cabinets, and they know what – and whom – they like or dislike. This type of existence brings Consuls comfort and meaning, helping them make sense of an otherwise messy, changeable world.

Alas, Analysts are hardly known for their attention to details or practicalities. In Consul–Analyst relationships, Consuls may be dismayed by Analysts’ inability or unwillingness to meet their standards of how things should be done. When a tidy home matters to Consuls, they will be frustrated every time their Analyst partners drop the mail on the floor or leave the cap off the toothpaste.

These tiny infractions can accrue significance over time, leading Consuls to feel that their partners don’t respect them, meet their expectations, or fit into their lives. When Consuls do communicate their preferences and wishes, their Analyst partners might dismiss these opinions as illogical, trivial, or pointless. “What difference does it make,” Analysts might ask, “if the dishes hang out in the sink for a while? Shouldn’t we be focused on more important issues, like particle physics or international relations?” For Consuls, however, the dishes may indeed be important.

When their partners don’t understand or honor their preferences, Consuls often find themselves harboring resentment or judgment. On a practical level, Consuls may feel

they do all the work, laboring to keep the day-to-day details in order while the Analysts go on about things that feel annoyingly irrelevant and unhelpful. Occasional spats over toothpaste caps may not matter much, but over time, these tensions can come to eclipse the love, affection, and trust that Consuls need to feel in order for their relationships to flourish.

Rebalancing Consul-Analyst Relationships

Respecting the Needs of the Moment and the Future

In unbalanced relationships, Consuls tire of their Analyst partners' grand, impractical ideas for the future, not to mention the constant exploring and experimenting that Analysts love to indulge in. These efforts, from Consuls' point of view, consume time, energy, and resources that could and *should* be directed toward more practical matters. Understandably, Consuls in this situation might feel tempted to roll their eyes at their partners or badger them to take care of present-moment demands.

For Consuls, a more constructive approach is to get curious about Analysts' grand ideas. The best way to do this: ask thought-provoking questions that help *both* partners better understand what's at stake and what the payoffs might be. For example, Consuls could ask their Analyst partners how long a given project would take, what resources it would require, what opportunity costs it would entail, and what benefits it would offer. This type of discussion makes both partners feel heard, and by asking thoughtful questions, Consuls can help ground even Analysts' most high-flying ideas.

Remembering Why They Fell in Love

The honeymoon phase of a romantic relationship may be sweet, but it isn't sustainable. Over time, even devoted couples can become increasingly annoyed by each other's habits and behaviors – whether minor quirks or major traits. Unbalanced couples can easily become overwhelmed by their differences, to the extent that they lose sight of what drew them together in the first place.

In this situation, it's helpful for Consuls to remember *why* they fell in love. Before giving up on their relationships, Consuls might want to sit down and write a list of all the qualities that once appealed to them about their partners. These should be qualities that the partners still embody – for example, their intelligence, their honesty, or their wit. Consuls who truly struggle to remember their partners' good qualities might try looking through old photos, recalling the details of their first dates, or even chatting with a few friends to see what they remember. (Ideally, these conversations should focus on a partner's positive traits, not their shortcomings.) After drawing up this list, Consuls might be moved by how many strengths and gifts their partner brings to the relationship. If they'd like, Consuls can share this list with their partners, but it is fine for them to keep this list as a private reminder of why they fell in love.

Choosing Battles and Letting Go

Consuls and Analysts both bring strong opinions and full-fledged worldviews to the table, which can be a beautiful thing. When their perspectives don't align, however, Consul-Analyst pairs may find themselves deadlocked. In unbalanced couples, both parties feel confident about the “rightness” of their approach, unwilling to cede any ground to each other or pursue true compromise.

As in other areas, Consuls can take the high ground in these standoffs, actively assessing how important a given point of contention truly is to them. To respond appropriately in these situations, Consuls can ask themselves the following questions: *On a scale of one to 10, how important is this issue to me? What is the worst that would happen if my partner got their way? In one year, will this matter to me?* By asking themselves these questions, Consuls can determine whether their resistance to their partners' point of view is motivated by their core values or by the desire to be right. When they realize a particular argument isn't all that important to them, Consuls can decide to focus their energies on other aspects of their lives and their relationships.

Consul-Diplomat Relationships



Balanced Consul-Diplomat Relationships

A Little Heaven and a Little Earth

When they first date, Consuls and Diplomats may feel like kindred spirits. Consuls are often moved by Diplomats' altruistic natures, which resonate with Consuls' own desire to care for others on a practical level. As the relationship matures, Consuls can

serve as a kind of kite string, helping the Diplomats ground and realize their high-flying, almost spiritual desire to help others. Meanwhile, Consuls can enjoy the view from the heavens that Diplomats offer.

Consuls help support their quixotic partners by leading the way in day-to-day activities, better integrating Diplomats in both the household and the community. In this relationship, both partners share a drive to create harmony and help others, and Consuls can turn Diplomats' idealism into something that can be acted upon, whether it's an entrepreneurial project or a great idea for a vacation together. Across all of their relationships, Consuls express their love and care by helping others to focus their lives. The intimacy of romance motivates Consuls to place all the more importance on providing that help to the person they love most.

A Caring Couple

Both Consuls and Diplomats have an interest in nurturing others. Consuls aim to create the type of stable environment where they believe their loved ones can flourish, and their Diplomat partners feel moved to support the mental and spiritual growth of others. The result can be an aligned, caring partnership that is fulfilling on many levels.

Even in the earliest stages of a relationship, these two can bring out the best in each other. Consuls may find that time spent with Diplomats motivates them to live out their ideals, whether that means throwing a surprise birthday party for a loved one or spearheading a major philanthropic initiative. As the relationship progresses, Consuls can cultivate a cooperative dynamic with their Diplomat partners, working together to create a sense of purpose, meaning, and even – to Consuls' delight – accomplishment.

More than the Sum of their Parts

When Consuls meet Diplomats, they might marvel at how easily the conversation flows. Consuls are engaging, talkative partners who enjoy sharing their experiences, likes, dislikes, and beliefs. But balanced Consuls also actively listen, allowing their Diplomat partners to express their deeper values, including their grand ideas about the intangible meaning of experiences and beliefs. This helps their Diplomat partners feel appreciated and understood – something they crave, and something Consuls love to provide. These relationships can deepen quickly through heartfelt respect and admiration.

As time progresses, balanced Consul–Diplomat relationships grow on a foundation of compatible values, not simple similarities, or even shared opinions. While Consuls and Diplomats arrive at their values differently, these are both values-driven types. Consuls derive their values from their communities or traditions, and Diplomats look to high concepts and philosophy to guide them. As long as each person respects and appreciates the other’s worldview, then this principled approach to life can help Consuls and Diplomats see that, as a couple, they are more than the sum of their parts. Together, they may feel called to nurture others in a way that radiates selflessness. In other words, they may feel that their partnership can benefit and be meaningful for not only themselves, but also the other people in their lives.

Unbalanced Consul-Diplomat Relationships

Practicality versus Utopia

It’s a beautiful thing when Consuls and Diplomats balance each other, but these partnerships don’t always unfold in balance. At first, Consuls may be intrigued by

Diplomats' utopian inclinations. Once the novelty wears off, however, Consuls may chafe at the impracticality of Diplomats' ideas and ideals.

Particularly if they get to the point of moving in together, Consuls may expect their Diplomat partners to settle down and become more practical. For present-minded Consuls, Diplomats' focus on the future can seem flighty, annoying, or even irresponsible. To Consuls' dismay, Diplomats might lose themselves in concerns about global warming or the expanding universe and forget to buy milk on the way home.

Observant and Intuitive individuals always differ in this way, and the discrepancy can show itself even in couples' everyday conversations. Diplomats often want to talk about an endless stream of *what ifs*, causing Consuls to lose their patience – particularly if they'd rather be talking about an urgent or actionable matter. In an unbalanced relationship, Consuls find themselves shouldering more than their share of practical responsibilities and chores, and their frustration at this state of affairs inevitably surfaces in their day-to-day interactions with their partners.

When Emotions Rule

Both Consuls and Diplomats tend to act based on emotions rather than logic. Yes, they are both capable of thinking coolly and rationally, but their feelings surge in first. In the early stages of a relationship, this similarity can create understanding between Consuls and Diplomats, but in unbalanced relationships, it can come to trigger significant tension.

Alas, sometimes couples need to be deal with hard facts. For Consul–Diplomat couples, emotions can all too often take precedence over reality. For example, if they fall in love with a house that's beyond their budget, they may need to abandon their

sentimental notions and move on. Otherwise, the relationship may become derailed by financial strain.

When both partners make decisions based on feelings, there is the potential for a constant state of drama. Sure, drama can be positive – such as enthusiasm and romance – but it can also be toxic, triggering resentment and deep hurt. It's true that Consuls' Judging trait compels order, but under the burden of excessive emotionality it will falter. In these circumstances, small arguments can balloon into major blowouts.

To complicate things further, Consuls rarely hold back their opinions, and Diplomats rarely contain their feelings. As a result, these two may find themselves butting heads in a big way, unleashing an almost overwhelming exchange of emotion. In these situations, unbalanced Consuls might seethe with disdain, leading their Diplomat partners to feel judged and dismissed.

Rebalancing Consul-Diplomat Relationships

Cultivating an Open Mind

Consuls know what they like – and what they dislike. This decisiveness is useful in many circumstances, but lasting love requires openness and compromise. In unbalanced partnerships, Consuls expect their Diplomat partners to agree with them and accede to their preferences, from what kind of car they should buy to which way the toilet paper should be loaded. To be fair, these details might matter more to Consuls than to Diplomats, but if Consuls expect their partners to validate and uphold all of their preferences, then the relationship will never feel truly equal or fulfilling.

In balanced relationships, Consuls listen to and acknowledge their partners' opinions and preferences. Before jumping in with their own ideas and expectations – even if it's just about where to eat dinner – Consuls can practice asking their partners the following questions: *What would you like to do? What about that course of action appeals to you? How strongly do you feel about this issue?* By listening before they share their own opinions, Consuls can foster balanced relationships that are founded on mutuality and compromise, not getting their own way.

Caution with Criticism

Criticism can seriously undermine Consul-Diplomat relationships. Due to their Feeling trait, each partner can suffer emotional wounds from even well-intended feedback, let alone harsh rebukes. It's normal for all partners to experience hurt feelings from time to time, even in loving relationships, and couples can recover from occasional lapses in kindness or judgment. That said, if criticism or contempt is expressed with regularity – especially between people as sensitive as Consuls and Diplomats – recovery may be difficult.

If criticism or feedback is necessary, it's important that it be conveyed with care and respect. In all cases, but especially for a Consul-Diplomat couple, the conversation should center on *specific* actions, instances, and feelings, not sweeping judgments or put-downs. In other words, *I felt angry when you...* is more constructive than *Why do you have to be so lazy?* By being specific rather than general, it is possible to highlight a bothersome behavior without condemning the person responsible for that behavior. This reduces the likelihood of defensiveness or resentment.

The formula for this type of communication is simple: *I feel [emotion] when you [act that triggers the feeling]*. For example, “I feel lonely when you stay at work past 8 pm,” or “I feel frustrated when you don’t take the trash out after you’ve promised.”

Ideally, these discussions should be balanced by expressions of praise and appreciation. The same formula can apply for these cases. For example, “I feel so happy when we take walks together,” or, “I feel confident and reassured when you say you believe in me.”

Deal with the Facts

Consuls and Diplomats are perfectly capable of critical thinking, but they may need to make special efforts to spot their “default” emotional inclinations. Otherwise, they are at risk of triggering conflict and stress due to over-romanticizing, over-dramatizing, or other excessive emotional responses. To minimize needless drama, these couples must learn to recognize when emotions are best brushed aside – at least temporarily.

That said, Consul-Diplomat couples will never dispense with emotional considerations altogether, nor should they. In the right circumstances, their feelings can lead them to make constructive, meaningful choices. For example, their emotional natures might inspire them to move to a city they love, spend more time in nature, or adopt a pet.

So how can Consuls honor their feelings without indulging in drama? First, they should identify the thoughts or beliefs that underlie a given emotional response. For example, if they’re incensed that their partner forgot to take out the trash yet again, Consuls might recognize an underlying belief that their partner doesn’t respect them or even that their partner will never get their act together. The second step is for

Consuls to ask themselves: *Is this really true?* Finally, Consuls can ask themselves: *How would I feel if I let go of this thought or belief? Would I feel relieved, or would I feel as if I'm negating my true values and needs?* These questions can help Consuls balance their emotional insights with self-awareness and insight.

Consul-Sentinel Relationships



Balanced Consul-Sentinel Relationships

Comfort and Commitment

Couples sharing many core traits have an easier time understanding each other, so a Consul–Sentinel pairing is often a comfortable match. Relationships between Consuls and other Sentinels thrive on a sense of duty, caring, and practical order. While the specifics may differ, each understands the other's desire to build useful foundations and maintain the traditions that define their worlds. Both partners appreciate a clear path forward, and try to proceed sensibly and smoothly without complicating things. When two Sentinels enter a relationship, a deeply responsible mutual caretaking can develop that is unequalled among other personality types.

From the moment they decide to commit, things are quite serious between Consuls and Sentinels. Both feel a strong pull to stabilize things. They want to focus on building a better, more certain life, and having someone with the same values adds to their momentum. They enjoy feeling that they have found “the one,” and when they find someone who aligns with their vision of what they want in a partner, they don’t waffle or fret. They commit.

Easy Compatibility

Consuls love Sentinels for their sensible natures and the steady effort they put into life. From the start, these two embrace established wisdom and understanding rather than abstract, theoretical musings. That’s not to say their relationships are devoid of imagination, but they find that putting their energy into realistic matters and proven methods tends to be more productive. Their attention to immediate needs assures them that their lives will improve consistently. When they dream of a better future, they do so by embracing reasonable, achievable goals.

This couple works well together from an early stage, with Consuls contributing an attentive, devoted sensibility and their Sentinel partners providing their own unique forms of prudence and perseverance. Unlike those who feel rewarded by dreaming in and of itself, this couple feels a sense of purposeful satisfaction when they accomplish practical goals. As time progresses, they may discover differences in their ways of engaging the world, but their respective approaches lead them in compatible directions.

Protecting those They Love

The name “Sentinel” is no accident. People with this Role do everything in their power to protect the people close to them. To do so, they aim to create an ideal life – more

specifically, what they'd consider an ideal life – for their loved ones. Relationships can bring out the best in these types, from their constancy to their drive to serve.

When Consuls partner with other Sentinels, the two can work together to transform their relationship into the protective haven that they so crave. In so doing, Consuls gain a dual benefit: they foster the security they need *and* they extend that order and stability to the people they love. Over time, this type of relationship can open Consuls' hearts even further, enabling them to feel that they are fulfilling their true purpose in life.

Unbalanced Consul-Sentinel Relationships

Too Much of a Good Thing

When two individuals with similar traits fall in love, the combination can result in too much of a good thing. Even tradition-bound Sentinels pass through stages of change, becoming bored or frustrated with the very routines that once made them happy. There is a difference between satisfaction and joy, and these types may become so focused on stability and duty that the pleasure drains from their lives, leaving only predictable routine in its place.

The danger is even worse if one partner feels stifled while the other craves constancy. If their partners desire change, Consuls may interpret this as an abandonment of everything they have built together. Conversely, Consuls who feel stifled may resent or blame their partners for their state. Whether their partners push for change or try to maintain an unhappy routine, unbalanced Consuls may lash out, heaping judgment and resentment on the person who once seemed like their soulmate.

Missed Opportunities

Unbalanced Consul–Sentinel couples don’t venture beyond their comfort zone, and so they may ignore highly beneficial opportunities that seem too risky. Even if they never disagree on aspects of their life together, such a couple may become insulated inside the worlds they know. When they reinforce one another’s reliance on the status quo, these partners never discover their options, much less explore them. Consuls’ ambition and willpower don’t guarantee that they will seize new opportunities, especially if their Sentinel partners also stick to a well-trodden path.

Personal growth, success, and prosperity almost always entail a measure of risk. However, unbalanced Consul–Sentinel partners support each other’s security rather than their growth. Trying a new path may seem pointless when a perfectly good situation already exists – especially one they worked so hard to create together. If these types reassure each other that change is not needed, they hold each other back. Worse, they may deliberately ignore circumstances that desperately need improvement.

Certainty upon Certainty

When they date other Sentinels, Consuls may appreciate their partners’ decisive, clear-cut approach to life. But if the Judging trait overheats as the relationship progresses, the result is a recipe for tension and conflict. Unless Consul–Sentinel couples learn to cope with disagreements, their stubborn determination can consume the harmony from their relationship like a flame consumes oxygen.

Once Consuls decide something is correct, they stick to that decision. If their partner disagrees, unbalanced Consuls might feel affronted, judgmental, or even self-righteous. This behavior can manifest in their Sentinel partners as well. The Judging

trait inevitably conveys a degree of decisiveness, an intrinsic certainty of thought. However, this in no way assures common preferences between the couple: one may like chocolate, the other, vanilla. The only thing they may agree on is that each wants their own way.

Even when Consuls *do* routinely get their way, this doesn't mean that the relationship is on good footing. People with this personality type may feel pleased or appeased when their wishes are honored, but high-handedness – even with the best of intentions – can be damaging to the other partner's sense of worth. Controlling behavior is truly the dark side of willfulness, and it undermines the practical compromise that all balanced Sentinels embrace. When one partner makes all of the decisions, long-term happiness cannot prosper because freedom is not shared.

Rebalancing Consul-Sentinel Relationships

Venture into Something New Together

When Consuls and Sentinels meet, they may enjoy the sense of security that comes from being with someone who also values tradition and the status quo. If the relationship veers into unbalanced terrain, however, they may find themselves clinging to old patterns and routines, even those that no longer work. As a result, Consuls may feel stuck, stifled, or limited, although the reasons for these feelings may not be apparent.

Balanced individuals navigate successfully through life by adapting and growing. In this spirit, Consul-Sentinel couples can shake things up occasionally to find new opportunities and joys. Improvement is by definition a type of change, and must be sought consciously. A foray outside their routine is the first step for this couple to achieve greater pleasure, strength, and happiness within the relationship.

Fortunately, once such determined types engage in something together, they generate their own momentum, as they do not commit lightly or give up easily.

The key for this couple is to agree *together* to make an ongoing effort to expand. To cure or prevent stagnation, they can schedule monthly or quarterly conversations where they discuss new things they can learn, do, or try together. They might identify one thing to try in each of the following areas: domestic routines, romantic activities, hobbies, and social/community life. By approaching these changes together, the couple can grow in tandem, taking advantage of each other's reliable support.

Compromise is Necessary

The Judging trait, with all of its certitude, doesn't have to lock people into inflexibility or rigidity. But if it does, the heart holds the key. When this couple disagrees, they must remind themselves of the deep appreciation they feel for each other's presence in their lives. The love they share is what motivates compromise. Fairly supporting each other's preferences doesn't require either partner to change their own – just that they honor the other's wishes, going along with them at least some of the time.

Balanced Consuls make a special effort to support their partners' needs and desires. No matter how certain a Consul is that pumpkin pie *must* be served at the holidays, their partner's tastes deserve respectful consideration and inclusion. Otherwise, Consuls' partners will feel dismissed, disrespected, or unfairly judged.

Whenever they find themselves at odds with their partners, Consuls can ask themselves "On a scale of one to 10, how much does this issue matter to me?" If the answer is six or less, Consuls can experiment with acceding to their partners' wishes and noticing how this feels. By doing so, Consuls may find that cultivating compromise feels even better than getting their way.

Consul-Explorer Relationships



Balanced Consul-Explorer Relationships

Opposites Attract

Consul-Explorer couples may seem like an odd combination, but they can be quite compatible. Early in the relationship, Consuls often appreciate that, as Observant types, Explorers are hands-on and present-minded. They may also enjoy Explorers' relative flexibility, which enables Explorers to embrace every moment as an opportunity for immediate satisfaction or accomplishment.

The truth is that two vastly different people can enjoy a wonderfully balanced and joyful relationship. Consuls may find themselves attracted to Explorers during times when they recognize a need for more excitement, relaxation, and spontaneity in their lives. Explorers certainly bring enjoyment to the table, thanks to their ability to find the fun even in ordinary situations, attack challenges that seem somehow interesting or inspiring, and kick back when necessary. As the relationship progresses, Consuls can offer practical support that keeps Explorers' lives functioning, allowing both partners to enjoy the advantages of a stable, secure home base.

Discovery and Security

Explorers broaden Consuls' worlds. By gently tugging Consuls out of their comfort zone and their sense of how things "should" be done, Explorers can add variety, excitement, and novelty to Consuls' lives. Consuls might not always admit they need this, but balanced Consuls in particular may crave some of the joy and freedom that runs through Explorers' veins.

Beyond practical assistance, Consuls can support Explorers on a deep emotional level. Many Explorers have experienced challenging times during their younger years, particularly if their unique personalities didn't fit in and their strengths weren't appreciated. This type of childhood can affect their sense of belonging for the rest of their lives. When Consuls love Explorers, their care can fulfill Explorers' basic need for nurturance and positive attention. In such cases, the result is often a real and satisfying emotional union for both partners.

Unbalanced Consul-Explorer Relationships

Roles that Grow Old

Opposites may attract, but over time, unbalanced Consuls and Explorers fall into roles that become so distinct and repetitive that they create separation instead of unity. If Consuls take on the responsibilities of organizing, planning, and meeting obligations, they may become frustrated with Explorers' "just want to have fun" attitudes. Although these roles can work well when each partner feels the benefits of the other's approach, they quickly grow tiresome and oppressive if taken too far.

In an unbalanced relationship, this dynamic might start to resemble that of a parent and child. It's burdensome for Consuls to take all the responsibility while Explorers

enjoy a carefree existence, and if Consuls impose rules and expectations, Explorers may feel stifled or patronized. Consuls won't hold back their judgment or frustration regarding this imbalance for long, and unbalanced Consuls may even unleash criticism or contempt that opens old wounds for Explorers.

Collision Course

Consuls have firm, long-held opinions and convictions, whereas Explorers adapt and change course fairly easily. This relationship arrangement may work at first, but as it progresses, Consuls might chafe whenever Explorers defy their battery of “shoulds”: how things *should* be done, how a relationship *should* progress, and – in the case of parents – how children *should* be raised.

This conflict can come to a head regarding the issue of commitment. In a relationship, Consuls may insist on defining the level of commitment early on, particularly if they feel eager to settle down or start a family. On the flip side, Explorers' independence often makes them resist a committed lifestyle, at least right away. Explorers can demonstrate great longevity in love, but if they feel pressured by too many strict demands, they may try to escape or pull away – something that is especially hurtful for Consuls, who crave total loyalty from their partners. If one partner seeks commitment while the other yearns for freedom, the relationship can be fraught with emotional landmines.

Rebalancing Consul-Explorer Relationships

Sharing Responsibilities

Unbalanced Consuls may try to validate themselves by playing “parent” in their households, taking care of practical chores and obligations – or nagging their

partners to do so. They may also keep score in their minds, noting all the ways they do more than their partner to keep things running smoothly. The result, unfortunately, is resentment and contempt – not exactly the ingredients for a happy relationship.

The solution to this situation is respect: both self-respect and respect for the other partner. Without building up grudges, balanced Consuls recognize when the scales of responsibility are tilted too far in their direction. In this situation, they speak their needs and respectfully ask their partners to help out. A balanced Consul might say, “I’m super stressed and busy, so would you do a load of laundry to help me out?” In this situation, it’s important for Consuls to release some of their expectations. The laundry might not be done *exactly* how they would do it, but that’s all right.

Balanced Consuls also remember that they fell in love with someone who has a higher tolerance for disorder and a lower tolerance for mundane activity. When they want their Explorer partners to help out, Consuls can spice up chores by playing music or turning the activity into a game – for example, “Let’s see how many things we can put away while this song plays.” In a loving relationship, nobody should confuse encouraging more responsibility with demanding it, but both partners must participate.

Benefitting from Each Other’s Ways

Unbalanced Consuls see the world in black and white. They may put themselves and their partners in boxes – for example, “All you care about is having fun,” or “All I do is work, so I don’t have any time to relax.” This isn’t the full truth, however. Consuls are perfectly capable of releasing control and relaxing, and Explorers can certainly make practical contributions to the relationship.

So how can Consuls break through the walls that keep them – and their partners – trapped in unproductive patterns? The answer, surprisingly, is to ask their partner for input. Even in the worst relationship stalemates, “What would you do in my place?” is a powerful question.

For example, Consuls who find themselves locked into doing all the chores might ask their Explorer partners how they would behave if the roles were reversed. This type of communication encourages Explorers to see the situation from Consuls’ point of view, motivating them to help remedy the situation. Even if Consuls think they know what their partner will say, they should listen carefully. Open-minded Explorers sometimes have powerful insights that can help Consuls break free of their old roles.

Conclusion

Embracing Possibilities

Relationships present Consuls with wonderful opportunities to grow. Normally, people with this personality type feel little pull to reconsider their opinions, but love can give them powerful a motivation to explore the terrain beyond the world of “should.” This won’t happen overnight, but balanced Consuls are fully capable of pushing beyond a rut, appreciating the inspiration and guidance they can gain from someone they love and trust. A dedicated partner with a different perspective can brighten Consuls’ words and broaden their minds.

In a balanced relationship, Consuls offer incredible devotion and strong emotional support, enabling both their partner and themselves to reach higher and do more than they could alone. When the relationship is founded on acceptance, honesty, and

respect, there is no reason why Consuls cannot enjoy a lasting and balanced love with any personality type.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your romantic relationships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Get to Know Your Partner](#)

Would you like to get to know your partner a little better? Try this simple, but very fun and effective, game.

[Couple Analysis](#)

A great tool for couples. Learn how your personalities are likely to interact, and how you can connect on an even deeper level.

[Type Guesser \(Romance\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your partner belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

[Romantic Fulfillment Test](#)

Grasp the roles that confidence and optimism play in your relationships, as well as what makes someone a good match for you.

[Intertype Test](#)

Do you have a partner? Do you want to understand your relationship better? Learn more about it with our easy Intertype Test.

Loyalty Test

With this test, you will find out how you build relationships and loyalty in four major areas: Romance, Work, Friendships, and Family.

Friendships



Social Foundations

Consuls are very social personality types, seeking large circles of friends and more than willing to spend the time and energy necessary to maintain these relationships. Upbeat and warm, Consuls are known for being welcoming and providing a constant source of emotional support and encouragement. They see friendship as a sacred responsibility as well as a fulfilling pleasure, caring for each friend individually. For this type, being involved in other people's lives is very satisfying, and they love to make a positive difference whenever they can

Consuls crave a world where people are responsible, trustworthy, and engaged together – friendships that reflect these values satisfy them deeply. Luckily, meeting good people is easy for this type. Consuls cheerfully do what they can to make sure their friends are happy, and being so outgoing and empathetic, their energy wins them many friends. Consuls are comfortably popular in most social environments, and they are often the center of their social circle. Being connected to many people gives Consuls the sense of strength and stability they need to be happy in life.

Sturdy and Stable

Initial connections may be quick and easy for Consuls, but they aren't superficial people. They maintain strong values and views based on their personal traditions, and find especially deep bonds with those who match them in such areas. When it comes to true friends, this type values consistency. They freely give of their hearts and hands alike, but expect steady commitment from others in return. Vigorous, practical, and emotionally-attuned, Consuls make excellent friends, and are always happy to bring another reliable person into their lives.

Where Consuls' desire for solidity limits their social relationships is their unwillingness to accept very different points of view. They tend to be kind-hearted, but also aren't easily impressed or enthused by unusual people, preferring an inclusive but tightly defined social order. This is a type who tries to gently guide others toward their own proven values instead of embracing change. They can be a powerful force for good in their community and beyond, always seeking to share the reliable foundation they have created with others.

Commonality and Mutual Reliance

Consuls' way of developing a positive social status is reflected by their friends, as they like being around those with similar culture. Friendships are likely to flourish in environments that reflect what they have decided on through their own experiences. Of course, what's compatible depends on the personal history of each Consul – the only sure thing is that they enjoy a sense of security through practicing consistent beliefs with like-minded individuals.

This type is socially outgoing in whatever community feels like home, but rarely feels pulled to explore contrasting ways of life. However, balanced Consuls seeking to

diversify their friendships wisely look for groups formed around any subject they have in common, from gardening to gaming to sports. This is an easy way for this type to bond with people who have different views and backgrounds. Sharing an interest means they will agree on at least that one thing.

Among friends who have earned their loyalty, Consuls are tireless protectors, always trying to create a framework of support and a cooperative sense of mutual reliance. They are great at using their sensitivity to stay in tune with what motivates and drives their friends, and contribute much of themselves to those ends. Where this type often falls short is when one of those friends departs from agreed-upon harmony to try something new, or when a person with challengingly unfamiliar views moves into their social circle. Consuls' empathy and desire to connect sometimes are sometime at war with their need for familiarity.

Pleasant Surprises

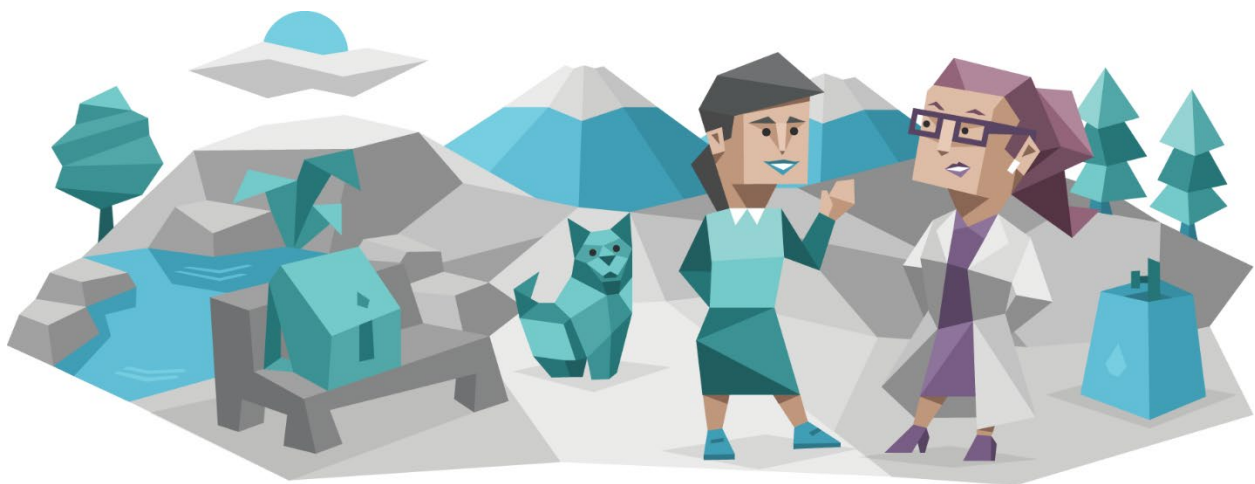
Consuls' appreciation of conventional social rules doesn't prevent them from building friendships with very different types of people, but they may need time to get to know their virtues as well as their needs. Consuls are quick to offer advice and help to anyone, and this often forms a bridge to bring them closer to those they don't initially understand very well.

It may take a while for Consuls to warm to people with unusual characteristics, but the chance to discover their inner qualities is an exciting challenge for these highly social types. They want to be able to include everyone as a friend – it's just a matter of finding or creating some common ground. Once that happens, Consuls can enjoy friendship with almost anyone.

Consuls and Friends of Other Types

With that in mind, let's look at some of the virtues that this type can share with each Role group through friendship, as well as some areas of potential difficulty. Most importantly, we'll also go over some helpful things Consuls can do to make friendships work with other types.

Consul-Analyst Friendships



Balanced Friendships with Analysts

Energetic Balance

Consul-Analyst friendships don't always form easily, but through friendship these types can nicely balance each other. For example, the headstrong, often confrontational nature of Commanders and Debaters can challenge Consuls' – and everyone else's – patience. Consuls can match the energetic willpower of these types to offer them some firm advice on creating social harmony when they get too carried away with logic and ego. These Analysts in turn appreciate Consuls' consistent strength, admiring how they refuse to give up and never let down a friend in need.

Not all Analyst friends are so challenging to be around, though. Consuls appreciate the quieter, thoughtful natures of Logicians and Architects. They see how these types take the time to figure out clever solutions, and find their input helpful on nearly everything. It may not always be easy to understand their curious intellectual musings, but Analysts offer Consuls a rational, calculated way of thinking that they often lack. In return, Consuls help Analysts of all types consider angles they normally dismiss, such as human needs and their own emotions, helping them understand themselves better.

Critical Support

More than just personal balance, these friends can offer each other truly valuable, very different kinds of support when problems arise. Each brings very different qualities to the friendship, but when they share their virtues with each other, a bond is formed from which provides strength through good times and bad.

When Consuls face problems, they will find that having Analysts friends knocks mountains down to molehills. Analysts are inspired innovators, and when Consuls need help thinking through a problem critically, they will find logical solutions in abundance. Analyst friends may not be the most obvious choice for tender comfort in times of emotional upset, but when Consuls are drowning in stress over a less personal problem, Analysts offer great support. Consuls like to keep things in order, and sometimes need a logical friend to help them stay on track.

The other side of that coin is that Analysts often don't know how to ask for help when they are troubled by sadness, loss, or worry, instead trying to think their way out of their very natural feelings. Consuls see right past this veneer of intellectuality to give the kind of comfort and understanding that Analysts don't even know they need.

Analysts might not find Consuls to be the most enthusiastic partners in intellectual pursuits, but they come to deeply appreciate having a friend who openly cares for them regardless of their mental ability.

Unbalanced Friendships with Analysts

Disappointing Disconnection

There are challenges, of course – in an unbalanced friendship, Consuls find Analysts to be emotionally distant and annoyingly focused on creative ideas rather than grounded reality. The fact that Consuls prioritize social connections and Analysts like to theorize about impersonal ideas is a stumbling block. These two might live in clashing mental time zones, as well, Consuls focusing on what is, and Analysts on what might be. Unbalanced Consuls roll their eyes dismissively at Analysts' grand, esoteric technical plans, and may in turn be frustrated by unbalanced Analysts' rejection of the social fabric they themselves find so vital.

To make this disconnection worse, unbalanced Analysts have a neglectful attitude towards maintaining friendships. Once they put in the initial effort to establish a good friendship, they often take it for granted, thinking nothing of long silences or absences. This robs Consuls of the frequent contact that makes them so happy, creating an impression that Analysts simply don't care. This is unacceptable to Consuls, for whom nothing is more important than friends, family, and their chosen social community. Their attempts to encourage Analysts to engage socially may not always be successful though, and those Analysts who don't make enough time for their Consul friends may find themselves out in the cold.

Perceptions of Weakness

Even in an established friendship, Consuls and Analysts can both suffer from stubbornness, and may look dimly on what they feel are each other's flaws. When in balance, basic tolerance as well as deep appreciation of each other's virtues more than makes up for these kinds of negative appraisals, but when unbalanced, both these types can be harsh.

Consuls may find Analysts to be inconsiderate because they are often blind to feelings. Unbalanced Analysts may be seriously lacking in this area, and unbalanced Consuls consider this an unforgivable deficiency – an inability to act human. When unbalanced Consuls are upset with Analysts' social ineptitude, they don't simply walk away, they try to "fix" them. Unfortunately, their solution is usually to exert pressure on Analysts to conform to their own social ideals. This may be anything from open verbal disapproval to passive aggressive criticism, but is unlikely to be put in rational terms that get through to Analysts, who in turn just feel confused and resentful.

For their part, Analysts may come to view their Consul friends as weak for always being so personally sensitive and concerned about others' feelings. This seems not only like gullible vulnerability to unbalanced Analysts, but also a pointless waste of time. Unbalanced Analysts see preoccupation with emotion and social harmony as ignoring fundamental reality, and tend to look down on those who prioritize intangible things like compassion, empathy, and human relationships. They deeply offend their Consul friends when they disparage the kinds of social goals that Consuls prize so highly.

Rebalancing Friendships with Analysts

Enjoying Each Other's Virtues

Consuls and Analysts can maintain a good connection by remembering the benefits of being friends. Consuls contribute critical qualities that Analysts often lack: realism, grounded practicality, and emotional understanding. Analysts often end up getting a bit lost in their own universe, and Consuls keep them in touch with humanity by offering a satisfying connection to good things in life. It's OK to live in a mental laboratory, but sharing a laugh over pizza and iced cream with a good friend is something that even the most cerebral Analysts appreciate. Analysts don't have to sacrifice their own ideas and priorities to connect warmly with Consuls, they just have to accept the outstretched hand.

Analysts aren't the only ones who need to make an effort to stay connected in this friendship. While social overtures come easy to Consuls, they may give little time to the things that drive Analysts. One way to overcome this is games; Analysts are very likely to be fond of some type of game, anything from golf to video games to tennis. Engaging games can be an easy gateway to spending fulfilling time together. It might not offer the deeper emotional connection that Consuls crave, but is at least a way to share companionable joy – not a bad compromise.

These friends might have to be deliberate about their compromises when finding things to do together, and can set themselves the goal of each doing three things per month that the other cares about. Good times together can be created almost anywhere, and if each friend gets to lead the way into something they like, they can likewise accept the responsibility to also make it can be fun for the other person.

Emotional Honesty

Analysts may not even realize they are losing their Consul friends by not being engaged or considerate enough, and emotional subtlety won't likely reach them. To be clear, Consuls can put what they feel into basic terms, and tell it with a cool, relaxed attitude. They must tell Analysts when something is important, be it a feeling, a thought, or social ideas, and it's also helpful to let them know what to do. Analysts value their friends deeply, but can be quite blind to their needs. Rebalancing this requires patient communication in language that makes sense to both friends.

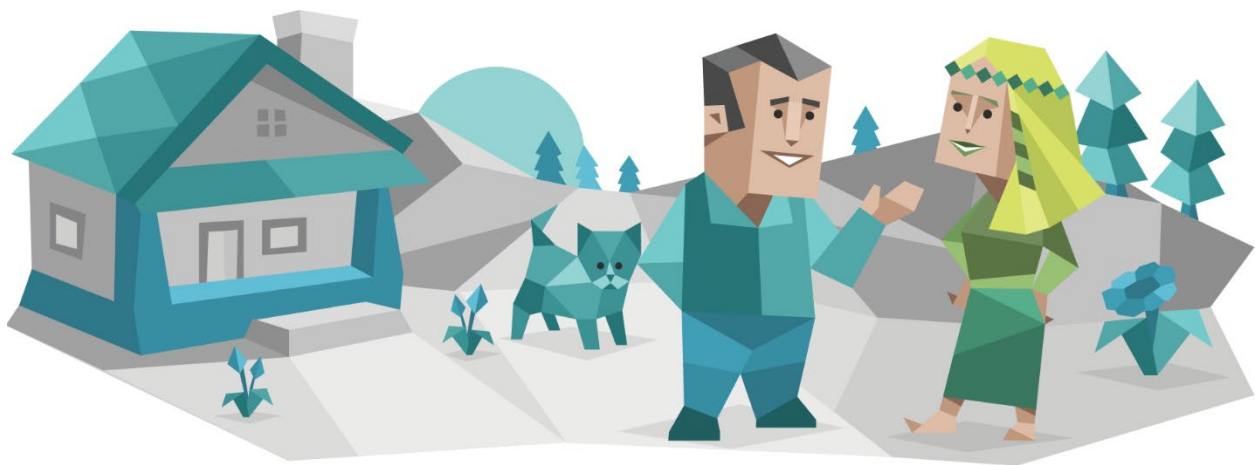
Consideration goes both ways, and balanced Consuls work to respect Analysts' seemingly unfamiliar ways of thinking, including a tendency to be reserved with their deepest feelings. Consuls can gently draw out Analysts' deeper feelings by asking questions, but also recognize when it is time to let things be. Analyst should feel free to say when they have reach their limits, and balanced Consuls understand that trusting honesty doesn't always mean absolute openness. Some people just need to keep parts of themselves to themselves in order to feel secure. Instead of trying to force Analysts' feelings out, Consuls can let them know that they are accepted, whether they choose to be fully open or not.

Thoughtful Support

A functioning, balanced friendship with an Analyst is certainly rewarding for both sides. Consuls offer Analysts a sensitive ear for their intellectual ranting that helps soothe their frustration with a dysfunctional world. Being dutiful, stable, and proactive is natural for this type, and Analysts especially need steadfast friends willing to take the time to understand them.

In turn, Consuls gain sincere and thoughtful support from their Analyst friends, whose vigorous minds are always at the ready. Analysts lead them into knowledge they might not discover through their more conventional perspective, but also offer nimble, reasoned reflection in times of trouble. Analysts help Consuls work through personal problems rationally, and this can be great help when emotions are out of control.

Consul-Diplomat Friendships



Balanced Friendships with Diplomats

Compatible Souls

Consul-Diplomat friendships are often a quick fit, both sharing a sense of empathy that makes it easy to understand each other. While Consuls might find Diplomats' high-minded ideals a bit unrealistic at times, they love the sincere way they try to express them. Consuls find the way that Diplomats care about people and society to be inspiring. Being friends will likely help create balance for these two, as Consuls are exposed to a strong imagination, and Diplomats to practical thinking.

Social activities between these two are not always a guaranteed success though, as Diplomats tend to have dreamy, forward-looking visions of what might be that distract them from the present moment. Consuls, in turn, are looking for steady, reliable friend to stay by their side through thick and thin, happiness and pain – and they will do everything for such a friend when they find them. When spending time together, these friends’ priorities and passions might be a little out of sync.

Fortunately, their hearts are usually in tune, as Diplomats are sensitive to their friends’ needs and Consuls have only to express themselves to be heard in the most caring terms. If Diplomats lose their heads in the clouds occasionally, Consuls nonetheless find them to be extremely open and emotionally available, and these two don’t take long to establish a deep connection. Regardless of their personal preferences and ideal social settings, these friends find the warmth and cheerfulness of each other’s company extremely satisfying, and have the potential to build an enduring friendship.

Discovering Support

Despite being bold, Consuls are not often adventurous by nature. However, the empathetic friendship of Diplomats is the perfect vessel for Consuls to try new things and broaden their understanding of life. Diplomats are unlikely to push Consuls into things they strongly disapprove of, being very attentive to their feelings. With that kind of support, balanced Consuls gladly challenge themselves to grow and learn, knowing that the more they experience in life, the more joy they will find.

The flip side is how stable and discerning balanced Consuls can be – they support Diplomat friends by sharing a realistic perspective and some helpful structure. Diplomats appreciate the way that Consuls forge a smooth path through life, and the

focused, energetic compassion of Consuls is a lifeline to Diplomats who feel lost in chaos. Consuls help them bring a little order to their lives while also giving them all the kindness they need. When these friends each put their best foot forward, they balance idealism and practicality to notably improve each other's lives.

Unbalanced Friendships with Diplomats

Different Realities

Unfortunately, this friendship may experience friction as these types come to realize that their differing approaches or systems of belief are incompatible in certain situations. Consuls look to the past for tried and true examples of what works best, and Diplomats happily embrace revolutionary change. Unbalanced Diplomats may become frustrated at Consuls' insistence on social order and stability rather than joining them in what they see as progress.

Consuls like to follow rules as an ideal, and in turn may become disturbed when they see Diplomat friends breaking rules *for* an ideal. These two often feel as though they are living in different worlds. This really hits home when these types express opinions on what is or isn't fair. Consuls see fairness in practical rules being applied compassionately, whereas Diplomats like to create fairness through conditional approaches based on moral ideals.

Another difference is how Diplomats often embrace unrealistic dreams. Consuls eventually find this behavior tiring if those dreams always seem to potentials be on the horizon. This type wants to create a warm social structure around them, and can be baffled when Diplomats, especially Campaigners and Mediators, are always chasing something "out there" instead of joining them in the present. Frustration results if these friends cannot reconcile their very different approaches to life.

Upsetting Each Other

Watching a friend fall into things that seem imprudent or even perilous is frustrating for Consuls. Whether it's a dubious romantic interest, implausible belief, or precarious financial habits, unbalanced Diplomats' sometimes haphazard lifestyle worries characteristically grounded Consuls. They feel frustrated when trying to avert Diplomat friends' questionable decisions, even becoming openly critical, and their own rising emotions do little to foster a calm way out of the situation. When these two get out of balance and lose control of their feelings, things can get ugly, indeed.

Unbalanced Consuls can be relentless, often causing offense when they push corrective advice, no matter how true it is. To Diplomats, this can feel like someone stepping on their dreams or trying to control them, a common misinterpretation of even the best-intentioned criticism or correction. They are hurt by Consuls' firm rejection of fantastical possibilities, seeing it as a lack of support. Such conflicts threaten these friendships, as unbalanced Consuls may remain persistently and vocally judgmental, and unbalanced Diplomats may reject anyone who doesn't agree with them as fundamentally negative, even close friends.

Rebalancing Friendships with Diplomats

Understanding Perspectives

Resolving different perspectives within a Consul-Diplomat friendship requires tapping into the positive emotions they feel toward one another. These friends don't need to agree on a lifestyle, but they can explain their heartfelt needs to each other. For Consuls, this may include conventional social interests, and for Diplomats, embracing new things. Either way, honesty and respect are key. Both these friends care about the other being happy, and if each must occasionally step out of their

preferred modes to join the other in theirs, they can simply regard it as a gift to a friend.

Further, when these friends take the time to gently explain their different views on life instead of simply holding them up as “better”, they will create understanding for each other. They can also show each other deep respect by asking questions with an open mind. It can be as simple as saying “That doesn’t make sense to me, can we talk things over together so I can understand you better?” Consuls may be focused on stability and traditional social roles, and Diplomats more on progress and change, but the appreciation these two feel for the sincerity of each other’s views brings them together. Agreement isn’t required when enough genuine respect – and love – is present in a friendship.

Stepping In, and Stepping Back

Balanced Consuls are judicious about when to offer their advice and help, accepting that Diplomats are dreamers and must be allowed their dreams, but there are moments when a more grounded perspective is vital. It’s not always easy to implement balanced intervention, but Consuls can work to maintain support while not becoming overbearing or judgmental.

If their advice is ignored, Consuls can respectfully retreat, making their ongoing willingness to help clear while holding true to their own perspective. They may have little choice but to accept an ongoing stream of questionable ideas and choices from Diplomat friends. If this happens, balanced Consuls take pragmatic solace in knowing that they tried to help. Avoiding participation in things they can’t support helps Consuls maintain fair friendships with Diplomats, even if that requires stepping back now and then.

Consul-Sentinel Friendships



Balanced Friendships with Sentinels

Reassuring Steadiness

Other Sentinels are a good fit for Consuls, as both share an appreciation for dependability and practicality. These friendships support day-to-day activities and quality of life in general more than change, ambition, or curiosity. Consuls are reassured and buoyed by uncomplicated friendships with other Sentinels. Having someone steadfast and sensible in their lives is no small consideration for either of these types.

Consuls also find Sentinels' conventional social leanings appealing, whether such friends are Introverts or Extraverts. Their discussions revolve around grounded matters like work, current life events, and personal interests. Sentinels aren't big on esoteric topics, and consider those who constantly talk about broad, impersonal matters a bit baffling – they like to use the time to connect with each other. Among Sentinel friends, Consuls get a pleasant dose of real life rather than ideological grandstanding.

These friendships go beyond casual compatibility, though. When serious situations and major life events happen, Consuls also appreciate how Sentinel friends stand by their side with dedication. They offer the same in return, acting as strong, vocal supporters of the people who have earned their friendship. Consuls and Sentinels stand a very good chance of becoming each other's best friends for a lifetime.

Stability in Action

Favoring stable foundations doesn't mean that these friends don't care about progress. However, where Intuitive or Prospecting types see a future teeming with endless possibilities, Consuls like everything moving firmly in a controlled direction. Having a Sentinel friend with an organized way of living and equally sensible goals helps both friends keep moving forward.

When difficulties arise in life, Consuls are often the first to step forward with a helping hand, and Sentinel friends respect and deeply appreciate their ready devotion. In turn, the judicious touch of a Sentinel friend is perfect for Consuls in times of trouble. Whether offering a thoughtful solution or simply some dutiful, hands-on help, these friends are cores of support for each other. This creates the security that they need to form a deep and grateful bond with each other.

Relatable Differences

Opposing personality traits may be easier for Consuls to relate to when displayed by fellow Sentinels. Executives' logic inspires Consuls to be more efficient, as it demonstrates creating useful structure through cool rationality. The quiet sensitivity of Defenders is charming to Consuls, who find their pragmatic, patient acceptance creates a gentle sense of connection. The reserved, thoughtful way that Logisticians

work to create order impresses Consuls, who appreciate systems that work to the benefit of people.

Different Sentinel friends offer Consuls doorways to growth, broadening their view while staying soberly grounded alongside them. Shared values focusing on stability, tradition, and dedication make friendships within this Role a good way for Consuls to find supportive bonds as well as new ways of thinking. Commonality helps these friends see eye-to-eye while they learn from each other's differing approaches to life.

Unbalanced Friendships with Sentinels

Social Problems

While these types share many compatibilities, Consuls may find that other Sentinels have a hard time matching them socially, each in different ways. This type wants to be immersed in a social framework, devoted to their friends and constantly involved in their lives. Some other Sentinels may not want this level of attachment. Introverted Sentinels might not have enough energy to keep up with Consuls, becoming tired or stressed out by too much activity. Thinking Sentinels might not be able to offer enough emotional openness for Consuls to feel truly connected. When friends cannot give Consuls the level of engagement and company they seek, it can begin to feel unfulfilling to this type, creating distance.

The worst potential for unbalanced Consuls might be when they become "frenemies" with someone of their own type. Consuls are bold, outgoing, and deeply concerned with their own status in the social order. It is easy for two such people to become competitive with each other, and when unbalanced, this is frightening. Consuls are forthright in expressing themselves, but they don't always speak their minds plainly. When balanced, this is because they want to be tactful and compassionate, but when

unbalanced, Consuls may hide adversarial behavior under a veneer of guileful sweetness. Consuls engaged in a cold war of words can ruin an otherwise good friendship.

Mutual Immobility

Consuls and Sentinel friends build an enjoyable, predictable routine together, but unwillingness to try new things holds back their advancement on many fronts. Sentinels don't offer Consuls much inspiration to make even beneficial changes to their lives, such as moving or going back to school. These friends may even shut out other worthy people who bring changes that don't easily fit their social order. Instead of embracing the risks of ongoing development, these friends seek to reassure each other that things are OK.

Mutual reassurance provides a sense of comfort and solidity, but does little to motivate improvements. This isn't to say that these friends settle for failure, but they may settle for existing success. Even the most vigorous Consuls rarely see the value in spontaneously departing from a working routine. Consequently, these friends may not push each other to excel beyond the security of conventional accomplishments. They do each other a disservice if they don't occasionally step out of their routine together to see what life can offer, and what they are truly capable of.

Rebalancing Friendships with Sentinels

Adjusting to Needs

At the risk of sounding like a mattress ad, Consuls can rebalance many social problems with Sentinels by artfully conforming to their unique needs, and perhaps dialing things down a little. When Consuls are too firm in asserting themselves, they

may create friction, but if they withdraw too far, they leave friends aching for their support.

When dealing with people with less tolerance for social contact, Consuls can respect their limits, using their own keen sense of emotional observation to determine when it's time to reduce the pressure. This doesn't necessarily mean detachment, but Introverts or Thinking Sentinels might appreciate doing something a little less actively engaged with other people, some of the time. For example, outdoor walks and time spent together in quieter pursuits give these types a chance to enjoy Consuls' company without needing to rise to their level of energetic social engagement with others.

If Consuls find themselves feeling friction with other Consuls, they need only pause to remember the three things they admire most about the other person, and focus on the positive connection they have. Energetic types challenge each other, and some competitiveness can be quite healthy and fun, but the underlying connection must be one of mutual appreciation and respect. If jealousy creeps in, each person needs to take a hard look at why they feel a sense of threat rather than support. Communicating these feelings honestly gives Consuls a chance to set things right with each other.

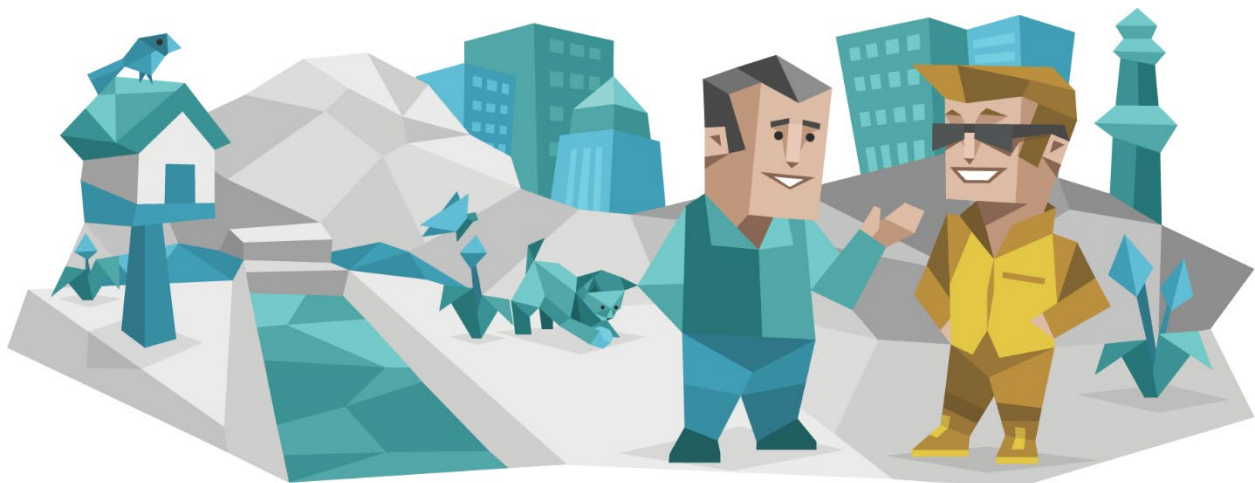
Sensible Change

Sentinels excel at being responsible, so balanced Consuls and Sentinels alike keep an eye not just on each other's comfort and security, but on what will truly benefit each other long-term. These friends wisely advise each other when they're in a rut, and offer ideas when change is needed to create success in life. When this requires

embracing something new or unconventional, these friends can offer each other a judicious helping hand as well as supportive encouragement.

This applies to recreational pursuits as well as more serious matters, and these friends can set a goal of trying out three new things together each month. There's no need to leap off a cliff or take major risks, but sampling new fun with a trustworthy Sentinel friend leads to experiences that Consuls would not find on their own. This type is not reluctant to take on challenges, and can likewise boldly explore new adventures. Engaging the unknown together, at least occasionally, is a smart way for these friends to explore their own potential while sharing some fun.

Consul-Explorer Friendships



Balanced Friendships with Explorers

Zest for Life

Friendship with Explorers offers Consuls some notable opportunities. Explorers live for the moment and its pleasures rather than stability, and make for exciting friends. Explorers' ability to lose themselves in enthusiasm is a great counterpoint to Consuls'

careful, methodical planning and sense of tradition. This friendship provides a fresh outlook that helps Consuls see a broader perspective on life, and serves their desire for active social engagement.

Consuls benefit from being led into fun and curiosity by an Explorer friend. Though it's not always easy, balanced Consuls practice relinquishing control and trying new things, especially in recreational matters where little is at stake. Developing adaptability without losing their cool is a very useful mode for this type. They can't always predict what life throws at them, and friendship with Explorers is a wonderful way to practice mastering the unexpected, the unpredictable, and the uninhibited aspects of life.

Offering Guidance

Balanced Consuls appreciate how Explorers' passion for discovery opens up a lot of fun and excitement for them both, but also see how such carefree enthusiasm can lead to unintended consequences. Supportive, hands-on advice is where Consuls shine in such a friendship. When they earn the trust of Explorer friends, they become a respected voice of sense. While not expecting Explorers to adopt more conventional views, they offer a warm, steadying hand with just the right amount of reserve to prevent calamity.

The other side of that coin is that Consuls who come to trust Explorer friends also accept a guiding hand to pull them out of their dutiful routine and explore something unknown to them. Consuls have a hard time embracing change, and Explorers provide not only help in this area, but inspiration and company when Consuls are ready to have some fun.

Surprising Capability

At first, Consuls assume that the more spontaneous style of Explorers, so different from their own planned approach, is not very effective. However, they are impressed when Explorer friends pursue things they care about to great success, overcoming challenges on the fly with adaptive tenacity. Explorers might change their minds frequently, but they throw themselves fully into mastering interests that are important to them.

When those interests align with Consuls' own, they find Explorer friends to be helpful, involved companions. Explorers add a little refreshing excitement to Consuls' projects and goals. For example, Adventurers' quiet curiosity introduces them to subtle experiences they might miss on their own. This type also very much appreciates the practical, hands-on side of Explorer friends. The intent way that Virtuosos hone their skills is impressive to Consuls, as it shows them the value of unconventional technical flexibility.

Motivation

Consuls enjoy the undaunted, open-minded spirit of Explorers, as well. The outward-focused vigor of Entrepreneur and Entertainer friends matches their own energy, but with uninhibited enthusiasm. Consuls and Entertainers may get along especially well by sharing exciting recreational things together. What Explorers lack in steadiness, they make up for with zeal, approaching experiences and challenges with a flexibility that Consuls can learn a lot from.

In turn, Consuls' organized effectiveness impresses Explorer friends, especially when aimed at a common goal. Explorers grab for what they want, and as masters of energetic planning and engagement, Consuls help them ensure success. These

friends lend each other very different kinds of help to move successfully through life. Consuls are utterly sensible, and their carefulness beautifully balances Explorers' lively adaptability. When these friends share a goal, each is impressed by what the other can do.

Unbalanced Friendships with Explorers

Dangerous Games

There is a dark side to living in the moment, as a lack of consistency and forethought often brings about wild disorganization, social friction, and financial instability. Explorers' uninhibited lifestyle and impetuous decisions challenge Consuls' boundaries of acceptance. Being exposed to too much chaos is deeply upsetting to this stable type, emotionally connected. It's not in their nature to abandon friends, but they are quick to share their concerns, unabashedly voicing criticism and advice alike.

Unbalanced Explorers rarely understand or respect these doubts and reservations, either becoming offended by Consuls or losing patience and acting without them. In an unbalanced friendship, any idea of steadfast companionship can vanish into thin air when Explorers feel compelled to go in directions that Consuls refuse to consider. This mutual disregard causes both friends to question the friendship itself. Explorers resent the lack of support when they want to follow their hearts, and Consuls dig in their heels, wary of ever-changing, exuberant disorder.

Disappointment and Frustration

A seemingly minor area where the oft-fickle interests of Explorer friends can be very troubling for Consuls is planning. Consuls demand organization, and Explorers don't

exactly operate that way. Friends being late for, altering, or cancelling social engagements is deeply frustrating to Consuls. This type becomes overly-critical when their own value of reliability is not reflected, and in turn, Explorers are dismayed by their intolerance.

More seriously, Consuls' reliance on emotions and human connections is challenged by Explorers, whose attention is easily pulled in new directions. It's hard for Consuls to understand why a good friend would put their energy elsewhere and fail to include them. Even temporary social retreat by Explorers innocently following some other sudden interest may be misinterpreted as heartless abandonment by unbalanced Consuls. This type relies on their connections for a sense of stability in their lives, and any loss of connection can feel very personal, even if not intended that way.

Disappointment goes both ways in this friendship though: unbalanced Consuls offer Explorers little support or enthusiasm for engaging the unknown, their insistence on stability and tradition often seen as hampering adventure and discovery. Despite their social natures, Consuls may not turn out to be the excitingly fun friends that Explorers seek, and Explorers don't put up with disappointment for very long.

Rebalancing Friendships with Explorers

Respecting Limits

To achieve balance within this friendship, Consuls and Explorers need to consciously respect and accept their differences. These friends may test each other, but in this there is much opportunity for growth. However, both must recognize when it is time to stop wasting energy on silent – or vocal – judgement, and instead start talking about their needs gently, respectfully, and honestly with each other. Complaining isn't communication.

When Consuls fairly communicate their true limits, Explorer friends can avoid pulling them too far out of their comfort zone. A conventional outing together, perhaps a favorite restaurant, shopping, or a movie, is a good way for these friends to share some fun in comfortably conventional environments. Explorers are all about indulgence and Consuls appreciate familiarity, so these friends are wise to share some common pleasures together.

Likewise, Consuls can stretch themselves when Explorers need company doing something unusual - Consuls rarely back down from a challenge. An easy way for Explorers to encourage Consuls to participate in less familiar activities is to involve them in the planning, and then make sure they stick to the plan. Consuls are a lot more willing to approach new things when the approach itself is well-organized and well-understood.

In any case, the importance of the friendship itself forms the common focus, with an understanding that sometimes compromises must be made for the sake of a worthy friend. Neither friend needs to lead in a direction they find uncomfortable, but they can try to follow, now and then. This kind of consideration is not automatic or easy for either Consuls or Explorers, but it is an area where both types greatly benefit from conscious improvement.

A Flexible Connection

There may also simply be times when these friends are wise to give each other some space. In this area, Consuls can learn from Explorer friends' tendency to be flexible. It may not be easy for Consuls to do, but pulling back and letting others live as they wish is a sign of tremendous respect, and true friends deserve that respect. When Explorers engage something too extreme for Consuls to support, they can practice

respectful detachment. There's no shame in letting their friends be wild and free without them for a while – they can hear the stories and laugh together afterward.

Balanced Explorers appreciate this respect, and more than that, they make sure to affirm their bond by expressing that appreciation to Consuls warmly – something very important for them to hear. Balanced Explorers respect Consuls' limits, understanding that not everyone has as much excited curiosity in the face of the unknown, and also understand their need for closeness. When Consuls need to retreat to the familiar, balanced Explorers can make another friendly offer later or about something else less unusual.

For these friends, respectfully giving each other room to be themselves is necessary, and they can come back together later for something they both enjoy. Consuls can make Explorers feel valued by finding three things they admire about them, and then telling them so. Everyone loves compliments, and social niceties are Consuls' bread and butter. By making their own company warmly inviting instead of judgmental, Consuls keep Explorers coming back for more.

Conclusion

Mutual support and shared fun are among the greatest benefits of friendship, and are major priorities to a type as warm and social as Consuls, but for all their ability to connect, they still have limits. Friendship with people who expand those limits is an integral part of their journey into growth and happiness. This type knows the value of community, and finds that not only can they be wells of support for their friends, they can themselves be elevated.

Once they come to truly know people through friendship, Consuls' assumptions and beliefs are in for some challenges, but they are up for that challenge. Applying their judicious value of fairness and kindness is an excellent way for Consuls to benefit from friendships with people who think and act differently. This type is strong enough to maintain their values of reliability and trust while also benefiting from exposure to other lifestyles and perspectives through worthy friends.

Consuls naturally build a structure of good people around themselves, finding great satisfaction and a sense of continuity in giving and receiving social support. It is not difficult for this type to form fulfilling friendships, but finding balanced ways to respect friends' differences – or to become friends with those who seem very different – is an ongoing opportunity for this type to consider.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your friendships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

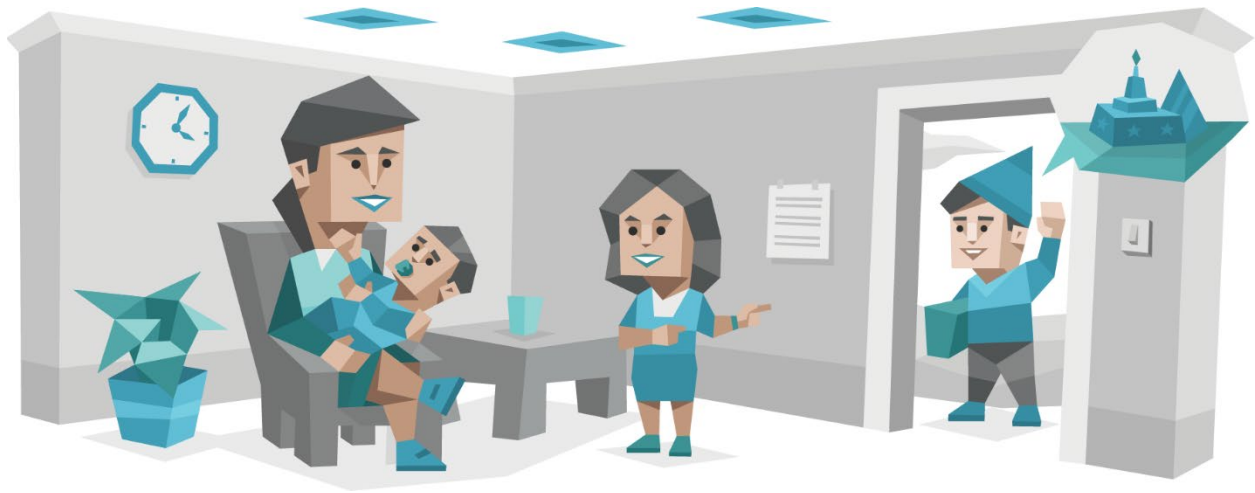
[Type Guesser \(Friendships\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your friend belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

[Personal Authenticity Test](#)

Can you be your true self with your friends and family? Let's explore how you feel about your authenticity in those circumstances.

Parenthood



Caring

Consuls' warmth and care make parenting something that often comes naturally to them. Many people with this personality type feel like parenting is the task they were born to do. Often seen as ideal parents, Consuls' sensitive nature and innate desire to build meaningful connections allows them to connect deeply with their children. They are loving and affectionate, providing their children with both emotional and practical support throughout their lives.

From the start, Consuls' altruism is apparent in their parenting approach. They ensure a safe, stable environment filled with love, care, and support. Consuls' patience comes in handy as their children learn to become more independent, testing any limit they can find. While they expect their children to be respectful and well-behaved, their expectations are well-balanced with their understanding of their children's needs and behaviors. This combination of understanding and direction balances the affection and direction that allows children to truly thrive.

Responsible and Respectable

Consuls' mantra of "hard work, tradition, respect" is best exemplified in their relationships with their children. In many ways, they are the classic 50's era parental figure – strict guardians of family traditions who have no trouble when it comes to enforcing the rules and standards they've established, while also providing stable, pragmatic wisdom to a child who needs advice. Often seen as model citizens, Consuls expect their children to carry that image, continuing the example they've set by being polite and respectful.

Consuls have a very responsibility-oriented view of life. They share a firm belief in the idea that one does what one can in order to contribute to the family and the community. This view is of course extended to their children. As soon as they are able, their children are expected to contribute in their own way, by cleaning their plates and their rooms and going to bed on time – by maintaining the order of things.

This type doesn't harbor wild, high-flying hopes of perfection for their children – Consuls are down-to-earth people and simply want to see their children develop into respected, responsible adults. But they also want their children to be decisive and capable, and that is something that can only happen when they have the chance to make their own decisions – and the chance to face the consequences of those decisions, good or bad – with the love and support of their parents.

While yielding control may be difficult, Balanced Consuls are able to exercise patience and restraint by allowing their children to fall off their bike, fail a test they didn't study for, or have their heart broken by unrequited young love. These youthful afflictions provide opportunities for parents to teach caution, resilience, and thoughtful problem-solving skills that will benefit their children for the rest of their lives.

Perfectionistic Expectations

Although they are generally understanding, Consuls have a tendency to set unrealistically high expectations for both themselves and their children. They expect that they will not just “meet their child’s needs” but will excel at this by making sure that delicious and healthy food is on the table for every meal and the house is always spotless. Anything less-than-perfect can feel like a failure for Consuls, making them constantly feel like they are not “succeeding” as a parent.

Consuls often become uncomfortable when their children aren’t constantly on their best behavior, especially in public. While they are generally understanding about their child’s capabilities, they will always promote “proper” behavior through whatever means necessary. From carrying a disobedient toddler out of a store kicking and screaming to chastising their teenager in the middle of a store, Consuls refuse to let their children “get away” with any behaviors they deem unacceptable.

Overly Controlling

With their desire to always do “what’s best” for their children, unbalanced Consuls can easily spiral into excessively controlling behavior. They are one of the most likely personality types to believe that their children should be guided in their education, and one of the least likely types to think that children need to be given freedom to develop. This system of beliefs can create a repressive environment, which prevents children from engaging their naturally curious instincts. Without the opportunity to freely explore their surroundings, pursue their interests, and make mistakes, children will never develop the ability to take initiative or bounce back from failures.

Controlling behavior has a tendency to present itself in negative ways, especially during stressful situations. Even small transgressions can seem like a personal

affront to their authority, causing offended Consul parents to become disconcerted by their children. Discipline then becomes their primary tool for keeping their children in line and making sure that they follow the rules. Grounding their teen for a month after coming home 5 minutes late once (barring other more serious behaviors) is a drastic punishment for this particular transgression.

When parental discipline is focused entirely on punishing unacceptable behaviors, children lose out on the opportunity to truly learn from their mistakes. Constant criticism of their behavior, rather than providing alternative behaviors, often materializes in children as a sense of defeat. When children consistently feel this level of frustration, they may either become withdrawn or begin acting out – feeling that they may never be able to please their parents. Whether children *should* respond this way or not isn't relevant in this situation. The fact is, they will, and it's up to Consul parents to guide their development sensibly and according to the reality of the situation. Ignoring the facts doesn't help anyone.

Set Realistic Expectations

Consul's expectations are not always in line with what is realistic or even appropriate. Allowing their children to grow and build a separate identity (while still encouraging proper behavior) is a fundamental part of both their own and their child's development. Each stage of their child's development requires adjustments in their expectations. This will be discussed in greater detail in the sections below.

The desire to feel needed is very strong for Consuls, and that desire is generally fulfilled throughout their child's early years. Unfortunately, as children get older and begin to exercise independence and develop their own sense of identity, they may reject some of the affection and input they had accepted from their parent so

willingly in the past. While this can be a frustrating experience, Consuls benefit from adjusting their expectations and focus on discovering what new and equally important role they can play in their child's life.

Consuls may find themselves sacrificing many of their own needs and desires when they become parents. While this is necessary to a certain extent, it can leave them feeling lost and uncertain about their own identity when their children leave the nest. It is helpful for both Consul parents and their children when they model healthy personal development. Engaging in a hobby, participating in a spiritual practice, or taking a class to learn something new can provide satisfaction and growth while modeling ways to develop personal understanding to children who are attempting to find their own identity.

Create Learning Opportunities

When one's nature is focused on organization and structure, it is easy to become caught up in controlling behaviors. Children certainly need structure and benefit greatly from an organized household. However, excessive control of their environment can actually result in children who are unable to regulate their own behavior. Rather than focusing purely on controlling their child, Consuls can focus on providing them with opportunities to learn how to control themselves.

A toddler will certainly spill their milk the first time they try to make cereal by themselves. A parent who shows them how to clean up their spill and how to carefully pour milk to avoid spilling experiences less frustration than one who immediately puts their toddler in time-out. Not only are they teaching them a skill, they are preventing the inevitable meltdown that occurs when a toddler child feels they are being unjustly punished. This technique takes more time up front, but saves a great

deal of time in the future as their children become more competent and confident in their abilities.

If there's anything that Consul parents hope to accomplish, it's to raise children who are hard-working, capable, and responsible, just like they are. These lessons are best taught by intentional modeling, as opposed to the "Do as I say not as I do" mentality, and allowing children to learn through trial and error. Mistakes will be made, and should be looked at as an opportunity to create a teachable moment rather than something to be punished.

Parenting for Each Stage of Development

Each stage of a child's growth presents both unique challenges and exciting milestones. Learning how to navigate these stages can seem daunting, but the opportunity to build a healthy attachment and create meaningful memories makes it worth the struggle.

Renowned psychologist Erik Erikson proposed a theory of psychosocial development that identified eight stages, five of which take place between birth and 18 years of age. It's important to remember that these stages are not set in stone and the ages listed for each stage are approximate. Children develop at their own pace and meet each milestone in their own time. The following paragraphs will briefly discuss what to expect at each stage of development as well as how the strengths and weaknesses of the Consul personality type affect their parenting at each stage.

Building Bonds (Birth–1 ½ years)

According to Erikson, the stages of infancy and early childhood last from birth until approximately 3 years of age. Children in these stages are very dependent on their parents to meet their needs. This is also when the bonds of attachment are created by meeting the child's needs, developing a trusting relationship, and promoting autonomy.

The first priority for infants in the journey to attachment is having their basic needs met. From being fed to receiving affection, infants will learn to either trust that their Consul parent will provide for them or they will suffer from a sense of mistrust in all of their subsequent relationships. If parents are inconsistent in providing for their children or are especially violent or neglectful, an extreme situation to be sure, their infants will have difficulty creating a positive, trusting attachment with their parents.

Attentive and affectionate parents, especially those who engage in consistent physical contact such as snuggling or transporting their child in a baby carrier on their body, will develop trusting, hopeful relationships with their infant and are likely to have very little difficulty building comfortable attachments.

Balanced Infant Bonding

Building Reliable Bonds

Balanced Consuls excel at providing structure for their children and will certainly be able to meet their infant's needs in this regard. Reliability is key in building a relationship with infants, and Consul parents are likely to be very attentive to their infant by reliably feeding, changing, and comforting them when necessary. Most Consuls enjoy the infant stage, where their children rely on them completely for

meeting their needs, and do not hesitate to provide for them consistently in a patient, caring way.

As parents, Consuls have an extreme sense of duty to meet their child's needs, which can motivate them when going through the extraordinarily draining infant stage. Where some parents may struggle with maintaining energy during this phase, thus creating mood swings or other inconsistent behaviors, Consuls not only survive this stage but even enjoy it. They have the ability to create a foundation for building trust and instilling hope in their infant.

Endless Energy

Infancy is an especially trying time for parents with the inevitable sleepless nights and exhaustion that are almost certainly guaranteed during this stage. Consul parents have an advantage in this regard as they are high-energy individuals, rarely tiring easily. This generous reserve of energy carries them through these especially exhausting days.

In addition to having the momentum needed to power through their sleep deprivation, Consuls' excess energy, if utilized effectively, can help to insulate them from some of issues that may be caused by exhaustion, such as feeling anxious, sad, or overwhelmed. While all new parents have these feelings to some extent (and if they are serious or continue for several days, should be discussed with a medical professional) Consuls may actually thrive on the busyness and revel in the opportunity to make order out of the chaos.

Unbalanced Infant Bonding

Take on Too Much

Although they are extraordinarily affectionate and attentive, Consul parents may have difficulty when they feel that they aren't appreciated. Consuls give tremendous energy to their family, friends, coworkers, and anyone else who seems in need of help. Adding a new child into the mix can quickly lead to burnout as well as feelings of resentment when they don't feel that their efforts are appreciated.

In addition to their obsession with helping others, Consuls are often hesitant to ever accept (let alone ask) for help, even when they truly need it. The infant and toddler years are undoubtedly some of the most challenging. The combination of high levels of stress and an unbalanced Consul's lack of willingness to seek help from others, especially combined with a lack of feeling appreciated, greatly increases the likelihood that they will suffer from burn-out, frustration, resentment, and even depression.

Struggle with Expectations

In addition to struggling with taking on too much, Consuls may have unrealistic expectations of their children in this stage. Unbalanced Consuls may believe that their infant should achieve certain milestones more quickly than is necessary or fret that their child isn't hitting milestones "on time". They may be more concerned about getting their child to sit up, roll over, feed themselves, or walk before they are truly ready, rather than appreciating their child's current abilities and engaging with them at their level.

While it is certainly exciting to see their baby roll over for the first time or sit up on their own, trying to push children to achieve these milestones early only causes frustration for both parties involved. Just because their infant isn't saying their first words at the same time as their friend's child doesn't mean that they are not on track developmentally. Development, especially at this stage, is not a measure of parental ability and both Consul parents and their infants will be much happier and more relaxed if they are allowed to grow and develop at their own pace.

Rebalancing Infant Bonding

Determine Developmental Needs

At this stage, it is important to understand that developmental milestones are approximate and are not set in stone. Additionally, children who attain certain milestones earlier are not necessarily "advanced" and those who achieve them later are not always "delayed". A child who begins speaking at nine-month-old may be hailed as brilliant while a sibling who doesn't speak until thirteen months is (incorrectly) assumed to be "behind" in development. Labeling a child as advanced or delayed, especially this early in life, can be detrimental to their development, as well as their self-esteem, as these labels often affect how others treat them.

A pediatrician or family physician is a parent's best resource for determining whether or not they should be concerned about their child's development. They can provide resources that cover what to expect at different stages regarding physical, intellectual, psychological, and behavioral development. Regular appointments with a physician will ensure that any issues are addressed as soon as possible, and this will help to put Consul parents' mind at ease.

Seek Support

Learning to balance their needs with their child's needs is one of the most important things that Consuls can do. Taking a thirty-minute bath while their partner is putting the kids to bed can help a busy Consul parent relax. Taking a relative up on their offer to baby-sit can provide the much-needed time to meet with friends for coffee. Even engaging in a deep breathing exercise for five minutes can help to clear their minds and relax their bodies. Talking to a friend or partner about their thoughts or feelings regularly can help Consuls parents both work through these feelings and spend time engaging in the relationships that are so important to them.

Additionally, learning to say no to others' requests when they don't have the time helps Consuls to find a more beneficial balance between helping others and meeting their own needs. If they are feeling unappreciated at home or overlooked by friends who may be "giving them space" to attend to their children, they should make an effort to voice these concerns. Reaching out to others and admitting vulnerability actually promotes bonding and increases understanding, which is exactly what sociable and sensitive Consul parents need.

Testing Boundaries (1 ½–3 years)

Once they are mobile, young children become very interested in exploring their environment with their senses. Crawling, walking, grabbing items, putting things in their mouth, and verbal communication are just a few of the ways that toddlers learn about the world around them.

During this stage, Consul parents must provide a safe harbor for their children while still allowing them to experience and explore their surroundings. Children who are

allowed to test boundaries yet still receive parental support and encouragement will develop a sense of autonomy. Children who are overly restricted, criticized, or made to feel guilty for their desire to test boundaries will ultimately experience a sense of shame and may suffer from feelings of incompetence or low self-worth. These feelings can last throughout their lives and may ultimately jeopardize their ability to achieve goals and develop positive character traits such as reliability or confidence.

Balanced Toddler Bonding

Supportive and Engaged

Extremely supportive, balanced Consuls make an ideal “home base” for their child during this stage as well. Their reliability and engagement ensure that their child will never feel abandoned, ignored, or unloved. Even though children at this age are incredibly independent, they still crave (and need) a trustworthy caregiver, and Consuls do not disappoint.

Consuls’ stamina and supportiveness are especially useful during the trying toddler years. While these years can certainly be challenging, balanced Consul parents enjoy promoting their child’s curiosity and independence while still maintaining a safe environment. They take pleasure in helping their children learn how to pick out their own clothes and dress themselves and how to use and manipulate toys and tools (such as forks and spoons). As natural teachers, helping their children learn to become self-reliant and competent is one of the Consul parents’ greatest joys.

Provide Safe Boundaries

Although they prefer to run a tight ship, balanced Consuls excel at setting up reasonable boundaries that allow a toddler to feel as though they are unrestricted,

but that feels controlled to the parent. The perception that they are allowed to play or explore freely is especially important for toddlers working to build a sense of autonomy. Something as simple as setting up a space where their toddler can color, glue, and paint without worrying about the mess or allowing them to pick out their own books at the library can feel incredibly liberating.

The toddler years are the first in which Consul parents need to fully utilize their natural ability to determine what boundaries their child needs and how to successfully create them. Providing a safe, structured environment gives Consuls the sense of control that they need to remain confident. When set up properly, this structure can expand and contract with their child's changing needs and abilities.

Unbalanced Toddler Bonding

Authority Issues

This stage can be especially challenging for unbalanced Consul parents as they have difficulty accepting their child's desire to push boundaries. From insisting on dressing themselves (and putting their uncoordinated clothing on backwards) to refusing to eat any form of fresh produce (or any healthy food for that matter), toddlers often seem as though they are challenging their parents' authority at every turn.

Unbalanced Consul parents will be offended by a child who appears to challenge their authority or does not display expected behavior, especially in public. Hierarchies are to be respected, especially between parent and child, and when their authority is questioned or ignored Consul parents are likely to become frustrated. It doesn't help that their toddler will likely acquire a new favorite word, "No", that they will use forcefully and frequently. Consuls do not approve of being challenged and may find this stage of child development to be one of the most difficult to reconcile.

Constantly Intervening

On the other hand, Consuls thrive on feeling needed and, when unbalanced, can become completely focused on meeting their child's every need. In an attempt to "help" their child, unbalanced Consuls may inadvertently raise a child who struggles with issues such as poor self-regulation and a lack of initiative. Constant interventions at the toddler stage can result in the expectation that everything will be done for them and can result in learned helplessness, or a sense of powerlessness that results in a lack of initiative.

Spoon-feeding a toddler who can use a spoon well enough on their own or dressing their toddler rather than letting them attempt to dress themselves because it's "easier this way" prevents children from gaining these important skills. Toddlerhood sets the stage for competence and robbing them of the ability to gain these skills will prevent them from even attempting to develop their abilities in the future.

Rebalancing Toddler Bonding

Promoting Responsible Independence

Pushing boundaries and defiant behavior are hallmarks of this stage and, while they can be extraordinarily frustrating, they are a necessary part of developing autonomy. Saying "no" is a way to establish boundaries, and developing boundaries is a fundamental component to identity development. Consul parents who understand that their children are establishing autonomy and are not intentionally looking to usurp their authority will have more success in setting their own boundaries with their child.

Just because children are learning to set their own boundaries doesn't mean that parents should allow them to get away with demanding behavior. Rather, understanding *why* their children are engaging in this behavior can prevent some of the Consul's negative reactionary responses. For example, a Consul parent may become immediately upset by a toddler who yells "No" when they tell them it's time to leave the park. Rather than demanding they leave without warning, the Consul parent can offer a countdown instead. "We're leaving in ten minutes. Five minutes left before we go! Ok, one minute left, finish up." This allows the child to complete any activities that they want and ensures that they understand their parent's expectations.

Focus on Long-Term Growth

Doing too much for their children can be just as damaging as inconsistent discipline, but with some of their own personal discipline, Consul parents can prevent or undo any negative consequences of their constant interventions. The most effective way to do this is by tapping into their natural desire for structure and an innate talent for organizing people.

Consul parents can encourage their toddler's development by regularly looking for opportunities to promote growth and autonomy. Letting a toddler pick out what they want to wear (from two or three options), letting them pour their own cereal, or allowing them to wash their own hands and face after mealtime (while feeling free to clean up anything they missed after) will not only give them a sense of autonomy but teach them practical skills as well.

Thirst for Knowledge (3–5 years)

The preschool years, from approximately 3 to 5 years of age, are a prime time for brain development and children at these stages accumulate knowledge at an extraordinary rate. Children absorb information like sponges through constant activity and a seemingly infinite range of questions. Learning at this stage takes place through play, especially the unstructured kind, and lots of social interaction with family and peers. Creativity is also exercised extensively through imaginary play and make-believe games and stories.

In order to master this stage, children must be given the opportunity to not only make some of their own decisions but also be allowed to initiate activities, ask questions – and receive answers – and lead others in exploration play. Children who are not given these opportunities or are made to feel as though their constant questions or childish make-believe games are annoying experience feelings of guilt, frustration, and a lack of competence. Consequently, they may suffer from poor self-control or a lack of initiative.

Balanced Preschool Relationship

Natural Teachers

Balanced Consuls are both patient and strong-willed, which is helpful when parenting curious, active young children. They happily answer their preschool child's seemingly ceaseless stream of questions and take great pleasure in modeling practical skills, such as sweeping, picking up after themselves or helping to fold laundry. Imparting their knowledge in a practical, useful way is one of the Consul parent's greatest strengths.

Practical skills and academics are not the only topics that Consuls value – instilling a sense of character into their children from a young age is just as important to them as any set of skills. Consul parents teach their children to respect authority, from teachers to elderly neighbors. They insist on honesty, and are the type of parents who will encourage their preschooler to not only apologize to a neighbor who's flowers they dug up but also help them to replant those flowers. Consul parents feel it is their obligation as an upstanding citizen to instill these important principles through modeling and consistent reinforcement.

Promote Confidence

Consuls are generally confident in their interpersonal abilities, and rightly so as they are one of the most dedicated and outgoing types. As a naturally social type, Consul parents actively encourage their own children to develop their own interpersonal skills. This is an incredibly helpful mindset to model and pass on to children, especially during the preschool and school years where they are increasing both confidence and competence.

For example, at this stage they expect their children to interact well with other children and will work with them to use problem-solving skills to deal with any difficult-to-play-with children that they encounter (“Ask Jimmy if you can take turns pushing each other on the swing, then maybe he will let you have a turn as well”). If this approach doesn't work, they will provide additional guidance for their children to act upon (“Maybe you could see if Jimmy wants to play on the teeter totter with you instead?”). If all else fails, balanced Consuls will teach their children how to withdraw from a situation or may intervene directly if necessary (“Jimmy still isn't playing with you nicely? Maybe you could see if Suzie wants to play with you on the slide instead?”).

Unbalanced Preschool Relationship

Lacking Flexibility

Although they love promoting learning, unbalanced Consuls may have difficulty following their children's lead during the preschool years. These Consuls struggle with the spontaneous needs that children often present at especially inopportune times. As very schedule-driven, timely individuals, they are annoyed by preschoolers who are more interested in their coloring page than getting their shoes on when it's time to leave. Temper tantrums and bathroom emergencies derail the best laid plans and Consuls who focus on maintaining tight schedules frustrate both themselves and their preschoolers.

Unstructured play is another area that can bring out a Consul parents lack of flexibility. Unbalanced Consuls may fall prey to the idea that free play is not as valuable as "educational" play or structured activities, and may focus their energy on providing learning experiences rather than allowing their children to take the lead. Combined with their love of routine and structure, these parents may leave little room for their children learn how to entertain themselves or make their own discoveries.

Exceptionally Overbearing

Unbalanced Consuls tend to be a very dominant personality type, often attempting to control their child's behavior and schedule as much as possible. The tendency for Consul parents to be dominant and overbearing can be especially damaging to children who are Introverted and may struggle with forced social interaction. The Extraverted Consul may mistake an Introverted child's lack of desire to interact with

peers at the park as a serious lack of social skills rather than a completely legitimate personality trait.

In reality, Introverted children are not any less socially competent, they are just more easily overwhelmed by external stimuli, such as a noisy, crowded park filled with strangers. Forcing them to frequently engage in overwhelming activities will likely lead to children engaging in temper tantrums or withdrawing into themselves and refusing to interact with others to an even greater degree.

Rebalancing Preschool Relationship

Increase Flexibility

Learning to gauge their children's developmental readiness can be difficult for Consuls who have become too focused on timely achievement. Rather than constantly worrying about their children's development, Consul parents can focus on allowing them to develop them organically. Children do not need an excessive number of play dates, "educational" toys and games, or structured learning periods throughout the day. Playing with simple toys allows them to engage their imagination, the key building block for developing their ability to gain knowledge as they grow.

One way that Consul parents can promote both learning and autonomy without being overly controlling is to allow their children to engage in free play without any agenda. Send them outside to play without any toys and watch as the space around them turns into an imaginary forest full of magical creatures. Provide toys that encourage creation rather than mere interaction, such as Legos, modeling clay, or wooden blocks. Allow children to play pretend with friends during a play date rather than planning a specific activity for them. Children who are allowed to engage in free

play at this stage will be much more likely to seek out learning experiences on their own throughout their life.

Understand Different Traits

While it is impossible to know a child's personality type before their brain has finished developing (which is usually around their mid-twenties) it is relatively easy to determine if a child is Introverted or Extraverted. Do they prefer to spend time alone over playing with others? Are they generally quiet or reserved? Answering yes to these questions could indicate that their child is an Introvert and therefore much less interested in constant social interaction or engaging in multiple group-based activities throughout the day.

Consul parents will be able to interact with an Introverted child more effectively when they understand that their behaviors aren't a result of poor social skills but, rather, a different way of processing their environment. For example, these children often prefer activities that focus on smaller groups such as swimming lesson as opposed to larger team sports like soccer.

They also need adequate time to recharge after social interactions such as birthday parties or play dates. Consuls who understand and accept their child's unique needs will, in turn, promote the confidence and compassion that their preschool child needs to truly thrive.

Creating Competence (5–12 years)

The early school years are an important period of skill development for young children. Not only are they still constantly absorbing new information, they are also working on becoming proficient in increasingly complex areas, from relationships to

mathematics to athletics. Children who are both challenged and supported in these areas will flourish in both their abilities as well as their self-confidence.

If they do not receive consistent support, children at this stage can begin to feel inferior to their peers and are less likely to develop long-term goals or work towards achieving them. On the other hand, if they are not sufficiently challenged, children in this stage can begin to feel overly-confident in themselves and their abilities and will lack modesty and compassion towards others.

Balanced School-Age Relationship

Supportive and Efficient

Striving to be effective students themselves, Consuls will encourage their child to develop efficient study habits, maintain good attendance, and engage in extracurricular activities or student groups. The school years, whether spent in a “traditional” educational environment or not, focus on the development of skills and obtaining proficiency in basic academics. Consul parents provide the necessary structure to help their children succeed, whether it is helping with homework, finding a tutor, or even just providing consistent support for a child who may be frustrated.

Consuls, while very supportive and encouraging of their children, balance these traits out very well with their focus on personal responsibility. They are no strangers to hard work themselves and encourage children of all levels and abilities to achieve their personal best. Consul parents are proud of their children’s accomplishments, however, they loath arrogance and do not hesitate to call out children who are behaving this way. Being a good student is expected, and Consuls support their children in fulfilling that expectation.

Excellent Mentors

The school years are a time of intense learning, and Consuls are natural teachers who have no trouble modeling the skills needed for success in academics as well as real-world skills. Consul parents do not shy away from teaching their children the value of hard work and the importance of traits such as dependability and persistence.

Practical skills are just as important as academics, and Consuls take every opportunity to pass these skills on. In fact, these teaching moments may be one of the most meaningful ways that Consul parents spend time bonding with their child. Working on the car together, showing them how to make cookies, and teaching them how to do laundry are all fantastic opportunities to model skills and continue to build relationships with their children. Relationships are built on quality time spent together, and helping their children learn how to succeed in life is unequivocally high-quality time.

Unbalanced School-Age Relationship

Overly Concerned with Success

Consuls can become overly concerned about making sure that their children are truly “good kids”, meaning they are successful in school, socially connected, engaged in hobbies, and well-behaved. This mentality can prove especially detrimental to children in this stage by indicating that these markers are more important than holistic growth or their child’s personal interests. From music programs to swimming lessons, unbalanced Consul parents place a great deal of emphasis on extracurricular activities that they believe will help their children be “successful” without appreciating that they are actually overburdening them.

Consul parents who elevate their expectations to this extent may experience emotional outbursts from their children when they become fed up by an excessive focus on how they appear to others rather than how they feel. Less confident children may struggle to voice their frustration and, instead of rebelling, will become overly dependent on their parent's approval. This may result in difficulty setting their own goals and can lead to a struggle to achieve a healthy level of independence later in life.

Excessively Critical

Another area where Consul parents struggle is their emphasis on success over "learning how to learn". True learning is often a product of failure – which is a hard concept for many parents to grasp. A child who is struggling in math class but, through hard work and time with a tutor, manages to raise their grade from an F to a C, is learning. Parents who are overly focused on success, perhaps in the form of all A's on a report card, may not view their child's C as proof of learning, regardless of the great strides that they have made.

Unbalanced Consul parents are often quick to point out faults in their child's performance or behavior rather than appreciating or acknowledging their children's strengths and achievements. They may think "They're already getting good grades in English, why should I worry about praising them for getting an A on their paper? It's expected." This can have a devastating effect on children who feel that their parent only sees their faults and, as a result, they may become withdrawn or start acting out – believing that nothing they can do is good enough to please their overly critical parent anyway.

Rebalancing School-Age Relationship

Construct Values Together

As much as Consul parents may want their children to succeed in specific areas, it's more important that they focus on promoting their overall well-being. They are very devoted to their principles, especially responsibility, duty, and social involvement, as well as their children. Using their devotion, Consuls can create a definition of success that embraces a more holistic idea of what success truly means.

Consuls should encourage their children to develop their own principles and pursue their own definition of a successful life. This can be done by looking to the institutions that have played an important part in their lives, such as their faith, their family, or a club that they are involved in. It's important to let their child develop their own values rather than expecting them to emulate their parents. While a Consul's values may be noble, their child's sense of identity depends on their ability to determine their own values with the support and understanding of their parents.

Love Them Where They Are

Well-meaning Consuls place high expectations on their children hoping that this will encourage them to be successful. Unfortunately, when the focus is constantly on what is expected parents are apt to miss out on what their child has already achieved. What children need most from their parents is unconditional love and acceptance and Consul parents are more than capable of providing this for their children.

Consuls who are prone to fixating on mistakes or failures can turn this behavior around with one simple habit – a gratitude practice. It may sound simplistic but simply taking the time to intentionally find three things each day that they are

grateful for is an incredibly effective way to stop the vicious cycle of criticism. Taking a few minutes each day to tell their child what they appreciate about them (I'm proud of you for picking up your room without being asked; I am grateful that you are so passionate about drawing; And I am thankful that you passed your spelling test.) will ensure that children feel both loved and supported.

Find Thyself (12–18 years)

Adolescence is the transition from childhood to adulthood where adolescents focus on developing their own distinct sense of identity. This transitional period centers around the individual's sense of what their roles are in their relationships with themselves, others, and society in general. To determine their roles, adolescents in this stage begin the all-important process of identifying their personal values and beliefs. Educational and future career goals are made and relationships are developed based on how they align with these values and beliefs, making this a pivotal, foundational stage for the rest of their lives.

Balanced Adolescent Relationships

Promote Positive Principles

During this stage of identity development, adolescents need the support and understanding of their parents more than ever. Balanced Consuls parents encourage their adolescent child's growth by promoting positive principles, such as responsibility, integrity, and reliability, while providing them with freedom to explore these principles in their own way. As difficult as it can be, balanced Consuls understand the importance of assisting their children in the process of personal development and will do so to the best of their ability.

Regardless of the struggles that they may face during this tumultuous time, Consuls remain patient and steadfast in their devotion to their children. Their reliability, both in their affection towards their children and in the promotion of their positive principles, provides a solid foundation for Consuls parents and their children. This foundation allows identity-seeking children to venture further into self-discovery while still feeling a sense of stability and love.

Honest and Dependable

Adolescence is a tumultuous stage for most children as they attempt to determine who they are and who they want to be. These discoveries are often made through trial and error, which means that many mistakes will be made. Consul parents' dependability and honesty are indispensable during this stage, as they help their children cope with the many challenges they will face. Honesty is necessary to help them learn from their mistakes – an adolescent who skips class needs to know the potential consequences of this behavior before it's too late.

If Consul parents can develop an unbreakable trust with their adolescent by maintaining that same dependability and frank honesty when their adolescent comes to them with something truly serious – getting pregnant, getting suspended or expelled, or milder stuff like a rough breakup – they can establish themselves as a true source of stability and wisdom for life when their child needs it most. As chaotic and terrifying as some of these situations may seem, balanced Consuls can tap into their confidence and dependability and place their focus on those aspects of the situation that they have the ability to help with. They can treat the adolescent with respect, but balanced Consuls are still the wise, understanding adult in the room.

Unbalanced Adolescent Relationship

Overly Traditional

Unbalanced Consuls may have difficulty accepting certain aspects of their child's newfound identity during this stage. Their strong principles often coincide with a preference for "traditional", or familiar, roles and a child who pushes the boundaries of these roles too dramatically could both shock and frustrate a Consul parent. Making sure that their child's values align with their personal and family principles is more important to an unbalanced Consul than their adolescent's desire to "find themselves".

Consuls' expectations of childhood are based on their past experiences, and societal changes that take place with each new generation can be both confusing and frustrating. Their adolescent children may appear almost unrecognizable as they attempt to determine if the principles and traditions that they were raised with truly represent who they hope to become. With their principles challenged, unbalanced Consul parents may attempt to remove anything that appears to be negatively influencing their child from banning social media to prohibiting applying to certain colleges. These authoritarian restrictions are likely to result in eventual rebellion and potentially damaged relationships with their adolescent.

Difficulty Letting Go

The adolescent stage also requires that children become more independent from their parents, making critical life choices on their own and relying less on their parents for support. Unbalanced Consul parents can struggle with feelings of rejection if they believe that their child no longer needs them or desires their affection. Consuls who thrive on being their child's caretaker or identify primarily as

a parent may take the loss of their control or influence in this role personally. This can result in overbearing or authoritative behaviors that may result in an attempt to prevent their children from becoming more fully independent.

Further, any criticism that they receive from their child, especially when it has to do with their deeply held principles, can be especially damaging to this people-pleasing type. Unbalanced Consuls who feel that their personal or family values are being criticized or rejected in any way become very defensive. For example, an adolescent who decides that they no longer want to attend church services with their family will often result in an unbalanced Consul believing they have completely failed as a parent because their child is “rejecting” their values. They may react by engaging in passive-aggressive behaviors, attempting to subtly guilt or shame their child into behaving the way they want them to.

Rebalancing Adolescent Relationship

Model Personal Growth and Understanding

Understanding is key during this stage as their child’s needs change and their independence grows with each year. This stage requires a constant rebalancing of responsibility and expectations as their adolescent child strives to become more capable, responsible, mature, and independent. It can be difficult for Consuls to decrease the amount of control they exert over their children – not necessarily because they view them as incapable but, rather, that they genuinely believe that they know best.

It’s helpful for parents at this stage to encourage their children to develop their own personal values and, while they can draw from family values to do so, should be allowed to privately focus on embracing values that are meaningful to their individual

journey. Most importantly, Consuls can take this opportunity to engage in some self-reflection as well, perhaps even taking time to discover a meaningful hobby, find a club or class to join, or become more involved in a community group or project. The self-discovery process doesn't end at adolescence, and Consuls who allow themselves to be inspired by their child's growth and development will improve their own as well.

Promote Healthy Independence

The adolescent stage requires that children become more independent from their parents, which is especially difficult for Consuls who thrive on being their child's caretaker or identify primarily as a parent. Rather than taking this desire for independence as a personal affront, Consul parents should learn to both celebrate and promote their adolescent child's development.

Practice encouraging children to take responsibility for their decisions and celebrate any progress they make towards becoming a self-sufficient adult. Finding new ways to engage at this stage that take advantage of their burgeoning skills is a wonderful way to bond. Allowing their child who has just received their license to drive them to the store in the "nice" car provides quality time with their child *and* time to practice this important skill. Parents who encourage their children's growth are much more likely to have meaningful bonds with them throughout their lives than those who look to promote dependence.

Conclusion

Parenting is one of the most challenging experiences that anyone will face, regardless of their personality type. Consuls have their own unique strengths and weaknesses

that they need to leverage in order to build positive, proactive relationships with their children. There is tremendous potential for personal development that takes place when one becomes a parent, and Consuls can gain a much deeper understanding of themselves and others if they use this opportunity to do so.

That being said, the advice provided above is based on general growth stages for children and basic strengths and weaknesses that many Consuls share. Every child is different and parents are the best judge of what their child needs. The advice above should be used in a way that works best for each family without adding additional stress, frustration, or burden. For special situations, such as behavioral or medical issues, it is best to consult with a professional pediatrician or pediatric psychologist to come up with a plan that works best for everyone involved.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your role as a parent? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Parenting Styles Test](#)

Whether you have children already or hope to become a parent in the future, this test offers you useful insights into your parenting style.

[Type Guesser \(Parent\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your parent belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

[Type Guesser \(Child\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your teenage child belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Academic Path



Consuls learn best in an environment that applies the following three principles: structure, community, and pragmatism. Consuls thrive when these three principles are combined in the classroom but are likely to struggle if even one is absent. By identifying the strengths and weaknesses in their processes, Consuls can not only become more effective learners but better teachers as well.

How Consuls Learn

Their Ideal Instructor

Consuls prefer their instructors be the clearly-defined head of the classroom. Student Consuls trust that a teacher is before them because of proper certification, training, and experience. In turn, they dislike muddling of the hierarchy. Consider, for example, teachers who try to be “friends” with students. Though Consuls are naturally friendly and enjoy spending time with their instructors, they would prefer if their teacher remained professional.

Consuls' ideal instructor sets goals and clear objectives. Even if the tasks assigned are routine and repetitive, Consuls won't if there is a clear reason for it. Their ideal learning environment includes timelines, adherence to the syllabus, classes that allow them to interact with their peers, and goals that can be achieved through dedicated studying.

Developed Focus

Studying is something that Consuls do very well. This type utilizes traditional learning methods like rote memorization, flashcards, paying close attention to the required text, and *always* make time to do the work. These aren't innate talents, however. Consuls, even those who have short attention spans, practice sitting down and focusing at the task at hand. This includes studying strategies like sectioning out time – 25 minutes of straight studying with 5-minute breaks – or experimenting with their hours to find when they're most productive.

They want to focus so that they can do well according to their community's standards. Consuls strive to deliver good results, because they feel satisfied when they can make their family, friends, and various mentors proud. In turn, they don't readily understand those who don't share the same drive to study and do well in school, and this lack of understanding can lead to irritation within the normally warm type.

For the Community

Consuls' enjoy being academically successful because it places them in good societal standing. They are proud that they're seen as competent and dependable. In fact, their greatest aspirations include making their family proud and being a successful member of the community. That is why they strive for careers that their community hold in high esteem – town doctor, nurse, or a teacher for example. Traditionally,

these positions are more readily available to students who do well in school, and it is for this very reason that Consuls strive to meet the academic requirements.

Community is a cornerstone for Consuls, which is why they seek to involve themselves deeply within their own. This can be something small-scale, like a close friend group, or large-scale, like actively sitting in on their academic institution's board meetings.

In small-scale groups, Consuls' are likely to check the emotional temperature of their peers. They may ask questions like *'Are you okay?'* or *'Do you need help?'*. In these situations, they may chat with their classmates about any and everything – from their most recent breakup, the daily gossip, or their frustration with an instructor's methods.

If they're not working on their personal connections within the community, then Consuls are physically assisting those around them by helping to wash dirty science beakers, sharing their friend's *'Vote for Me'* poster, or taking notes for an absent group member.

Learning for Career Applicability

Consuls are pragmatic when it comes to academics. They are drawn to subjects where they're able to learn skills for a future career, which is why they prefer topics that heavily incorporate practical application. This might include applied mathematics, communications, and home economics. For example, a Consul who aspires to the medical field may focus on Organic Chemistry while in high school with the intent to build a strong foundation for further education.

They may be dismissive of abstract and philosophical courses because of the lack of real-world application – consider Poetry, for example. Consuls certainly enjoy reading some choice works, but dedicating themselves to free-form creative expression can feel exasperating. If a debate or lecture goes on too long without landing on something useful, they may view the whole experience as wasteful, but they'll tolerate it to honor academic requirements. They're happy to have fun in school, but Consuls prize focus, too – academic tangents, even enjoyable ones, often make them feel like they're drifting.

Balanced Learning Habits

Personal Fulfillment

Consuls learn so that they can be contributing members of society. These warm people take pride in supporting the established order and do what is necessary to keep things moving in the right direction. Consuls build upon the foundation their society deems successful, try to fit into the culture, and mend things where they can. Every community has gaps, and Consuls learn what is necessary to fill those voids.

Balanced Consuls take these goals to heart, but also understand that while it's important to meet societal standards and expectations, it is equally important to fulfill their personal needs. Balancing community duties and personal satisfaction can manifest in an adult who is, say, a top-level teacher who dedicates their life to their students, but who also take the time for an hour-long, once-a-week cooking class to learn how to braise a turkey properly.

Responsible Work Ethic

Consuls are very hard workers who have trained themselves to maintain focus. They dislike the idea of not fulfilling their commitments and obligations – even if they didn't ask for them – and don't dismiss deadlines lightly. They complete all tasks to the best of their ability, as they would feel anxious doing otherwise.

That said, balanced Consuls aren't keen on sacrificing their health to meet a goal. They do what they can, but avoid things like all-nighters or skipping meals. Instead, they schedule in time to commit the effort needed to succeed, but also to sleep. They also recognize when “good enough” is good enough, setting aside unrealistic perfectionism in favor of what gets the job done.

Contrary to their strong sense of personal responsibility, balanced Consuls also let themselves cut loose with a night on the town with a group of friends. They balance a social life against their academics – if they're putting in the effort to do well, they recognize that they've earned a break. It's as the saying goes – “everything in moderation, including moderation.”

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Loss of Independence

Consuls take pride in how they appear to their friends, colleagues, and community, and, most of all, their family. While they have difficulty admitting it, they are very concerned with their community's expectations.

People have two primary motivations – internal and external. The internal motivation is based on what a person wants from life, while external is based on what society tells them what they should want. Unbalanced Consuls follow the latter in excess.

Take, for example, Consuls choosing a specific university because their family has a long-standing tradition of attending, and not because they feel it is the best choice for them.

Following what others want is an issue, because, at the end of the day, Consuls' academic needs remain unfulfilled. They'll spend their time meeting other's expectations that they don't take the time to discover who they are as individuals. *What are they talented at? What do they have a passion for? Where are areas they can improve upon?* – these are all very important questions that Consuls won't be able to answer if their sole focus is on fulfilling someone else's academic goals.

Expectation Overload

Consuls' expectations – being straight-A students, getting a respectable job, and never getting in trouble – come from a lifetime of meeting other's expectations (particularly their family's).

When unbalanced, Consuls will give an arm and a leg to meet expectations. They'll cause themselves undue stress worrying about deadlines and assignments or push themselves to the limit to balance all their obligations. This can look like Consuls giving up their entire weekend to focus on the studies they couldn't complete during the week due to extracurriculars. They want to meet the expectations that their community has placed on their shoulders, even if these expectations are implausible, if not downright impossible.

Both obligations and expectations give something, and they take something. They give a sense of certainty, and there's no doubt about how people should conduct their lives in their presence. But this certainty can come at a high price: A life lived more narrowly than needed, and experiences missed. If Consuls aren't exacting of

themselves, they can make these expectations work. However, rigid and excessive expectations can lead to constant disappointment.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Learning for Personal Fulfillment

When weighing what they want against what society tells them they want, Unbalanced Consuls tend to prioritize the latter. This can lead to them feeling unfulfilled, and, at times, resentful. Instead, Consuls can focus more on meeting their internal needs before meeting external needs, and ultimately live healthier lives.

They can start by doing things that are fun, “unnecessary”, but still useful to their academic careers. This should be relatively easy for Consuls, as this type isn’t afraid of bold moves – as long as they’re also sensible moves. They’ll move cross-country for a lucrative career, they’ll buy a house that’s on sale for a low price in an otherwise expensive neighborhood, they’ll get married if they meet the person of their dreams, but none of this is done on a whim.

When adapting boldness to academics, one way they can go about things is to learn about a subject they thought was interesting in elementary school that also ties into their general course requirements. For example, having an interest in the stars when young, then taking Astronomy to fulfill a science requirement (even if their major is administration).

By making changes little by little, Consuls may at some point gather the courage to take a particularly big leap – like going off to a University that they enjoy (but isn’t particularly prestigious), and refusing to let the expectations of society be the deciding factor. There will always be plenty of obligations in life, but narrowing them

to only to those that are useful and relevant – and giving themselves leeway along the edges – can bring all manner of freedom.

Putting Themselves First

Unhealthy Consuls will go out of their way to meet the expectations of those around them, and ignore their own desires in the process (and in more extreme cases, be completely unaware of those desires). A valuable skill that Consuls develop is putting themselves first.

Putting themselves before others may seem selfish for these dutiful types, but learning to do so will lead to a more fulfilling life. Consuls can start by first acknowledging their desires. Not the desires of their parents, or their family, or their friends, but what genuinely makes *them* happy. For example, they can begin a feelings journal, and write in it three times in a week.

In this journal, they will try to capture their current moods, and trace their moods to events occurring at that time. They will then try to seek out the triggers for these moods, and then write down the lessons they've learned about themselves. The purpose of this journal is to increase self-knowledge. An example of an entry can be:

July 13, Satisfied, content, and inspired. Went to a craft show and was surprised by how much I liked it. Currently thinking about learning how to crochet. Imagining all the gifts I could make for my family. Feeling hopeful and excited.

Potential Lesson: I enjoy crafting, and it's something I'd like to keep learning about when I have time available.

Consuls in High School

Even as teenagers, Consuls are, typically, the ideal student. They're dedicated and polite, work to satisfy their instructor's expectations and enjoy working with their peers. While other students groan at the thought of going to school, Consuls flourish in the structured world of high school. As teens, they're not necessarily over-concerned with the future, but are simply following the established path. In high school, Consuls may benefit from their adherence to this path, however, this benefit could also be their greatest challenge.

Consuls tend to be social butterflies in high school. They do their best to get along well with others, and seldom have confrontations with their classmates. Like most people their age, Consuls have small groups of intimate friends, but they're also often proud of their popularity. Balanced Consuls happily intermingle with and include a broad range of groups and individuals. They tend to be popular people, and it isn't unusual to see Consuls voted Prom Queen or King, or "Student of the Year." However, less balanced Consuls can be mean-spirited to those who don't conform, which is responsible for the catty Consul stereotype.

Balanced High School Learning Habits

Peeking Outside the Box

Consuls excel within systems where structure and rules are enforced. This is why high school, with all its regimented glory, can be a great place for this type to demonstrate their success. However, Balanced Consuls understand that life outside their home and their walls may not be so narrow, which is why they take the time to explore options they find interesting. They look outside their own world to learn about alternate options they hadn't realized existed. For this, they draw on their wide

social connections to help them realize unconventional, but fascinating, paths. For example, that a teenage girl can pursue robotics software, too, and that there's nothing wrong with a teenage boy exploring poetry.

Balanced Consuls accomplish all necessary courses and meet reasonable expectations, but they also make sure to make time or invest more in the subjects they genuinely enjoy. Consuls who enjoy their Chemistry class can join the after-school Chemistry Club. They make sure to take the time to discover their passions and interests, develop their identity as well as any teenager can, rather than relying on the identity their community puts upon them.

Healthy Boundaries

As with other Sentinels, one of Consuls' greatest strengths in high school is their capacity to care for their fellow students. This isn't sweeping compassion as much as it is making sure the practical needs of their peers are met. If another student reaches out for help, Consuls try to support them to the best of their ability. Balanced Consuls who excel in a subject might help tutor a struggling student, especially if it means they can both get their homework done.

However, balanced Consuls make sure to distinguish between friendliness and being taken advantage of. They know that their tendency to be kind can be mistaken for weakness, but even then, they make it a point to be patient, yet assertive with any classmates with dubious intentions. A balanced Consul would stop a peer from cheating off their homework, because they believe that there's more merit in learning on one's own than copying answers and learning nothing in the process.

Unbalanced High School Learning Habits

Doing Only What's Expected

Consuls are dutiful and committed, driven to meet the expectations placed upon their shoulders. While this often works in their favor, it can also turn against them. This becomes evident when they, so focused on meeting requirements, miss out on doing the things they want and enjoy.

Finding joy in learning is important to the academic process, and Consuls may find that they have lost that joy somewhere along the way as they struggle to meet everyone's wants but their own. Unbalanced Consuls may study to do well on a standardized test, but find they have learned nothing outside the bounds of that test.

Consuls also run the risk of not learning what they like or enjoy. They may never let themselves find their passion or talents while they're still in high school, which could lead to steeper challenges later on in work or higher education.

Too Diligent

Consuls are likely to work from the first day of high school to the day they graduate. They work hard and diligently meet all the requirements put in front of them. Other students may slack off when the work becomes too predictable and easy or when they get toward the end of high school. Consuls do not. They continue to work to their highest level until they leave.

While that may sound like a dream come true to many educators, there is a dark side. Consuls face enormous pressure to do what is expected and may be inclined to sacrifice their joys and needs to meet certain standards. If success is determined to

be a perfect grade average, then Consuls may sacrifice their health (sleep, for example) to study.

Even if they don't feel well, Consuls may be reluctant to take time off, as they see it as their duty to attend to their education no matter what. This rarely bodes well, and Consuls may find that their pursuit of diligence has left them worn out. This exhaustion can lead to slipping grades, lessened ambitions, or unhappiness.

Rebalancing High School Learning Habits

Patience and Understanding

Unbalanced Consuls have the tendency to be judgmental of those who don't follow tradition and community norms. Classic examples of this in high school are the "mean girl" or the "bully jock", but it can also be the rejection of the "class clown" in a serious, buttoned-up academy, or criticizing a female student who embraces traditional femininity in an alternative, women's studies course.

Because teenage Consuls fit in very well with their environment, they may hold frustration for people who don't uphold the same social and academic standards. They might think "Why can't you just do the work?" or "Is it so hard for you to sit quietly in class and listen?" They may criticize these people without taking the time to consider the other person's life, and what else could be going on beyond the demands of the classroom.

Consuls will let this perceived offender know how things should be done. They don't do it to be mean, but because they think this person will genuinely benefit from changing their ways. The problem with this is that people, more often than not, don't want to change and are likely to see Consuls' attempt to do so as irritating. Also,

Consuls shouldn't seek to change people either, but instead develop patience and understanding.

They can begin developing these traits by cultivating curiosity about people they deem as 'other'. Consuls may see a person and determine that what they're doing is wrong. While this instant judgment may seem easier than getting to know the person, it would better serve Consuls to cultivate a curiosity about this person and their ways in order to avoid future confrontation.

Once a week, young Consuls can have a conversation with another student outside their immediate peer group. This conversation should require more than a brief chat about the weather, and more of a casual investigation as to why the other person prefers to do things the way they do. Consuls may be surprised to find that the other's choices are ideal for that person's life, and that adopting Consuls' own point of view would only make things more difficult.

Developing School-Life Balance

High school is difficult. With the added in pressures of the future, parents, and extracurriculars, it can be exhausting to even the laziest of people, and downright back-breaking to hardworking Consuls. Consuls are always looking to do their best in whatever they commit to, and if something has to give, they sacrifice themselves to sustain their other obligations.

Sacrificing themselves is not the way to go. Here, young Consuls can develop healthy school life balance by creating a schedule. Creating this schedule will not only boost their productivity, but allow them time to hang out with friends, time to be alone and relax, and enjoy their lives as teenagers rather than breaking their backs to meet unrealistic expectations.

They can do this by creating a fixed schedule. Work when they need to work, and rest when they need to rest. This becomes possible by dedicating time to study, and then *stopping* when that time is over.

An example of this would be one hour of dedicated studying time during school hours (study hall, perhaps), and two hours after school. In those two hours, Consuls should focus on the most important tasks first – an essay due next week, five math equations, 30-minutes of assigned reading – and then close everything once those two hours are up.

During those two hours, distractions should be eliminated. A good place to start would be turning off their phone, logging out of social media, and removing themselves from social situations that would keep them from doing their work.

After this time, Consuls can dedicate their time extracurricular activities, or sitting down to finally finish the TV show they'd been putting off for two months.

Work or College?

Go to college? Or go into the workforce? This fork-in-the-road decision plagues all young adults as they prepare to leave the swaddling comfort of high school. And while personality type is not the only factor that goes into making this choice, it can be very important variable.

The question many Consuls have is whether it's more practical to enter a trade early to begin establishing a life or to bolster future security by obtaining a degree.

Core to Consuls' consideration is familial expectations, especially regarding what their family perceives as stable and successful. Consuls find themselves hard pressed

to defy a family full of college graduates, or, on the other hand, a family full of people who immediately entered the workforce. Also, if the choice is available, are more likely to pick a local, but low-rated university to be closer to the community where they grew up.

However, it is important for Consuls to know that they have choices available to them. So, what are some things they may consider when making that choice?

Balanced Decision Making

Understanding the Path: Work

Most Consuls have an idea of the path they'd like to pursue after graduation from high school. This idea has been defined by familial expectations, but also expectations they have of themselves. They could make the choice to go into the workforce rather than continue onto higher education, and many Consuls do choose this path. If this decision is made healthily, then it is based on a Consul's self-knowledge and hearty pragmatism. The career they choose is likely a practical one, and it will also be one they find satisfaction in.

If they go straight into the workforce, it is because they have a well-defined career path in mind and have the resources available to make it happen. University at this point could be unnecessary. Consuls are anything but wasteful, and the idea of potentially spending huge amounts of money and time on something that could be irrelevant is painful for them to consider. If there isn't a sense of purpose or meaning in college, it's likely just to be a bad experience.

The difference between Consuls who choose university and Consuls who choose to immediately go into the workforce is that the former seeks formal training because

they need added structure, while the latter can apply structure well enough to themselves, seeing through independent learning through practice or on-the-job training.

Understanding the Path: College

If they go for higher education, it is because they want to pursue a career that requires a degree or certification, or because they have a genuine fascination with a subject. They choose which university to attend based on their personal preferences and may pick a less prestigious university if a specific program – say nursing – is stronger than it would be at a top ranked school.

If Consuls need a degree or a certification for their desired career – teacher, social worker, nurse, or physician – then they’ll get one. However, this type keeps practicality in mind as they search for an institution to provide that certification. To get what they need, this type rarely has a problem with going with the relatively economical choice of trade school or community college for their degree over the pricier 4-year university.

Balanced Consuls also seriously consider family’s opinions of institutions. But while the weigh-ins of family and mentors are extremely important to a Consuls, a balanced decision is based on how the Consuls themselves feel about their school of choice. This is a type who values leadership, and they that starts with themselves, viewing directing their own education as great practice.

Unbalanced Decision Making

Fear of the Unknown

When unbalanced Consuls approach decision-making, they are ruled by their Judging trait. They value propriety and planning, order and a known path. The idea of leaving what they know for a virtually unknown future can be deeply unsettling to Consuls. When presented with unfamiliar change, their otherwise decisive natures are replaced by paralysis and fear.

Fear of the unknown can force unbalanced Consuls into early work (say, the family business), as they see it as a system that works. They don't choose to stay necessarily because they want to, or because they like their work, but because the option of going down the road not taken may seem too stressful. It's not uncommon to find parent-child duos of nurses, lawyers, or any other profession that lends a service to others.

Consuls may also choose to go to university because it's traditionally the path that their family has taken. Even if Consuls have a career they prefer (and that doesn't require a college degree, or that requires a different certification), they may not want to go against the grain. The same can be said for Consuls who don't want to *leave* university because the job market too unfamiliar and unpredictable –school is something they've grown accustomed to for nearly their entire lives. They may opt to become “professional students”, remaining in the relatively regimented academic arena.

Selecting for Others

The opinions of parents or other admired mentors can be very important to Consuls. Family may come first for this type, and they make sure to include their loved ones in most aspects of their life – past, present, and future. However, when unbalanced, Consuls may always be conscientious of societal expectations, and may pick a route solely because it is deemed “proper” or “acceptable” by the authority figures in their life.

It’s at this point that unbalanced Consuls begin down a path of passive living. They don’t live a life of their personal choosing, but a life dictated by the word of powerful loved ones. Even if Consuls detests the path set forth by their loved ones, they may feel as though they have strictly adhere to social values, and make their family proud.

Rebalancing Decision Making

Facing the Unknown

It isn’t change that Consuls avoid, necessarily. They have no issue choosing to go into the workforce or go into higher education if they know what it’ll involve. It’s only when they don’t know what’s on the other side of that tunnel that they become nervous and, ultimately, avoidant. Facing challenges, however, creates a better-rounded and therefore more stable person.

The key to facing the unknown is understanding that it’s acceptable to fail. Consuls may have it in their mind that they can only be model students or model employees, and nothing less. And the only way to accomplish that is if they can see the path clearly before them.

While they may not always be able to see a defined path, Consuls can gain confidence when facing the unknown by visualizing future obstacles and struggles. Consuls might take some time to imagine that an exam doesn't focus on what they studied for. What could they do to recover from this as they sit in the classroom, staring at unfamiliar content? By developing a strategy in advance, they can recover quickly from a very challenging situation – it was expected.

- Fall back on standard exam-taking techniques, like eliminating possibilities or looking through previous and future questions to see if one question provides the answer for another;
- Commit in advance to asking the teacher for clarification, a tremendously valuable technique that rarely occurs to a flustered student;
- Follow up with the teacher after the exam to make sure that in the future, they know where their attention can best be focused as they review material – a failure here is an opportunity to improve techniques, and it's rare for an instructor to reject a student who shows dedication to their course;
- Consider a difficult challenge that they were able to overcome successfully in the past.

Understanding Their Choice

Consuls should meditate on the reasons why they're making a certain decision. This is a type who relies heavily on the expectations of their community, and extra caution should be taken to ensure their making a choice based on their personal satisfaction rather than the satisfaction of others. Consuls can ask themselves the following questions:

- What are three main reasons they're deciding on this path?

- Have they taken the time to explore other options? This includes visiting school, talking to their advisor, job exploration for other careers, internships, and so on.
- Are they making a choice based on their personal interests?
- If not, determine what their interests are, and if they can pursue it more effectively through work or school.

For Consuls who have made a decision based off the expectations of others, it would be good to remember that it's never too late to pursue their interests. They can take the time needed to gracefully bow out of whatever field they're in and prepare for their preferred path.

Consuls in College

Consuls may have mixed feelings when entering college. There is an opportunity to gain some real skills and develop professional credentials. However, university life tends to have far less structure than high school, with a much greater demand for self-direction. This can be disconcerting to a student with as many fixed habits and beliefs as Consuls.

However, Consuls are hardly ones to back down from an exciting challenge, especially one with such a rich history. Even with these fixed habits and beliefs, college can be a time for Consuls to consider and build upon their strengths in a real way. Consuls may find this a time where they can develop competence. Consuls need to be careful to ensure that within their chosen major, that they make a point of reflecting on whether it's suitable for them. A major heavy in labs and practicums – like medicine, for example – will suit Consuls well. Also, Consuls respect practical

knowledge as much as any hands-on-work. Learning how to insert a syringe has equal weight to understanding the medical systems.

Consuls' course choices tend to be similar to the subjects they connected with in high school. They do well in any detail-oriented work that needs careful administration and social engagement: health care, education, law, social work, public relations, human resources, and religious studies to name a few. For Consuls, the value of a subject is defined by its application and purpose. It's unlikely they will be attracted to less traditional courses. They will instead seek more bedrock courses – perhaps something their parents might have taken a generation earlier.

The question for Consuls is not whether they can do something. They have the work ethic to do well in any niche they choose. Instead, they'll wonder if they'll feel of use. Some feel that college and university are only about gathering the tools need to make a good living. Consuls may fit into this category. However, they always have one eye on contributing to their communities and taking care of others. Making a good living would likely be more about taking care of people over the gratuitous accumulation of wealth.

Balanced College Life

Conscientious and Responsible

In high school, Consuls knew where they had to be, and exactly what they had to do. While the same can be said for higher education, there's more fluidity and autonomy involved. The sudden freedom can be overwhelming to many young adults, which is why it's common for many most-year-students to become depressed and unproductive as they try to find their new purpose in life.

Consuls are better equipped than most when it comes to the first-year-blues. They've worked hard to develop the ability to plan and manage their time, develop useful study and notetaking skills, and how to draw on social resources. Yes, they may be away from friends and family, and yes, they're a change-averse type who has the been thrown wildly out of their element. Despite all that, Consuls will search and find the clearest path possible.

Involved in the Community

Balanced Consuls' main reason for choosing higher education is simple – to receive the certification or degree required for their chosen career. They understand the path they have embarked upon, and have chosen higher education for its focused implementation of a life plan. However, just as Consuls are diligent students, they also excel at involving themselves in the community.

Consuls make their education social, broad, engaged, and invigorating, taking advantage of not just the practical resources, but joining rowing or other team sports or clubs for both enjoyment and as resume boosters. But it's not just the resume that concerns them – they genuinely value what these programs teach about teamwork, leadership, grit, and other character-building aspects. For example, if Consuls were to join a student organization like a fraternity or a sorority, it wouldn't be for the partying (though that is a bonus), but for the opportunity to make lifelong bonds with their peers.

Unbalanced College Life

The Straw That Broke the Camel's Back

Consuls are naturally inclined to overload themselves. Whether it be the pressures of academia, the needs of others, or the expectations they have of themselves, unbalanced Consuls too easily take this too far. Sooner or later, they'll bow or break under the cumulative weight of it all. There's only so much they can take on before they simply don't have enough time in the day.

In high school, Consuls' ability to stress themselves out was lower due to smaller workloads and fewer expectations. In college, however, Consuls have free rein to express their undue perfectionism within their chosen courses and activities. They will also add stress to their lives by pushing for too much detail and will make lofty demands of themselves. These demands may look like not allowing themselves leniency when they make mistakes, pushing themselves too hard to achieve and maintain high grades, and forcing themselves to meet the expectations of family members and loved ones.

As the weight becomes heavier and heavier, Consuls may rant and rave about their stresses, assuming that it's just the way of life, that things are meant to be difficult. It may not even occur to them that their workload isn't normal, and that the real, underlying cause is that they signed up for too much.

Unyielding and Rigid

Consuls are the 'stick-to-it' kind of people. Once they decide on a course, it can be very difficult to get them off it (even it is completely unsuitable for their needs). Consider Consuls who choose a major they don't particularly like. Rather than

switching majors, they will see this particular major out for the next four years in the name of commitment.

This sort of rigidity can also be seen when unbalanced Consuls are confronted with unfamiliar ideas that clash with their existing beliefs. A devoutly religious individual may struggle with ideas presented in scientific courses, or they might react strongly against protest groups rather than listening to what they have to say, or even adopt or lead censorship initiatives. The same can be said for Consuls raised in more liberal settings, who refuse to even consider what a more conservative student is saying, and immediately label them as 'wrong', and not worth listening to.

Rebalancing College Life

Reshaping Unreasonable Expectations

While Consuls in high school had issues with taking breaks, Consuls in university may be unwilling to deal with root of their stress – meeting unreasonable expectations. If the expectations of their loved ones include maintaining a perfect grade point average, while taking a full course load of rigorous classes, while keeping up with various clubs and organizations, while also going out with friends regularly, and having a part time job, then it's safe to say that that's a little unreasonable.

Consuls are warm people and apply pragmatic fairness when they can. If a friend were to come to them and vent about the same stresses listed above, they would give advice as to what they would do in the same situation. Funnily enough, they are reluctant to take their own advice.

The first step to dealing with the issue of heavy expectations is to acknowledge that these expectations unreasonable. A simple way to check if they're unreasonable is to ask the question: "Would I ask someone else to do all these things?".

This type may treat their suffering lightly, joking loudly about it with their classmates with barely restrained panic. They will grit their teeth and bear the pain, sometimes ignoring their emotions completely. However, to be a better-rounded person, it is necessary to understand that it's okay not to be okay.

Consuls can combat these self-blaming tendencies by practicing self-compassion exercises. These exercises can range to meditation to talking with close friends or family. One exercise in particular is the self-compassion letter. In these exercises, Consuls will look closely at their feelings, and then think about if they're being fair to themselves.

Self-Compassion Letter

- Imagine the issue at hand – too many deadlines, overwhelming extracurricular work, not seeing friends enough
- Next, they will imagine someone who loves them unconditionally, and how they would react to the Consul's current issues
- In the letter, they will ask themselves what are healthier ways to cope with the stressful occurrences
- Spend the next few minutes free writing about any and all negative emotions, while also imagining the person who loves them unconditionally

Reducing Rigidity

At the core of Consuls' personal rigidity is the fear of change. It's not that they are incapable of changing, but rather, they dislike having to halt all gears and reverse back to square one. This is why one will find Consul's in majors they dislike, but are reluctant to leave. They may think "I've already come this far, might as well finish it."

The problem in this is when a bad choice in one's major can lead to only one kind of internship, that can lead to only certain types of careers, that can lead to a lifetime of settling in a path that Consuls' didn't even want in the first place. Consuls can ask themselves a single question in situations like this: Do they value satisfaction and contentment more than complacency?

When it comes Consuls' rigidity in their social lives, one can turn to German philosopher Friedrich Nietzsche, who once said: *"You have your way. I have my way. As for the right way, the correct way, and the only way, it does not exist."*

The right way does not exist. Consuls, when unbalanced, have a harder time than most remembering this. However, they can be some of the warmest individuals, and usually want the best for others. They can combine their natural warmth with open-mindedness to make closer, and more authentic relationships.

The first step in doing this is to consider the following whenever faced with an opposing view:

- Why does this view upset them?
- Does the person with the opposing opinion have direct impact on the Consul's life?
- Why is better to *not* listen than to listen?

- Would there be more knowledge gained by listening than simply refusing to hear out the opposing opinion?

Lifelong Learning

For Consuls, 'learning' is very much about gaining real-world-applicable skills. They gather what they need to create and maintain a stable life; as well as to better serve the people and organizations they care for. It is the purpose of community engagement that Consuls continue to learn. This is why they acknowledge formal education as a resource, and are aware of its ability to advance personal development.

As they mature, Consuls find what they consider necessary – family, community, and social circles – to expand. This could be things like learning how to garden so they can join in on their friends' gardening club, to how to have better relationships with their children, to generally increasing their resilience and grit. Other Consuls, however, may continue treading the same well-worn paths. They may stubbornly insist that, while they have not learned everything there is to know, they at least know what they *need* to know.

It should be noted that Consuls are aware that there's always something new to learn, something new to apply. For example, registered nurses are asked to update their knowledge of new procedures, guidelines, and medical happenings every year. If it is a case like this, then Consuls are more than willing to take tests and courses as long as it's needed.

Balanced Lifelong Learning

Making Time to Learn

Consuls find that as they get older, their obligations grow. It is very easy for this type to become completely swept up by the expectations of relationships, family, work, and the organizations they invest themselves in. However, well-rounded Consuls understand that a balanced life includes having time for oneself.

They make it a point to carve out time in their busy lives to indulge in learning skills they enjoy. While work and personal obligations are important, there is always room to incorporate new skills into their everyday routine. For example, Consuls who want to learn how to cook intricate recipes will take up a cooking class at their local community center.

Learning New Skills to Complement Old Lives

Consuls don't learn new things for the sake of novelty, but because they can apply it to the foundation of their lives. They take the time to look at the life they have presently and wonder how they can enrich it for both themselves and the ones they care about.

This can manifest in things like learning more about automobiles so they can handle minor car issues on their own, or picking up carpentry to create simple furniture pieces (that they can then pass on to their children), or even taking a dance class so they can participate in the annual town talent show.

On the topic of formal education, balanced Consuls may be open to pursuing more certifications and higher-level degrees if it would improve their career prospects. They understand that sometimes it's important to look in a new direction, and to

make a plan to pursue that direction sensibly – developing a budget to pay for school, finding time in their schedules, and ensuring that the degree serves a purpose.

Unbalanced Lifelong Learning

Assuming Superiority

Consuls are adept at creating a life that they're satisfied with, but often at the cost of doing what they're only comfortable with. When deciding not to take a path, a Consul may try to convince themselves that they're just not cut out for it and that everyone who has followed that path are more foolish than the Consuls themselves. When unbalanced, Consuls are convinced that they've done everything correctly, will continue to do things correctly, and if they're doing things the right way, then others must be doing things wrong.

Consuls cling to stability because the chance of failing is distinctly lower if the path ahead is already clear. This way of thinking makes perfect sense. However, the issue arises when the Consul is unwilling to step off the path, if even for a moment. This strict adherence allows the Consul to remain in the same place, that while comfortable, may be keeping them from more suitable opportunities.

This line of thinking may also lead a Consul to believe that there is nothing else for them to learn. And even if there are new things to learn, it could hardly be worth the effort to go outside of their comfort zones.

No Time for Learning

Consuls are more than happy to lend a helping hand to those who ask. This inclination to be of service to their loved ones and their community is one of the

Consuls' best traits, but it can also be their weakness. They can easily lose themselves to day-to-day tasks, and miss out on the opportunity to do other things.

When they allow every moment of their day to be dictated by obligations and expectations – being the model employee, making sure their partner is satisfied, making sure their parents are happy, that the bills are paid, that the house is clean, and a thousand other little things – they could be miss out on vital personal development time. It is possible that years can pass by with Consuls not learning about anything they're personally interested in, or worse, that there's nothing else worth being interested in.

Rebalancing Lifelong Learning

Varying the Routine

Being “set in your ways” isn't necessarily a bad thing. However, there's always room for improving upon an existing routine. Consuls can begin this by picking a relatively mundane task and mixing it up – for example, a walk. Rather than taking the same path every day, Consuls can choose a different path every week. A walk on a forest trail, a walk through the city, or a different route through the neighborhood can all provide a refreshing change, and opportunities to find new things to try around the community.

Based on their small excursions, Consuls can then adjust their routines based on what they liked or disliked. Better yet, they may not change their old routine at all if that's what suits them better. The important thing is that they gain the knowledge of the new to contrast it with the old to make a well-rounded decision.

Incorporating Time to Learn

Time may be the biggest obstacle in any Consuls' path of learning. There may be other obligations distracting them from learning more about the things they enjoy. However, it is important for Consuls to carve out time for themselves, and to put themselves first every so often. Creating space for self-care can help lower stress and improve Consuls' overall mood.

They can begin by committing at least an hour a day to learn or practice a skill they enjoy. This hour can be at any time of the day and can be incorporated into their everyday routine. Take, for example, Consuls who like to relax and watch television for a couple of hours at night. They can also use that time to practice knitting or sewing (given they take the extra time to learn the technique).

Even if they can't incorporate the skill they want to learn into their everyday routine, Consuls can choose to make time. They can use social time to invite their friends to learn-a-longs, ensuring there is time to talk and learn skills in events like knitting circles to community baseball leagues to book clubs.

Conclusion

The Responsibility of Growth

When Consuls enter a learning environment, they bring with them the tools and traits to succeed – they can easily integrate among teachers and fellow students, their outgoing manner opening endless learning opportunities. When their focus on social structure is balanced with studious attention to new knowledge, Consuls gain the best of what school has to offer, growing intellectually as well as socially. This can be

a wonderful time for this type to embrace the practical benefits of education as well as develop their sense of community with others – life skills that carry them onward.

The educational experience is also an excellent opportunity for Consuls to reach past their own boundaries and conceptions – it's a special time when they have access to many different minds, views, and ideas. Caring enough to genuinely explore diverse paths early in life instead of settling for the rote is a highly responsible way to build a satisfying and balanced set of values. And, practicing the skill of learning itself keeps Consuls from stagnating – they can continue learning after school is over, making life into a classroom. Being wise enough to recognize their own limits and brave enough to step beyond them is a worthy task, and school gives Consuls an exciting way to meet this goal.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your academic path? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Thirst for Knowledge Test](#)

What is your interest in gaining knowledge? How does your desire for learning affect your life? This tool will help you explore that.

[Academic Exploration Test](#)

Do you ever wonder what areas of study might suit your personality? Find out which subjects might be the most satisfying for you.

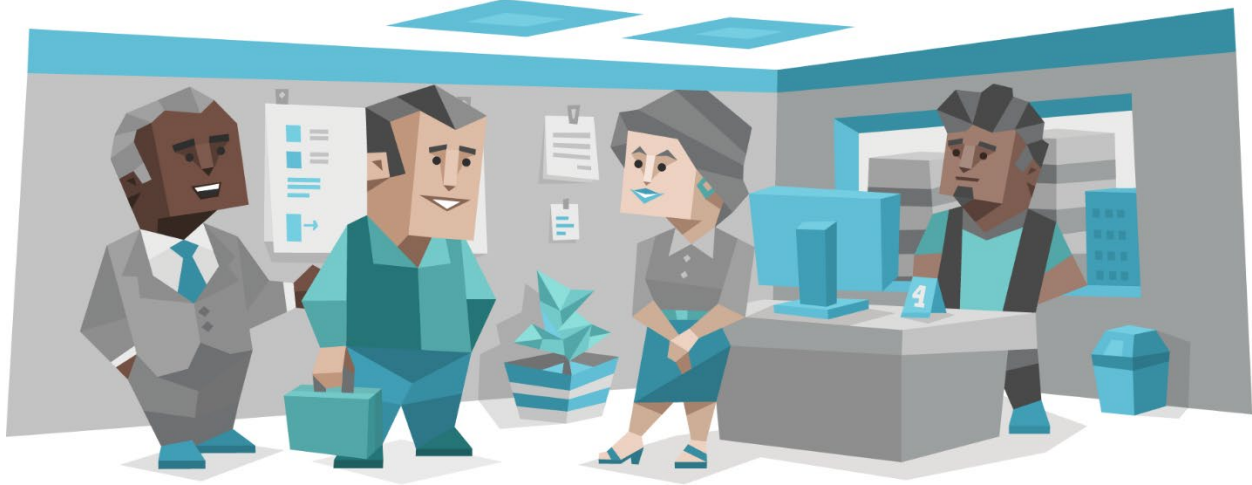
[Perfectionism Test](#)

Perfectionism is a desire to be remarkable and outstanding in everything you do. Let's see what role it plays in your life.

[Type Guesser \(Academic\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your classmate belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Professional Development



Consuls combine the work-ethic and the attention to details and protocols common to Sentinels with an Extraverted and Feeling Trait that encourages them to include others in their sensibilities. They are more likely to be found with others at work than alone. The human element permeates their work lives.

Consequently, Consuls dabble in human resources even if they aren't attached to a formal human resources department. No matter what their level or the title they have, they find satisfaction in organizing and uniting people around established standards and practices at work—it's a consistent theme repeated throughout this section. Their success often depends on the degree to which they balance that agenda with the diverse opinions and preferences of others.

Other People are the Key

Consuls are gregarious individuals who value their bonds with others. They are the ultimate extraverts. This type relishes social situations, even if the amiable gathering happens to occur in the middle of an office on a workday. They are fun-loving and capable of turning less than exciting tasks at work into an event. Consuls don't

venture very far off the beaten path, but they manage to spice up everyday routines with a sense of camaraderie nonetheless.

As the ultimate team players, Consuls prefer jobs that include a lot of contact with others. They might remain focused when doing isolated jobs, but chances are the work won't satisfy them. Consuls like to feel appreciated, and they need to know their contributions are important. They often measure this based on how others react to them. When working alone, such feedback may be rare, making things difficult for Consuls. Seeking attention is seen as a weakness in some other types, but not so for Consuls. Getting positive reinforcement motivates Consuls to apply themselves even more. Feedback is essential for this type and is less about ego than developing a sense of purpose and knowing what they're doing counts.

Feelings and Focus

The Feeling trait and its consequent focus on harmony is a defining characteristic for Consuls. Where Sentinels with the Thinking trait may focus almost exclusively on a goal, sometimes at the expense of other people's feelings and concerns, Consuls find it difficult to separate the two.

Not being able to separate the objective from the more subjective approach easily can work two ways. As a benefit, Consuls' goal-orientation can help them when they head a team or are simply just a part of it. They instill a no-nonsense objective approach with a passion rather than a coldness more rational types may adopt. They can use this encourage their coworkers to hit whatever their target might be.

On the other hand, they may take it too personally when others don't go along with the standards they hold as important. Such strong feelings may split a unified group into a cliquish "us versus them" configuration. They are, indeed, likely to take things

too personally at times. They base their opinions on a colleague's behavior less on whether it's effective and more on whether the action aligns with their beliefs and preferences. In a worst case scenario, such assessments can create a cliquish division comprised of two groups: "those people support me, and those don't." However, in the name of protecting harmony, a lot of criticism may go on behind the backs of those involved.

The Observant and Judging traits reflect Consuls' protective sense of the rules, protocols, and standards. It fosters a "this-or-that" narrative that suggests a single right way and many wrong ways to do a thing. By holding this belief, they sometimes create a complex tension when they try to keep everybody happy and everybody in line at the same time. Consequently, they may attempt to dictate how colleagues should feel or respond to a situation without making an honest effort to discover what is going on with them.

Jobs and General Skill Sets



There is no definitive list of jobs that fit any type exactly, and exceptions always exist. However, this short list of industries shows where typical Consuls might feel at home

and provides a good place to start thinking about potential areas of professional interest.

By way of review, Consuls are hard-working, organized, and enjoy working as part of a team. They don't mind repetitive work, nor work that focuses on minute details. With this focus on the necessary over the frivolous, many of them find themselves in leadership positions. Consuls are consummate networkers and fill their contacts file with the names of people able to contribute to their success. They persist in whatever they start and can be relied on to follow through on major projects.

The following professions reflect Consuls' skill set:

- Customer acquisition
- Management (any context)
- Sales
- Coaching
- Teach
- Small business ownership

Alternative Options

Both self-employment and entrepreneurship are viable options in the 21st century. No longer are people expected to stay with a single job for 20 years, nor can they expect to. In today's job market, there may be even more job security and satisfaction in being flexible and taking charge of one's own employment. Consuls are certainly quite capable of thriving in jobs of their making.

Consuls may succeed best at being self-employed while working within an established framework - perhaps buying into a larger franchise. They thrive on

respected precedent and are not so prone to pathfinding. But no doubt, once they've landed on the right enterprise, they have the basic organizational skills, the work ethic, and the enthusiasm required to make a solid living.

If taking control of their employment is a feature, a fundamental aspect of self-employment is being the boss. Consuls often discover their conflicts and problems at work involve the opinions and behaviors of others. Becoming self-employed may eliminate some of these difficulties. After all, it's the boss who makes the decision and sets the direction. They have the final word, and Consuls appreciate do so.

On the other hand, if self-employment means working alone, Consuls may find this route difficult. That doesn't mean that Consuls are forced to form companies to enjoy being others or can't freelance independently to be happy. They simply need to find some way to interact with others regularly. Customers or clients are often a great source of interaction, and in the context of business, Consuls' affinity for social outreach makes these interactions even more valuable.

Workplace Roles

Once they've made the decision on the nature of their employment, Consuls can begin to look at their behaviors in the workplace.

The following sections explore Consuls' attributes on the job, including a look at both typical skill sets and how they handle roles within an organization. The "balanced" section describes Consuls at their best, using their strengths wisely. "Unbalanced" describes when overheated strengths or weaknesses prevent them from having an optimal work experience. It often results in a strength turning into too much of a good thing. The "rebalancing" section provides some suggestions, many of them

actionable, some of them simply attitudinal, for restoring balance when things are unbalanced.

Balanced Consuls as Employees

Starting at the Beginning

It's a natural leap to think of Consuls in leadership positions. Eventually, many end up there. But few take over the boss's office on day one. Employees need to pay their dues, gain experience, and earn respect like anyone, or they may find themselves in over their heads.

Waiting their turn works fine for Consuls, who view life as a series of predictable steps. They have an innate sense of Aristotle's quote, "He who cannot be a good follower cannot be a good leader." They wait their turn while being loyal to their current leaders and refining the skills needed to take the reins someday themselves. With their enthusiasm, Consuls are never simply marking time, no matter what rung of the ladder they're on. There's always the productive and the practical happening.

Work and Validation

Even in subordinate positions, Consuls like to see themselves as having important input. They work to impress bosses and those with whom they work. Even from the beginning, they are likely to apply themselves fully to their jobs. However, as subordinates, Consuls need clear instructions, and intentional goals, especially in the beginning. Hard boundaries and guidelines give Consuls the confidence to move forward.

Balanced Consuls see everyone they work with as members of their social circles. For some types, "mixing business with pleasure" can be complex and difficult. While

Consuls may occasionally run into problems in this area, they are largely expert at working with “friends” while remaining focused on professional tasks.

Unbalanced Consuls as Employees

The Myth of Loyalty

Most would agree that loyalty is good. For the most part, it is. But unbalanced Consuls may take it a bit too far in their enthusiasm. Unbridled loyalty can become as troublesome as no loyalty at all. It’s the difference between a sycophant and an employee who is appropriately loyal, yet not afraid to be honest or even critical.

There is a tendency among Consuls to avoid making waves. If they feel excessive loyalty toward their boss, they certainly don’t want to upset them. Consequently, they may fail to tell their employers something that may disappoint them or that shows disagreement, even when a directive is misguided. While some managers may prefer this, those with integrity want honest feedback from their workers. Advancement often depends on the quality of one’s feedback at some point and not learning to give it honestly out of “loyalty” may well stunt professional growth.

The Illusion of Peace

While they strive to maintain harmony and a friendly atmosphere, Consuls cling to what they believe is right. In the name of keeping the peace, they might not deal with a problem directly, instead, finding an indirect means of expressing their disapproval. That might be through gossiping behind the offender’s back or finding other passive-aggressive ways of responding. This roundabout response may give Consuls, with their righteousness satisfied, the false sense that they have addressed the problem when they’ve simply avoided it.

Consuls may believe they are keeping the peace by not confronting things directly, when, in reality, their indirect methods simply poison the well. Gossip has probably never led to a solution. Even those who listen to the gossip may wonder about the basic integrity of the gossiper. Trust and any prior sense of collegiality may erode, while genuine problems remain hidden, unresolved, and are compounded by negativity. They may wonder what the Consuls say about them when they are not in the room.

Rebalancing Consuls as Employees

Putting Loyalty in Perspective

Mere decades ago, it was common for people to stay in the same job for their entire lives. Loyalty was largely measured by endurance and longevity. In many cases it involved employees putting the interest of the company above their personal interests. That thinking has changed drastically. Now, loyalty is more about the quality of contribution, and the amount of serious work provided rather than marking time. Part of “serious work” may include offering thoughtful and honest feedback. This new measure of loyalty changes simply achieving seniority into a more measurably productive tenure, even if it doesn’t last forever.

Consuls want to contribute. They need to feel that what they offer in the workplace is important. Using this, they can reframe loyalty to mean that they give honest and therefore important feedback. Of course, every subordinate needs to be respectful and polite when offering such feedback. Not all honesty must be “brutal” honesty. A measure of diplomacy never hurts. But in the end, the truth is more helpful than a sycophantic false loyalty that, in effect, deceives the superior.

The Assertive Subordinate

When Consuls enter the workplace as subordinates, they want to see it as a friendly place where everyone gets along. But few workplaces are free from disagreements and tensions. Because of their harmony-seeking attributes, Consuls may avoid addressing unpleasant situations directly. Learning techniques designed to reduce harsh confrontation while dealing with problems squarely can help Consuls communicate more clearly and effectively while catering to their need for harmony.

While there are dozens of assertiveness techniques, the one that may resonate most with Consuls and can be used immediately is the use of “I feel” statements. For example, instead of saying, “Your work is sloppy. You always leave the counter a mess after your shift,” say, “I feel annoyed when I come in and see the counter a mess. We have to spend a good fifteen minutes organizing the work area.” “I feel” statements simply place the responsibility for an opinion or an observation on the speaker. It removes any harsh criticism or accusatory tones, instead highlighting how Consuls feel. Using assertiveness techniques, Consuls can approach a situation directly, deal with it honestly, have their needs met, and minimize bad feelings.

Balanced Consuls as Colleagues

The Collegial Coworkers

Inclusiveness is a defining characteristic of Consuls on the job. They want to be included, and they want to include others. They approach working with others eagerly and find pleasure in social interactions at work. When they need to reach out to people as resources, their social ease reveals them to be excellent networkers. Unity is important to them, even if they sometimes express it imperfectly as they struggle to grasp somebody else’s perspective.

When things are balanced, Consuls are kind and giving, and they practice a high level of congeniality with their colleagues. In fact, this friendliness is such a prominent part of their work identity that they may even find it hard when they're forced to work alone.

Consuls are genuinely interested in seeing their teams, and the individuals on their teams improve and succeed. The phrase "All for one and one for all" works for Consuls and Musketeers alike. Needless to say, they're tireless members of any work group and are unmatched in their enthusiasm.

Trustworthy

It doesn't take long for Consuls' coworkers to see how reliable they are. Their work ethic is strong, and they remain true to the standards and protocols that define a job. Part of being reliable is being predictably effective. That is an apt description of the typical Consul.

Consuls strive to keep projects on an even keel. Effectiveness largely means doing things "by the book." Consuls, like other Sentinels, feel an obligation to protect tradition and established norms. If coworkers need information about the company's policy or preferred methods, they aren't likely to find anyone more informed than this type. If a task needs completing, they can count on Consuls to do a thorough job because the company expects it.

Unbalanced Consuls as Colleagues

An Insistent Teammate

It's admirable to want to include coworkers in teams and activities, but unbalanced Consuls can become insistent on inclusiveness, considering social engagement non-

negotiable. Since they work best in a crowd, they might mistakenly assume others operate the same way. They may fail to accept that some thrive on laboring in solitude. Introverts hate few things more than the pressure to join a group. Should some coworkers decline to participate, Consuls may inadvertently create a clique dividing those who are “in” from those who are “out.” While their goal may be to unite, things may end up the opposite.

Unbalanced Consuls may also have trouble distinguishing between growth and improvement. Set in their ways as they are, they may fail to take the time to understand what contributes to a specific coworker’s professional growth. They may dogmatically decide there is a specific way to help their colleagues improve. They’ve found an effective method that works for them and just can’t stand the idea of seeing others suffer by not enjoying its benefits – no matter what the other person thinks. The Consuls’ counsel may even help co-workers become more productive than they were. However, it may not be how their colleagues best utilize their unique talents. The good intentions of Consuls may not always match the needs of their friends and co-workers.

Reliability Becomes Rigidity

An important aspect of being part of a team is valuing other team members’ input. Consuls may present themselves as caring and receptive to other ideas. However, if they disagree with a particular idea, they are likely to make it a personal issue. They sometimes find it hard to believe that those with alternate opinions can be right. The same dogmatism that prevents them from allowing their team members to grow in their own way can also affect other aspects of their work.

Once a rule, law, or protocol is established, Consuls feel obligated to adhere to it regardless of the circumstances or the outcomes. They may confuse following protocols with effectiveness since they so closely connect the rules with “the right thing to do.” Some types may be far more flexible and might freely stretch boundaries if they need to find some effective solutions. Such disregard for the rules can summon Consuls’ previously mentioned judgmental tendencies and create unspoken (or as often as not, clearly declared) tension in the workplace.

Rebalancing Consuls as Colleagues

Helping Others Feel Valued Too

Consuls like to feel valued. That may be part of the reason they push their perspective so vigorously. It may help them to reframe this attitude. The most valuable thing they might bring to the table is helping others feel valued as well by encouraging them to speak up. Taking a more supportive stance toward colleagues can help Consuls balance their sometimes-insistent ways. However, it may take some effort on their part to talk to their colleagues and discover what it is they need to feel valued.

The most valuable thing Consuls can do to help their colleagues may be to listen honestly. Instead of giving one-size-fits-all tips for improvement or a reminder of the rules, they may want to take an extra moment and allow their coworkers to speak without interruption. Consuls may want to examine their listening-to-talking ratio. As a challenge and as a learning experience, Consuls may want to adopt a “question only” position for a while. If the talking seems to outweigh the listening, it may be time to consider whether they know their coworkers well enough to be advising them at all. It may be possible to help them improve without listening, but it’s hard to help them grow in its absence.

No More “Rules Police”

Once Consuls have listened to their colleagues, there is yet another step: Accepting their colleagues as individuals responsible for themselves, as individuals capable of deciding for themselves their best direction and interest. Consuls who learn that it is not their role to police the activities or the attitudes of their coworkers find that they enjoy working more and have more productive relationships with colleagues. Inclusion and working together doesn't mean trying to control others.

Consuls identify with standards so closely they may begin to take it personally when others thumb their noses at such conventions. If it is in the Consuls' job description to monitor and oversee such things, then, naturally, they must attend to them. If a coworker's behavior impedes the Consuls work, then, of course, they have to deal with it. However, if neither thing is true, they may want to ask themselves what they get out of judging their coworkers and, speaking plainly, if it's any of their business. Consuls are happier and more effective if they cut these extraneous concerns from their lives and allow themselves a sense of appreciation for the different perspectives others bring to the table.

Balanced Consuls as Managers

Natural Organizers

Whether upper management, middle management, or leading from among peers, Consuls possess an impulse to organize and often set the direction for a team or group. Well-balanced Consuls efficiently sort tasks needed to complete a job or project, delegate wisely, and know how to appreciate the long view needed for reaching goals. Based on the experience and trustworthiness of their team members, they also invite constructive criticism and advice. Consuls are social individuals who

enjoy networking and creating partnerships with others. These characteristics become vital tools when they accept management positions.

Consul managers enjoy uniting people and managing them. They do their best to create a warm and conflict-free workplace, as they understand it. They respect traditional hierarchies and encourage their subordinates to do the same. (This, of course, in moderation as blind followers can be taken advantage of and may be less useful than honest brokers.) Consuls enjoy the power that comes from responsibility, but they see as benefits beyond their ambitions. There is a conviction that they serve a greater good.

Social Leadership

Consuls are those leaders who bring a sense of family and fun to the job. That doesn't mean they aren't serious about accomplishing their goals. But if they can infuse the work day with something slightly more stimulating, especially in the social realm, they do. They're likely to be the managers who, for example, create contests around meeting quotas or hold celebration parties when reviewing positive feedback from customers. In fact, Consuls are likely to hold a lot of celebrations (if company policy permits them), believing that the emotional focus on success leads to better morale and stronger productivity.

Consuls are likely to feel attached to their subordinates. When balanced, they remind them of the rules and the structures and use the company's accepted best practices as guidelines for helping them improve while accepting that there is usually room for individual styles within these guidelines that allow each person to grow in the way that works for them. They work to keep harmony and high morale, but they do so within the context of promoting the company, becoming corporate cheerleaders at

times. Yet they do not allow their friendliness to take the focus away from their serious loyalty to the business – it's instead a way of proving that loyalty.

Unbalanced Consuls as Managers

Too Much Focus on The Plan

Organization is a tool that holds immense value in business. However, unbalanced Consuls, rigidly entranced by desired goals and may place them even above the desired outcomes and any flexibility needed to reach them. In doing so, they can lose vital flexibility. The best plans can go awry. Sometimes, plans need revising, and Consuls too sold on theirs as “the only way” may not maneuver as quickly as they need to.

Consuls, all of whom rely on the Judging trait, desire things to be predictable. The need to ensure predictability breeds a need to exert control, which can be a strength unless it hardens into rigidity. Life regularly throws curveballs often making plans useless. Unbalanced Consuls managers not flexible enough to handle them may come up short.

Not Taking Things Personally

Consuls may not be as skilled at compartmentalizing the different aspects of their work lives as other leaders might. In the end, what matters in business is not how happy and conflict-free the staff is, but rather how effectively they've done their jobs. For unbalanced Consuls, their preferred warm demeanor may clash with the cold reality of directly enforcing effectiveness.

Many managers find delivering tough assessments or taking disciplinary actions difficult. Unbalanced Consuls may think of their staff as friends and even family, but

that does not always serve a manager well. It can send mixed messages that muddy the waters. Consuls may have trouble dealing directly with their “friends” who work for them for fear of hurting their feelings. The “friends,” in turn, may expect inappropriately gentle handling. Sometimes managers must take actions which leave others unhappy. It’s a fact of management life.

Furthermore, in friendly relations with subordinates, there may be the danger of employees taking advantage of Consul managers. Boundaries and compartmentalization serve the purpose of keeping people honest in their roles. Employees who forget that their “friend” is also their boss, may innocently expect to receive favors from the Consul managers. Less innocently, some may choose to appear friendly just to get on the right side of the boss and perhaps be allowed privileges others may not receive.

Rebalancing Consuls as Managers

Building in Flexibility

Reality dictates that planning is beneficial, but knowing when to modify it is also valuable. Anticipating problems beforehand and building in contingency plans can help. For Consuls, planning for eventualities can seem like inserting an excuse to deviate from an established strategy. However, a simple reframe is to see contingency plans not as watering down the original plan, but as controlling it.

Sometimes challenges to a plan are a complete surprise, and there is no contingency plan ready. Sometimes a flexible attitude is all one needs to conquer an unanticipated problem. Actively expecting the unexpected, and consciously adopting a willingness to change course when needed can help Consuls to regain control of a wayward plan. Balancing the resolve to stay on course with a willingness to

circumvent unexpected hazards can save the day when a plan approaches a rocky shoal.

Fortifying Boundaries

Consuls may want to explore how solid their boundaries are about their staff. Manager-subordinate relationships are never equal, no matter how friendly they are. One holds power, and one doesn't. Fortunately for Consuls, company policies sometimes dictate how these relationships are handled – some prohibit dating, for example. A set of rules plays right into Consuls' style of operating. In the absence of policy, they might take a hard look at the way they interact with their subordinates and design rules of their own.

A repeated theme for Consuls involves communicating clearly and directly. Managers probably need this skill more than at any other workplace role. Learning to do so allows them to keep relationships straight and in their proper compartments. No hedging and no talking behind others' backs. Having a clear picture of the nature of a relationship and combining that with a reasonable amount of directness and diplomacy can rebalance many difficulties involving role boundaries and communication.

Cooperation Between Types

Cooperation and communication is essential for any business endeavor to run smoothly and to meet its goals. In most business settings, there are likely to be other personality type and working well with them may be crucial. In the sections below, relationships between the different groups and the Consuls will be explored. The "balanced" section will look at when the relationship works well and is mutually

beneficial. The “unbalanced” will discuss potential problems and conflicts, and the “rebalancing” concerns methods or ideas for repairing unbalanced relationships.

Consul-Analyst Workplace Cooperation



While some Analysts may share the Extraverted and Judging Traits with Consuls, there are no traits intrinsically the same as the Consuls across all Analyst types. However, that doesn't mean there is no common ground that can be shared by all. Both Consuls and Analysts are passionate about systems. While Analysts have a penchant for creating and refining them, Consuls are more likely to look for ways to comply with them and preserve them.

Balanced Consul-Analyst Workplace Cooperation

Domesticating Change

Stepping back and looking at these two types from a wider perspective, Analysts are likely to create the mold into which Consuls' will eventually fit. They like to shake up systems and frameworks to make them better. However, much can be said for stability, and the Consuls play a role in taming change that is too haphazard or

scattered. They slow things down enough to allow the people involved with the system time to adjust to change. One offers a broader way of thinking. The other domesticates it to fit the real, practical world.

Even though there is room for overlap, the Consuls and Analysts serve two distinct roles if their approaches are allowed to flourish. As a team, they can back the other up. The Consul will demonstrate how the Analysts visions are achievable and will be instrumental in making that happen. Analysts can support the Consuls interpretation of their plans as consistent. Putting three people at the counter in the morning will be necessary if the fresher, more profitable muffins are coming out of the oven at 6:00 a.m. instead being prepared the night before. Vision and execution feed off of each other when this pairing is balanced.

Moderating Influences

As moderating influences, the two can contribute to each other's work in significant ways. Cooperation between them is the product of accepting that they both offer something of value that leads to the same end – effective outcomes. Where Analysts offer broader solutions and visions, Consuls are masters at organizing their implementation and bringing them to reality. A sincere collaboration between the two is a crossroads where ideas become achievements and old ways transform into more effective new ways.

For example, Analysts may bring a larger blueprint for serious change that is very task- and result-oriented. The steps and the contingencies may all be in place. However, they may fail to consider things like personnel and the reasonable timelines needed to allow the workforce to accomplish the steps. At that point, the Consuls can step in and provide insight into the day-to-day, human concerns that

they need to address before a company can implement the plans. Complementing each other's focus can help develop a full plan that not only promotes an effective direction but also takes necessary daily matters into account.

Unbalanced Consul-Analyst Workplace Cooperation

Experimentation and Caution

Tensions are likely to mount if Analysts change things too casually. Consuls prefer proven solutions and need time to test new ideas before they accept them, and they see anything too inventive as introducing chaos into their trusted strategies. Analysts are less likely to focus on the risks associated with experimentation. Sometimes they may even indulge in experimenting simply for the sake of trying something out. Such experimentation provides no measurable contribution to the goals, and, consequently, Consuls are likely to reject them soundly.

Consuls may label Analysts as loose cannons with wild ideas. In turn, the Analysts begin to think of Consuls as uptight enemies of innovation. When both or either frames their relationships as adversarial rather than collaborative, they stop being useful to each other, and the larger enterprise becomes weaker due to a lack of cooperation.

If one is subordinate to the other in Consuls-Analyst work relationships, either of them maintaining a stubborn allegiance to a particular focus can be problematic. Automatically taking a position without giving a full hearing to any alternate views can be counterproductive. Very real and negative results can happen when there is a power difference. These might include a lack of promotion, a lack of basic respect, low morale, and even job loss.

Differing Styles

Working together, Consuls and Analysts may at times face clashes that are more about personality than substance. Consuls are sensitive and when that is paired with their deep conviction about how things “should be,” they may be easily upset in the workplace. Analysts, on the other hand, are not always attuned to emotions and sometimes are perplexed when their rational solutions are met with a highly sensitive reaction. When these two attitudes meet, there might a tangible sense of incompatibility.

When unbalanced, Consuls and Analysts might hold each other in poor regard. Consuls may think Analysts cold and calculating. Analysts may consider Consuls too obsessed with the feelings of others and with an agenda built mostly on old ideas. Consuls might interpret that as Analysts being disrespectful of the things that are important to them. It can stop being a war of ideas and approaches and become a matter of hurt feelings and a perceived assault on the Consuls’ egos.

Rebalancing Consul-Analyst Workplace Cooperation

Breaking a Stalemate

If Consuls and Analyst co-workers find themselves in conflict too often, they may need to define for themselves what the other person offers. In the heat of battle, it’s easy to downplay the value of a co-worker who is not in agreement. Reminding themselves of the other’s value may restore balance. But more than a “touchy feely” approach, these types need to quantify real results, or potential results, for each to take this assessment seriously. Doing so not only helps to break the stalemate but might also help the co-workers revisit some of the ways that those they work with might be better utilized. Here is one way to approach it:

To explore a chronically contentious relationship at work, take an inventory of the other person's success or their measurable movement toward success. The inventory should be real profiles in productivity and not simply a list of qualifications. Reciting qualifications, labels or degrees, may impress, but they don't necessarily speak to effectiveness and results.

Once the inventory is complete, review how much of the material on the list is still relevant to future work and goals.

- What have the Consuls or Analysts done or what are they doing well, and how can that be applied to the job at hand?
- Where do the co-worker's work interests overlap?
- How can they strategically tap into the others skills or strengths to be even more effective as a team?

Taking Oneself More Lightly

Misunderstanding of other personality types is not always about the other person. Often, it is because one or both parties take their style too seriously. For Consuls, it's that everyone should be happy and harmonious while adapting to the standards they have accepted. Those who don't comply may find themselves subtly shunned by Consuls, or even directly challenged if they've really pushed too far. For Analysts, taking themselves too seriously takes the form of exaggerating the importance of their rationality and foisting their opinions too aggressively onto others. They may at times fail to hear others' opinions, assuming theirs to be superior.

Therefore, rebalancing means finding some way to appreciate style diversity in the workplace and admitting that dissimilar styles still offers value to the workplace. For Consuls, rebalancing involves looking at the essentials Analysts bring – things like

being data-driven, rational, and their focus on accuracy and efficiency. For Analysts, rebalancing involves understanding that the company is a system that relies on human capital and that humans like the appreciation and stability found in the Consuls' style.

Consul-Diplomat Workplace Cooperation



Balanced Consul-Diplomat Workplace Cooperation

Consuls and Diplomats are kindred spirits. As a team, they are mostly interested in the human factors which permeate most workplaces. Consuls view others from a down-to-earth perspective, and Diplomats empathize to a degree bordering on the spiritual. They share the Feeling Trait and the Judging Trait which leaves them both passionate about their beliefs and standards, and how they apply, not only to themselves but others as well.

Consensus and Cooperation

Both Consuls and Diplomats respect consensus and cooperation. Both are happiest when people are in agreement, and everyone is getting along. It's unsettling for either

of them to face conflict or to have to deal with any form of hostility or disagreement (although fighting for the right principle can bring the warrior out in both). Together, Consuls and Diplomats may bring a sense of unity to the workplace and smooth over some of the rough edges caused by a variety of people with varied working styles in the same place.

Consuls and Diplomats both like the idea of people becoming “better.” As mentioned above, Consuls look for improvement according to the standards they set or adhere to. Diplomats are more likely to encourage people to grow in their way, although they do oppose anything that feels like others have wandered into morally questionable areas. While their focuses are different, it’s still conceivable that balanced Consuls and Diplomats can find common ground in personnel training and development. Together, they might build a program that not only provides precise skills or understanding but also takes into account the differing interests and abilities of those who participate.

Alike but Different

It would be an oversimplification to say that Consuls are doers while Diplomats are strictly dreamers. Certainly, Consuls dream in their fashion and Diplomats act in theirs. But despite the reality of some overlap, Consuls are the more practical of the two types.

It’s a subjective judgment call to say pragmatism is a more vital tool at work than being a visionary- and a lot depends on job descriptions. In the case of Consuls working with Diplomats and sharing the touchstone of the Feeling Trait with them, there’s plenty of room for complementary cooperation despite their unique styles of doing things. For example, while Diplomats may explore new ideas about workplace

cohesion and present theories around that, Sentinels can add their pragmatic magic to the ideas and find applications that work in a specific business. Diplomats can provide a vision that resonates with Consuls, and Consuls then translate it to real life. Their end goals are likely the same: a place where people effectively work together and experience some form satisfaction while doing so.

Unbalanced Consul-Diplomat Workplace Cooperation

Oppressive Caring

In their zeal to make life better for their fellow employees and to improve their lives, Consuls and Diplomats will often decide that they know what is best for others. If they work closely together, they are likely to reinforce that belief in each other. In short, they may push their ideas and preferred actions as something others should do for “their own good.” In fact, both types have been known to insist on it, and, therein, lies the problem.

Consul and Diplomat co-workers both have a focus on others and a Judging Trait that organizes their views. In the extreme, they can combine the two and become a little tyrannical about their own ways. While their goal is unity and cohesiveness, such strict expectations of others can create the opposite atmosphere – denying the individual characteristics, preferences, and styles of coworkers can be divisive.

Hard Matters and Soft Matters

With both so focused on human capital, attitudes, and behaviors and less on objective measures, Consuls and Diplomats potentially set up an echo chamber that may distract from a business. Where others may be insisting on more data-driven

proof of effectiveness, Consuls and Diplomats working together may create more drama-driven outcomes.

In business, there is often talk of soft skills, the kind Consuls and Diplomats excel in, and hard skills, those that bring more direct results. Both types are important, but if allowed to shift out of balance, they can contribute to a workplace being difficult. Without the soft “human” skills that Consuls and Diplomats working together might deliver, there can be low morale leading indirectly to loss of productivity. However, too much focus on that and it saps energy from the results that make businesses viable. If Consul and Diplomat co-workers manage to create an echo chamber that is dense in emotional decision-making, their contribution dilute more task-oriented endeavors.

Rebalancing Consul-Diplomat Workplace Cooperation

Finding Common Ground

There is no doubt that rules and standards are necessary on the job and Consuls stand as guardians of such things, providing stability and consistency. But when too much of a legalistic approach turns humans into cogs in a machine designed to do someone else’s bidding, blending in some of the intuitive connections that Diplomats excel in forming can help “rehumanize” the process. This is the balance: maintaining structure while respecting individuality. Both are vital in the workplace. Rejecting the Consuls’ focus invites chaos. Rejecting the Diplomats’ invites low morale.

At some point, when rebalancing work relationships between different types, the word “tolerance” always comes up. There is an economy among the differing personalities. All types are needed, and none is wasted. The person who navigates relationships between types best is the person who goes beyond tolerating to

embracing the valuable gifts other types bring. For the Consuls, it may mean accepting that Diplomats bring a different dimension of feeling that has a greater respect for the individual. For their part, Diplomats can learn to be more realistic and practical in their treatment of others.

To achieve this better, Consuls and Diplomats may need to establish an understanding of the motivations and foundational beliefs of the other. Fortunately, both are interested in exploring such things, even if they may, at times, be a little reluctant to accept what they hear. They are often caught up in their assumptions. One way to build a better understanding of each is to find a way to test the things they assume about their coworkers. Simple assumption testing can clear up a lot of conflict both between Consuls and Diplomats. Once they've resolved their conflicts, they are likely to be well-practiced at doing so when it comes to doing so with those who do not fit their Feeling and Judgment Trait ideals. This can set a precedent for how to deal with others.

- Take a situation where there is disagreement. It may be safer to start with milder situations until trust is built.
- Now, write three assumptions about how the other person views the situation.
- Test the assumptions. Ask the other person if the held assumption about them is true. It's important to remember to listen free of judgment. This isn't about correcting the other person, but understanding them better. If possible, a neutral observer to cry "foul" when judgments are delivered, may help. But at the minimum, self-monitoring is required.
- Finally, when everyone's assumptions are clear, look for common ground. Where do the approaches overlap? Where can they be used together to improve things?

Letting Go

Just because both Diplomats and Consuls rely on the feeling trait for their decisions doesn't mean that either lacks rationality. In fact, there's rationality in emotional decision-making. At times, it makes sense to decide from one's emotional intelligence. But a more basic rationality may be exactly the thing to turn to when more emotional agendas are at odds.

One of the best ways to break a stalemate is to introduce a new element to the mix. That may sound obvious, but it's easy to forget when standing one's ground in a contentious situation. For Consuls and Diplomats, introducing that "new element" may mean simply sitting down and trying a colder, more rational approach. Perhaps it is helpful, in such situations, to invite the input of someone who has a more analytical mind. Balancing all the elements of good decision-making is likely to be more effective than just relying on a preferred style.

Consul-Sentinel Workplace Cooperation



Balanced Consul-Sentinel Workplace Cooperation

Consuls are one of the types in the Sentinel Role group. Each type in the group shares the Observant Trait and the Judging with the other three types. The chief things they have in common are a rigorous work ethic, a reverence for tradition or rules according to the culture they're a part of, and a solid respect for all things practical.

Working with other Sentinels appeals to Consuls' pragmatism. With their Sentinel peers, they can avoid some of the issues they face with their less practical colleagues. While some Sentinels may not share the Consuls' Extraverted sociability or the Feeling Trait that, when combined, makes them so gregarious, they all share a focus on being reliable and loyal.

A Shared Sense of Mission

Consuls and other Sentinels honor efficiency, details, and protocols. As Consuls ascend, as they typically do, to their roles as leaders, they may rely heavily on other Sentinels to help them meet their goals. They may feel confident that their Sentinel cousins understand their objectives, and that like-mindedness fosters connections. When balanced, other Sentinels can help them stay on track and help them focus on the practical ends rather than interpersonal dramas that may occur along the way.

Consuls and their Sentinel cousins have an appreciation for a clear direction uncluttered by information that they feel is impractical. That would include anything theoretical, or anything that too harshly challenges the established system. Interactions between them are likely to focus on the next best step to take. They're not prone to bog themselves down with a lot of discussions involving "why" questions, being more inclined to "how" questions. That shouldn't imply a lack of

concern about the reason behind strategies, but once they embark on a plan, Consuls and Sentinels aren't likely to revisit or revise rationales often.

Shared Sensibilities

Not all Sentinels share the Consuls' preference for friendliness and harmony, especially the introverted among them. The combination of the Extraversion trait and the Feeling trait sets Consuls apart from all other Sentinels and makes them the most social among them. However, all Sentinels have a strong interest in the welfare of the people in their lives, even if they don't express it as openly as Consuls. This aura of service to others bonds Consuls to other Sentinels in tacit ways and inspires diligence in both.

Consuls and Sentinels, sitting together in the lunchroom, discuss down-to-earth matters. The conversation flows easily due to shared basic values. Among other things, the diners may discuss their work and the progress of their projects. Work is serious business to both. They may discuss the strengths and weaknesses of their co-workers – maybe basing their judgments on a co-worker's effectiveness, but just as likely measuring them against some more formal set of standards.

Unbalanced Consul-Sentinel Workplace Cooperation

Time with like-minded co-workers can be a pleasure. However, it can also help create an insular environment. Pairing with a similar type can sometimes result in a tedious abundance of sameness. For Consuls-Sentinel collaborations, the tedium plays out mainly through their established expectations and a lack of flexibility.

A Chorus of Agreement

While embracing established methods promotes stability, being unreceptive to new ideas bodes poorly in the modern business world. Few businesses have remained as they were 20 years ago. They will be unrecognizable 20 years from now. Too many Sentinels in a room can potentially slow innovation and, consequently, productivity, to a snail-like pace, harming competitiveness.

Consuls and Sentinels demonstrating unbalanced cooperation support each other in rejecting needed innovations, forming a wall of opposition. They show an intolerance for those who introduce an unorthodox method too quickly. Too much combined Sentinel reverence for tradition turns new ideas and methods into a threat to their established means of operating, at least initially.

Should Consuls ascend to leadership, depending on those too similar to themselves may create a cluster of “yes” people as advisors, who are less likely to offer constructive criticism or useful pushback. Unbalanced Consuls welcome the otherwise dreaded echo chamber.

Playing it Safe

Another problem that may arise from an unbalanced Consul-Sentinel echo chamber is a raised aversion to risk. These types working together may simply play it too safe. Added responsibility tempers risky behavior. With Consuls’ and Sentinels’ reverence for tradition and their feeling of responsibility for the people in their lives, they may avoid even the most necessary risks out of fear of hurting either.

They would prefer the tried and true over the risky experimental. But then, hesitating too long can be deadly in a time of change. To say it casually, “If you snooze, you

lose.” Risk-averse Consuls and Sentinels keep things steady, but perhaps, at times, too steady. Sentinels are the least impulsive group, and it may be prudent to add the voices of some who are willing to take chances to the conversation. History is full of examples of people who lost out because they were too cautious and hesitant. Sentinels and Consuls, in particular, can be judgmental when they see others fail. This can make them less willing to risk the judgment of others by taking a chance that might lead to failure.

Rebalancing Consul-Sentinel Workplace Cooperation

Invite Diverse Input

Support from Sentinels can empower Consuls. But so can recognizing that such relationships have limits and acknowledging that helpful alternatives may exist just a step outside of this pairing’s comfort zone. Rebalancing may be as simple as considering that a current set of options may be too narrow and making a deliberate decision to add diverse voices to the conversation which may come from inviting

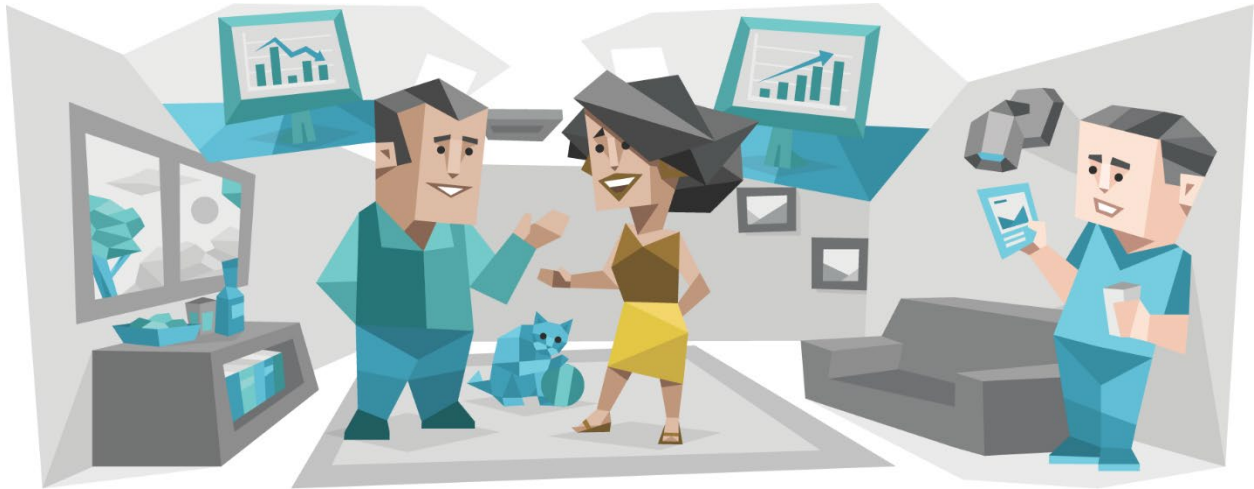
It’s difficult to invite dissenting voices to the table. People enjoy others agreeing with them. However, if dissent is needed, an invitation isn’t usually required. They are probably already there. They may be silent and in the background due to a too rigid work culture. Sometimes, they are simply ignored. Creating a more accepting environment or developing an individual attitude of openness can bring needed devil’s advocates out of the shadows. When Consul-Sentinel dominated groups place the search for workable solutions over the comfort of being agreed with, valuable alternative voices begin to feel welcomed.

Failing Fast

Business author Tom Peters advises, “Test fast. Fail fast. Adjust fast.” He is describing the current swift momentum that sweeps most businesses along. Such advice can send a shiver down the spine of the typical predictability-loving Sentinel. Adopting the mindset that life is a series of calculated risks can help Sentinels cling to safety a little less. As the familiar old saying goes, “Ships are safe in harbor, but that’s not what ships are for.”

Consuls and their Sentinel co-workers might work together to create a culture that is tolerant of reasonable failure and experimentation. Inviting other personality types to offer their opinions and giving them enough breathing space to try new things can help Sentinels discover the value of taking risks and trying innovative ideas. Perhaps, instituting panels that include a diverse level of experience, where available, can help nourish a more inventive climate. The more experienced can blend the benefit of their wisdom and histories with novel ideas of the less experienced who are not as influenced by tradition. Their mission would be to create a synergy of their perspectives. Such panels would both protect the tradition and standards Sentinels love while promoting new ways of thinking.

Consul-Explorer Workplace Cooperation



Consuls share the Observant trait with all Explorers and the Extraversion and Feeling Trait with some of them. What they don't share with any Explorers is their Judging Trait, and this one trait can powerfully influence the others. The Prospecting Explorers have a much more casual relationship with standards and rules than Consuls. Where Consuls enjoy predictability and order, their Explorer colleagues like novelty. This difference colors all their interactions both positively and negatively.

Balanced Consul-Explorer Workplace Cooperation

Complementary Work Relationship

It's easy to get the impression that Consuls and Explorers are complete opposites. Consuls are likely to view Explorers as impulsive and irresponsible. Explorers likely see Consuls as friendly, but rigid and unadventurous. Those might be unbridgeable gaps between the two types if they didn't share a deep respect for a mutual attention to concrete matters.

Consuls and Explorers most often complement each other when things go wrong. Consuls have a repertoire of reliable solutions, but those occasionally fail in novel situations. When this happens, Explorer co-workers are irreplaceable. They think on their feet and are masters at solving unexpected issues. If Consuls and Explorers can learn to appreciate their differences, they can develop an effective tag-team approach to cover the routine and the unexpected.

Balanced Attitude

Consuls and Explorers are so dissimilar that they can balance each other almost perfectly. Consuls may have trouble admitting they need free spirits like Explorers on their teams, but even they at times must admit they can be too uptight. Explorers may worry that “playing the game” may rob them of their independence, but they may quietly admit to themselves that a little more structure could make their lives better.

When such coworkers find a way to blend their perspectives, they can be dynamic in covering both those things that require protocols and those that need improvisation. Consul and Explorers who successfully work together adopt a “best of all worlds” attitude and succeed in covering all contingencies.

Unbalanced Consul-Explorer Workplace Cooperation

Tight Ship versus Free-form Solutions

Consuls may appreciate Explorers’ clever, spontaneous solutions that save the day on occasion. However, there are limits, and they will likely reach a point where the Explorers’ disregard for the rules becomes too much. Rules represent stability to all Sentinels. There is nothing more important to Consul than a harmonious workplace

resting on social conventions. Explorers who take too many liberties may begin to represent a serious threat to its overall steadiness.

If Consuls are the boss or manager, they may clamp down excessively on Explorers. An attempt to pull them into the fold and to make sure they march lockstep with others can damage a sound working relationship by ignoring the strengths Explorers would otherwise bring. Tightening the reins beyond a straightforward list of objectives may be ill-advised.

Should Explorers be in charge, Consuls may feel that things are a bit chaotic. They may continuously look to the leader to enforce order and then experience some disappointment when they don't. Consuls may lose respect for their Explorer managers who they may view as being "sloppy" with protocols. They may even feel condescending toward their undisciplined superior. They may even reach a point where they can no longer abide their manager's lack of structure and challenge them directly. This rebellious attitude would be uncharacteristic to Consuls who have deep respect hierarchies and usually display loyalty to their superiors.

Losing Autonomy

Independence is a major concern for Explorers. However, there are rules to follow, and Consuls may feel an obligation to reject Explorers and their freewheeling ways. They may forget that their independent thinking is the thinking that inspires their timely, perhaps unorthodox solutions. Explorers not only think outside the box, but they also reject the very notion that the box exists. Meanwhile, unbalanced Consuls may try everything they can to construct one around them.

Explorers who feel trapped always develop exit strategies. When Consuls challenge Explorers' autonomy without some respect for the purpose it serves in their lives,

there exists the possibility of failure on many levels. Rejecting Explorers' independent natures and independent thinking is rejecting the valuable talents they bring to the table. The Consul in trying to control the unpredictable Explorer may lose a valuable asset. In trying to do so, they demonstrate a deep disrespect for their coworkers and lessen the chance for successful collaboration. This the exact opposite of what they generally aspire to accomplish.

Rebalancing Consul-Explorer Workplace Cooperation

A Courageous Exchange

Taking a leap of faith and trusting another's unproven methods takes a great deal of courage – especially for types who thrive on being 'in the know', like Consuls. Courageous Consuls might look for ways to learn from the attitudes of Explorers. Explorers' love of change, new stimulation, and general independence can help Consuls broaden their perspectives a little if they're willing to go along for the ride. Professional growth comes from expanding one's comfort zone, and Explorers certainly dabble with things beyond those boundaries.

Likewise, Consuls can help willing Explorers become more attuned to accepted social standards. Whether they approve of them or not, there are always established expectations in business. Consuls can help them get a handle on them should they wish to climb the ladder to a higher position or take their job skills to a new level. When playing this game, chalking up another win is usually achieved by playing by the rules – but sometimes those rules need to be bent or broken to get done what needs to be done.

However, none of this comes without effort. First, comes awareness, then a commitment to appreciating the value the other offers. There is no mechanical or

physical trick or exercise to bring about such appreciation on a comprehensive scale. One might try something like thinking of three good things to say about someone before criticizing them or adding them to their gratitude list in specific and descriptive ways as first aid. But ultimately, it's a matter of decision and attitude. Consuls may want to decide to appreciate the fresh and slightly rebellious attitudes that Explorers bring to their work lives, especially when they produce results.

The Explorer Two-Step

Consuls who work with Explorers may want to think of this experience as a kind of dance. Dancing with a partner usually assumes an element of flexibility, where the partners anticipate each other's moves – yet there is some structure maintained in their movements. The delicate dance of knowing when to assert boundaries and rules and when to let Explorers try unorthodox moves on their own is essential for Consuls who work with them.

When it matters, Consuls may want to enforce protocols. When it's not that important, perhaps they might loosen up a bit. Again, that doesn't mean wholesale disregard for the rules, but exercising a little more flexibility and taking a bit of a risk can pay off at times. In doing so, they are acknowledging the positive attributes of their Explorer colleagues and are a step closer to providing the unity at work that they desire.

Conclusion

The lesson for Consuls may be that those who learn to include diverse personality types and styles in their work lives will find that they add more talents to their collaborations. Learning to appreciate their professional strengths and weaknesses

and those of other types can help them find a way to navigate work and life more effectively. Letting go of some of their preconceptions and expectations can also liberate them to grow in their own professional lives.

Some have said that when people come to the end of their lives, they are unlikely to think about all the hours they spent at work as a highlight of existence. That may be true for most, but it might not apply to Consuls. For them, their work is likely to be a defining part of themselves, one aspect of a life well-lived. Within it, there may be much to remember fondly, both as they review their professional accomplishments and the social connections they built at work. Their final thoughts may well honor this part of their lives.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your professional development? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Job Preferences Test](#)

Among the most important things you decide in life is how you're going to make a living. Discover which job fields fit you best.

[Job Burnout Test](#)

We've all heard the term "burnout." But what does it mean to you? This test will guide you as you take a look at how burnout affects you.

[Career Values Test](#)

What should your job look like for you to call it "ideal"? What aspects matter most to you? This tool will help you answer these questions.

[Leadership Styles Test](#)

What is your leadership style? There is no right or wrong answer to that question. This test will help clarify your preferred approach.

[Leadership Styles II Test](#)

The second part of our Leadership Styles test will explore your desire to be a leader and willingness to delegate power.

Motivation Test

On average, we work for about 90,000 hours over our lifetime. With that in mind, it's helpful to figure out exactly what motivates you.

Ambition Test

How eager are you to succeed, and at what cost? Ambition can be a double-edged sword – explore how it works in your case.

Professional Authenticity Test

When at work, are you acting in a way that is consistent with your true self? Explore difficult questions about authenticity with this test.

Goal Orientation Test

What's the underlying motivation you feel when confronting a challenge? See which of the Goal Orientations influences you most.

Type Guesser (Workplace)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your coworker belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Final Words



Community Pillars

No type possesses a greater sense of real-world connection than Consuls. A desire to participate drives them in all areas of life, and when they balance their tendencies and actions wisely, that involvement leads to a happy and productive life. For this type, being a pillar often means constructing that support personally, thrusting their hands into the mortar of life and shaping the world around them – not only building themselves to a high standard, but trying to raise others as well. When done with kindness, grace, and respect for people’s individual needs and truths, this type’s firm outreach becomes the building blocks of a balanced, beautiful society.

Whether it’s their own family, a romantic partner, bonds in their professional lives, academic peers, or simply personal friends, Consuls gladly place themselves firmly in the midst of their chosen community. Never ones to shy away from work, Consuls feel a responsibility to make things better, and this can be a great gift. Such investment not only strengthens any group, it invites positive feedback and mutual participation – a Consul’s reward is often seeing how their own energy gets others

moving in the right ways. If being a pillar means offering a support, then helping people to stand on their own is an even greater accomplishment.

A Giving Structure

As Consuls seek to implement their values, they inevitably find challenges, as no great effort is free of resistance. And yet, when this type evolves themselves, they find that a little flexibility makes any challenge easier to overcome. Learning when structure can – and should – be modified is a major step in the personal growth of this type. A balanced sense of responsibility and diligence motivates them to examine their lives to see where improvement is due. There's no shame in questioning what once seemed solid in the pursuit of making life better, and Consuls certainly have the will to advance beyond unproductive routines.

This isn't to say that this type shouldn't embrace their traditions – a pragmatic appreciation for what works well is partly what enables Consuls to not only feel secure, but to be reliable and productive as people. The key for this type is connecting with the heart of what makes a tradition valuable, not merely accepting an alluring veneer of predictability. Often, lofty values and strong principles are strengthened by finding new ways to express them – a structure with a little “give” remains active, offering the most benefit in life. When their exacting will is tempered by the depth of their hearts, Consuls always find ways to be happy.

The Road Ahead

We've covered many different topics in this profile, and we hope that the chapters have offered insight and answered questions about the Consul personality type. We hope that readers will now find it easier to understand other people and their perspectives. This profile isn't meant to be read just once. When trying to understand

another person better, or struggling to understand oneself, another read-through can offer fresh insight.

Furthermore, spend some time on our [website](#) – for example, by exploring our [articles](#) or [additional assessments](#). If you lead a team, our [Team Assessments](#) can help you understand its unique dynamics. There is a wealth of inspiring advice and information on the website, and we strongly recommend that you take a look. If you have some spare time, consider lending us a helping hand by taking additional [surveys](#) or simply [sending us a message](#) and sharing your thoughts about this profile or the website in general. We would love to hear from you.

We wish the best of luck to all Consuls. What matters most in Consuls' lives is that their paths through life reflect who they are, deep within. Reflecting on values, dreams, and ideals often reveals the right path through life by clearing out superficial distractions. Our lives are often too full of troubles, conflicts, and worries. By working to better understand each other, we can make our relationships, communities, and world more aware, more genuine, and more peaceful.

Until next time.

Addendum: The Puzzle of Personality

Often the very first question people ask after completing our personality test is “What do these letters mean?” We are of course referring to those mysterious acronyms like INTJ-A, ENFP-T, or ESTJ-A. As you may have already learned from the Type Descriptions or articles on the website, the five letters of these acronyms each refer to a specific trait, with certain trait combinations forming various types and type groups. But before we discuss those traits in depth, let’s explore their historical foundations.

The Historical Detour

Since the dawn of time, humans have drawn up schematics to describe and categorize our personalities. From the four temperaments of the ancient civilizations to the latest advances in psychology, we have been driven to fit the variables and complexities of human personality into well-defined models. Although we are still some time away from being able to do that, the current models account for our most important personality traits and can predict our behavior with a high degree of accuracy.

Personality is just one of many factors that guide our behavior, however. Our actions are also influenced by our environment, our experiences, and our individual goals. On our website, we describe how people belonging to a specific personality type are likely to behave. We outline indicators and tendencies, however, not definitive guidelines or answers. Significant differences can exist even among people who share a personality type. The information on this website is meant to inspire personal

growth and an improved understanding of yourself and your relationships – not to be taken as gospel.

Our approach has its roots in two different philosophies. One dates back to early 20th century and was the brainchild of Carl Gustav Jung, the father of analytical psychology. Jung's theory of psychological types is perhaps the most influential creation in personality typology, and it has inspired a number of different theories. One of Jung's key contributions was the development of the concept of Introversion and Extraversion – he theorized that each of us falls into one of these two categories, either focusing on the internal world (Introvert) or the outside world (Extravert). Besides Introversion and Extraversion, Jung coined the concept of so-called cognitive functions, separated into Judging or Perceiving categories. According to Jung, each person prefers one of these cognitive functions and may most naturally rely on it in everyday situations.

In the 1920s, Jung's theory was noticed by Katharine Cook Briggs, who later co-authored a personality indicator still used today, the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator® (MBTI®). Briggs was a teacher with an avid interest in personality typing, having developed her own type theory before learning of Jung's writings. Together with her daughter, Isabel Briggs Myers, they developed a convenient way to describe the order of each person's Jungian preferences – this is how four-letter acronyms were born.

Of course, this is just a very simplified description of the Myers-Briggs theory. Readers interested in learning more should read *Gifts Differing: Understanding Personality Type* by Isabel Briggs Myers. As we define personality traits and types differently in our model, we will not go deeper into Jungian concepts or related theories in this article.

Due to its simplicity and ease of use, the four-letter naming model has been embraced by a number of diverse theories and approaches over the last few decades, including frameworks such as Socionics, Keirsey Temperament Sorter, Linda Berens' Interaction Styles, and many others. While the acronyms used by these theories may be identical or very similar, however, their meanings do not always overlap. One of the reasons behind such a lengthy introduction is that we want to make it clear that there is no single definition assigned to these type acronyms – each theory defines them in their own way and it is entirely possible that if you meet five people who all say “I am an INFJ”, their definitions of what INFJ means are going to differ.

Types vs. Traits

Regardless of its structure, any type-based theory will struggle to describe or characterize people whose scores lie near the dividing line. A different way to look at personalities is through the lens of a trait-based rather than a type-based model. What do we mean by that? Instead of creating an arbitrary number of categories and attempting to fit people within them, a trait-based model simply studies the degree to which people exhibit certain traits.

You may have heard the term Ambivert, which is a perfect example in this case. Ambiversion means that someone falls in the middle of the Introversion-Extraversion scale, being neither too outgoing nor too withdrawn. Trait-based theories would simply say that an Ambivert is moderately Extraverted or moderately Introverted and leave it at that, without assigning a personality type.

A trait-based approach makes it easier to reliably measure correlations between personality traits and other characteristics – for example, political attitudes. This is why trait-based approaches dominate psychometric research, but that's more or less

the only area where these approaches are dominant. Because they don't offer types or categorizations, trait-based theories don't translate as well as type-based theories into specific recommendations and takeaways. Assigned categories such as Extravert or Introvert may be limiting, but they allow us to conceptualize human personality and create theories about why we do what we do – something that a more scientifically reliable but colorless statement, such as you are 37% Extraverted, simply cannot do.

Our Approach

With our NERIS® model, we've combined the best of both worlds. We use the acronym format introduced by Myers-Briggs for its simplicity and convenience, with an extra letter to accommodate five rather than four scales. However, unlike Myers-Briggs or other theories based on the Jungian model, we have not incorporated Jungian concepts such as cognitive functions, or their prioritization. Jungian concepts are very difficult to measure and validate scientifically, so we've instead chosen to rework and rebalance the dimensions of personality called the Big Five personality traits, a model that dominates modern psychological and social research.

Our personality types are based on five independent spectrums, with all letters in the type code (e.g. INFJ-A) referring to one of the two sides of the corresponding spectrum. You can see where you fall on each scale by completing our free personality assessment, NERIS Type Explorer®. This approach has allowed us to achieve high test accuracy while also retaining the ability to define and describe distinct personality types.

Five Personality Aspects

This section will describe five personality aspects that, when combined, define the personality type: Energy, Mind, Nature, Tactics and Identity. Each of these aspects should be seen as a two-sided continuum, with the “neutral” option placed in the middle. The percentages you would have seen after completing the test are meant to show which categories you fall under, and how strong your preferences are.

Let us now go through the personality aspects one by one:

Introverted vs. Extraverted

More Than People Power

When considering people who are Introverts (I) and Extraverts (E), it's natural to go straight to the more social aspects of these personality traits. However, they are more than this. These traits are also defined by their broader response to their environments, which includes other people but isn't exclusively about them.

Introvert (I) Personality

Strength in Reserve

Introverts are well-suited to many situations. A tendency to be reserved helps these personality types to pace themselves. They're likely to listen to others more carefully. Very introspective, Introverts enjoy more focused “alone time” – leading to more and deeper insights. And, while sometimes too sensitive to their environments, this often helps them pick up cues more quickly, making them great at reading many situations.

However, this same reserve means that Introverts tend to find outside stimuli like noise, motion, or intrusive lighting frustrating. Some of this can be an invigorating change of pace – too much unsettles them and drains their energy. These personality types often prefer to be in their own space where they can adjust their environments. Add a human factor to this sensitivity – for example, insistent conversations where they're expected to be just as insistent – and it can exhaust them. They need time alone to regather their energy and restore their calm.

Introverts' reserved, more solitary nature presents challenges, as many societies favor Extraverts and their bolder approach. But it helps Introverted personality types to take things slowly, cautiously, and with less fanfare. Fortunately, if they're willing – and create the time to recharge on their own – most Introverts can handle society's strenuous demands.

In fact, many successful leaders and entertainers come from their ranks, often remaining humble and avoiding an unnecessary spotlight in fame. The Introversion personality trait never needs to disqualify those who possess it from pursuing a goal.

Extravert (E) Personality

The Power of Engagement

Extraverts are interested in engaging with their environment, and they feed off the responses of the people and events around them. They enjoy pushing limits and seeing what the world can do. This all depends on many other factors and life's natural limitations, but Extraverted personality types lean toward taking the initiative and relying on the world around them for validation.

While all of this is noble and often admired in society, it can also become unbridled. Extraverts may put too much value in their engagement with those around them. Being with others can be so important to these personalities that they often find it difficult if they're stuck alone. Boredom comes too easily. This can lead them to do things simply for excitement rather than thinking through more subtle but important considerations. Becoming the center of attention – at any cost – might be too appealing.

However, when they suitably address these challenges, Extraverts are forces to be reckoned with. People with this personality trait tend to advance projects important to them quickly, whether personal or professional. They often choose to lead when given a chance – and can be dynamic in that role. Their outgoing energy can be vital to a social gathering, and their liveliness can be contagious. And there always remains a sense that people are important to them.

Intuitive vs. Observant

Thought at Every Scale

Our second personality scale includes the Intuitive (N) and Observant (S) styles. These traits describe what people are more likely to do with the information gathered from the world around them. Intuitive personality types rely on imagining the past and future potential of what they see. Those with the Observant style are more interested in observable facts and more straightforward outcomes. They prefer to avoid layering too much interpretation on what they see.

Being Intuitive doesn't mean someone can't be practical, and being Observant doesn't mean a lack of imagination. They both use their minds and their physical

senses well. The difference is the spin they put on their experiences – it's where their thinking goes after an encounter with their environment. If Intuitive personality types appreciate Observant types' practicality, and Observant personality types appreciate Intuitive types' imaginative perspective, they can complement each other in ways that make for unbeatable partnerships.

Intuitive (N) Personality

Eyes on the Horizon

People with the Intuitive trait prefer to exercise their imaginations as they seek new ideas and possibilities. They live their day-to-day lives just like any other personality type. But while that's happening, their minds tend to point inward while at the same time gently focusing somewhere beyond the horizon. Their lives are ones of questioning, wondering, and connecting the dots in the "bigger picture," and they love the theoretical. They often ask, "What if?" and ponder the possibilities the future might hold.

But Intuitive people aren't always the most practical, preferring instead to give things deeper meaning. There may be a long wait as these personality types allow their imaginations free rein. They may also leap in too quickly to more complex matters. An entire theory can come together in moments, leaving others confused. In either case, they can appear out of touch to the Observant individuals in their lives. For some Intuitive folk, there may be some truth to this observation.

That said, when there's a need for innovation or a different perspective, people with Intuitive personality types can usually step up and provide a new direction. Practicality can sometimes be overrated, especially when a situation calls for serious change and "coloring outside the lines." This is where Intuitive people shine. They

bring interesting dimensions to life beyond everyday ideas – and take those who decide to go along with them.

Observant (S) Personality

Do What Works

The phrase “real-time” was created with Observant individuals in mind. They’re most in touch with what occurs in front of them, in the present. This doesn’t mean Observant personality types have no regard for the past and future. But they view both from the perspective of how each influences their present actions. This makes them focused and practical people. They mostly root their thinking in the actionable, tangible, and useful. But make no mistake, these personalities can be creative within that realm.

One challenge people with the Observant personality trait may face is a too-narrow perspective. They may reject far-reaching solutions in favor of something more obvious. By continuing something that appears practical at arm’s length but doesn’t fit the bigger picture, they might reduce their hard work to busywork.

People with the Observant trait are often a steadying force that tends to get things done. Their energy is very “hands-on” in the sense of working on real things in real-time. While they’re often smart people, spending a lot of time sitting around and pondering possibilities doesn’t cut it for Observant personality types. They want thoughts and talk to lead to action.

Thinking vs. Feeling

How to Think and Feel About the Thinking and Feeling Traits

Our third, Nature scale reveals the extent to which we value emotions or rationality more when considering options. Does a person tend to use the Thinking (T) personality trait, which relies on the head, or the Feeling (F) trait, which relies on the heart?

But let's not oversimplify. Think of it instead as you might your hand preference: A left-handed person leans more heavily on their left hand, but they still use their right hand, albeit less. We can apply the same approach to a person with a dominant Thinking trait or a dominant Feeling trait – they aren't without some qualities of the non-dominant trait.

Thinking (T) Personality

"How Does This Help?"

When presented with a decision, people with the Thinking trait typically lean on objective information. Knowledge is their indispensable tool. Once these personality types gather the facts, they test their alternatives against logic and reason to see which decision, by those standards, proves the most effective or realistic. They generally manage their relationships by employing fairness and effectiveness as their primary method of dealing with others. Their passions are born of respect.

Whatever value people with the Thinking personality trait place on relationships, they can still dismiss emotional responses, either their own or those of others. This is often because of their discomfort with emotions, which don't always follow the rational path they value. Sometimes, emotions just puzzle them. But that doesn't

mean they have hearts of stone. They often feel in deep, profound ways – they would just rather not decide matters from that place. And, perhaps unfortunately, they may see those who do as weaker decision-makers.

Personality types with the Thinking trait are likely to evaluate things almost relentlessly. This isn't as bad as it sounds. They aren't satisfied if they believe something is not well thought out – they revel in the brilliance of an elegant plan. This makes them great to have around when critical thinking and impartiality of any kind is the focus, and this makes them immensely helpful for sorting out ideas and methods. Their primary filter is, *"How does this help?"*

Feeling (F) Personality

"Who Does This Help?"

People with the Feeling (F) trait follow their hearts and emotions – sometimes without even realizing it. They may show it to different degrees and in different ways, but however they do it, Feeling personality types tend to be caring, compassionate, and warm. These concerned people can be highly protective of those they care about – whether that is their immediate family or remote populations in need.

However, people with the Feeling personality trait often find they become excessive in their concern for others. They may easily burn out – or cause others to – when they become too involved. These emotionally aware individuals can become depressed if they feel they haven't been as selfless in life as they imagine they should be, or if those they have helped seem to fall down regardless.

Feeling personality types' concern for others typically affects all their endeavors. This can be practical and close, as with family, friends, and colleagues. Or it can be broader, as with world peace, ending hunger, and giving the disadvantaged a boost.

But this reliance on feelings doesn't mean there is no logic – theirs is just a different logic. They see that emotions can't simply be waved away, so feelings and the welfare of others shape their lives more than stark facts and cold objectivity. Weighing things this way makes these personalities valuable to have around when the big question is, “*Who does this help?*”

Judging vs. Prospecting

Crossing the Finish Line (By Whatever Means)

The Tactics scale, which includes the Judging and Prospecting personality traits, reflects how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, “Do you prefer spontaneity or certainty?” “Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?” “Do you need more choices or fewer?”

Judging (J) Personality

Making Things as They Ought to Be

People with the Judging (J) personality trait feel most comfortable when the course ahead is well-marked. They would rather come up with five backup plans than deal with events as they come. Preferring to consider their options ahead of time,

personality types with this trait prefer clarity and closure, sticking with the plan rather than going with the flow. It's as if Judging types always keep a mental checklist. When they cross something off their list – or even start an item on their list – they consider it complete and not open to reconsideration.

The downside is, if they take this too far, those with the Judging trait sometimes come across as rigid. However, most are not unreasonably stubborn. It's important to remember their need for structure always is a preference and reality often calls on them to respond in unforeseen ways. Too many surprises in a row can leave these personality types frustrated and stressed. When this happens, they can still be relied on to develop a plan (and a contingency plan), but however well they handle the unexpected, they rarely enjoy it.

Judging individuals tend to have a strong work ethic, putting their duties and responsibilities above everything else. To them, rules, laws, and standards are the key to success. They can be too dependent on these measures, whether applied to themselves or others. But the intent is almost always one of fairness and results.

Prospecting (P) Personality

Figuring Things Out as They Go

Prospecting (P) individuals are much more flexible when it comes to dealing with unexpected challenges. This flexibility helps them seize unexpected opportunities as well. These personality types tend to react to their environments rather than try to control them, helping them to make their own luck in whatever the world delivers. People with this trait hold that life is full of possibilities.

All this opportunism can lead to impulsive decision-making, though. At the same time, they can be overwhelmed by the sheer number of options on their radar. People with the Prospecting personality trait can be slow to commit to something because of uncertainty or the potential of everything else. If they don't moderate this trait, indecision or a lack of conviction can be a problem. They can seem unfocused. What was important to them one week may be forgotten the next.

Despite those concerns, this personality trait can offer a great deal of creativity and productivity. Theirs is almost a stream of consciousness quality. In many ways, it's like these types are constantly brainstorming as their minds create a web of options. This can be a powerful tool for finding solutions. And if they aren't satisfied with something in their lives, it's easier for them to let go of it and choose something else. This can lead to serial passions that keep Prospecting individuals stimulated as they explore the buffet of choices always before them.

Assertive vs. Turbulent

Confidence, Achievement, and You

The Identity scale, made up of the Assertive and Turbulent personality traits, affects all other scales and indicates how confident we are in our abilities and decisions. Identity triggers the way we react to the things life constantly throws at us. How do we respond to success and failure? Criticism or feedback from other people? Unexpected events that suddenly change many things or everything? Even the unknown future?

Assertive (-A) Personality

Calm in the Storm

Assertive individuals are self-assured, even-tempered, and resistant to stress. They don't worry too much, but this is different from apathy. They aim for goals and want successful results, but they typically won't let nervousness color the path to their accomplishments. They're unlikely to spend a lot of time thinking about their past actions or choices. According to Assertive personality types, what's done is done.

However, problems may arise for them if their confidence turns into overconfidence. Assertive individuals may gloss over problems or details that can interfere with their goals and desired results. They may lean toward assuming all will be positive. Assertive people also sometimes presume they are free to do much more than others would allow or tolerate. If overconfident, these personality types may come to believe their confidence overshadows what others want.

But their confidence remains. It can help them move forward where others might hesitate. People with this personality trait report more satisfaction with their lives. They feel more assured of their abilities to handle the difficult and the unexpected. Through this lens, they often create the kinds of success that matter to them.

Turbulent (-T) Personality

Power of Stress, Activate!

Turbulent individuals are success-driven, perfectionistic, and eager to improve. They are always trying to counterbalance their self-doubts by achieving more. Just as they push themselves to become better, they're as likely to push their projects or efforts

in the same direction. Turbulent personality types tend to notice little problems and often do something about them before they become larger ones.

There are potential downsides to all this attention and achievement. Always feeling the need to do more, to have more, and to *be* more, Turbulent individuals can also get caught up in endless thoughts of criticisms, slights, or regrets. This can either bog them down or motivate them to do better. Their sensitivity to potential problems can be useful – unless that’s all they think about and the problems clutter their attention. Turbulent personality types may compulsively scan for what might go wrong instead of keeping their eyes on more positive targets – on what could go right.

Careful and attentive people are always important to society and keep it safe. At the same time, a fear of stagnation can bring about great change. Turbulent individuals beautifully cover both. When these personalities balance their worries and concerns with positive action, they’re likely to prove themselves to be of great value.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

Our system has two layers: the first (inner) one defines our Roles, the second (outer) one – our Strategies.

Roles

Personality theory is a study of similarities among people with shared traits and how these traits might be expressed through behaviors and attitudes. Traits are the most fundamental part of our framework and include characteristics like Introversion or

Thinking. The next level contains personality types, in which four of the traits are combined and sorted to create 16 personality types. Roles, simply put, are the next level. At the Role level, the 16 types are divided into four groups.

Which personality types belong to each Role depends on two shared traits that they have in common. While all traits influence behaviors and attitudes, the two traits that determine a Role are shared by only four personality types and instill in them some unique, matching characteristics.

Those with the Intuitive trait (Analysts and Diplomats) are paired with the Thinking/Feeling traits because the Intuitive trait focuses on internal processes like thinking and feeling. While they may ultimately play out in the external world, they are primarily inward-looking.

In like manner, those with the Observant trait (Sentinels and Explorers) are paired with the Judging/Prospecting traits. Judging and Prospecting, while they have their internal aspects, are more likely to be played out in the external, concrete world of action and doing. Sentinels with their Judging trait are likely to bring order to their worlds, while Explorers with their Prospecting trait are likely to instill spontaneity into all the actions they perform.

The four Roles are primarily used when they are more likely to explain concepts in a clearer, less complicated way than involving all 16 personality types might. Using Roles this way is particularly warranted if the topic consists of a trait or traits that are a prominent part of the core traits of the various Roles – such as when Intuitive or Observant have a greater influence. But use is not limited to just that. They're like shorthand when Role commonalities suffice in talking about a subject.

In summary, Roles are just another level of the same theory, with each of the four containing four personality types. Those within a Role share a combination of two prominent traits and, therefore, share some similar characteristics.

The Role layer determines our goals, interests, and preferred activities. There are four roles:

Analysts – Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

Thinkers, Not Robots

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP) – are known for their love of rationality. Because they share the Thinking trait, these types often aim to make decisions with their heads rather than their hearts. But Analysts are far from being robots. Their Intuitive personality trait energizes their imaginations, helping them to come up with creative strategies and motivating them to explore things deeply – whether that’s an intellectual pursuit, a new interest, or even a crazy scheme or thought experiment.

These personalities are driven to understand and create. They have no problem switching between speculative musing and tactical problem-solving. Of course, these broad abilities need to be honed – and, when appropriate, they need to lead to action. Otherwise, Analysts’ active minds can give them a false sense of accomplishment.

These types often love ideas and speculation more than the realities of follow-through. As a result, they risk being outpaced by those who simply sit down and do the work. This can earn these types a reputation for being “armchair analysts” – and, at times, Analyst personalities may forget that they actually need to test their ideas in the real world.

Driven by Curiosity

Analysts are innately curious. This helps them to ensure that their ideas are workable, rather than just clever. These personality types have a strong drive to learn, and they want to find out things for themselves rather than accept received wisdom. These types may be found stockpiling books, questioning teachers, spurring debates, or driving conversations in forums across the Internet.

Analysts are also relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all of their rationality, imagination, and desire for results to make it right. Especially when it's balanced with self-understanding, this drive can enable Analyst personalities to push the boundaries of what's possible – no matter what anyone else may think.

Socially Selective

Analysts can have a reputation for being lone wolves. These personality types don't necessarily care about befriending everyone they meet, and they definitely don't surround themselves with random people just for the sake of having some company.

Given a choice between spending time with someone incompatible or spending time alone, many Analysts would choose the latter. And they may not be so subtle about it. 71% of people with Analyst personality types say they're good at shutting down unwanted conversations – far more than any other Role. This brusqueness can make Analysts seem rude, unapproachable, or antisocial, particularly to types that value social harmony.

That said, it's important to note that only 17% of Analysts actually describe their ideal social life as “mostly by myself.” Much greater numbers – 30% and 41% respectively

– say they’d prefer to have a few good friends or a partner and a few good friends. As a result, it’s inaccurate to view these personality types as antisocial.

Instead, it makes sense to view Analysts as socially selective. Like other types, they crave social connection. But these personalities won’t feel socially fulfilled by spending time with just anyone. They want to surround themselves with people who really get them – even if it takes effort to find those people. That might be why 46% of Analysts say they actively seek new friendships – which is more than any other Role except Diplomats.

Independent Minds

Analysts have little patience for following in others’ footsteps. 58% of these personality types describe themselves as “very independent” – far more than any other Role. Independence isn’t just a characteristic of these types – it’s an important part of their self-image.

This mindset shows up vividly in how Analysts approach academic and professional settings. These personality types are questioners, reluctant to take anything on faith. And “anything” includes what their teachers or bosses say.

From the outside, this might look like a lack of respect. In our Teachers Survey, Analysts were far less likely than other Roles to say they admired their past teachers. And this mindset persists in the professional sphere as well. 43% of Analysts in the workforce say they would be better than their boss at their boss’s job – again, far more than any other Role. Analyst personalities are also far less likely than other Roles to express admiration for their bosses.

But does this represent a lack of respect? Maybe – but this choosiness might well have other roots. Analysts tend to hold themselves to high standards, and they often hold the people around them (bosses and teachers included) to these high standards as well. In addition, Analyst personality types tend to care a great deal about learning and professional success. 85% of Analysts say they have a strong desire to be an important and successful person.

It makes sense, then, that these personality types hold their teachers and bosses to rigorous standards. After all, an Analyst with a poor teacher or boss may be less likely to become successful. Of course, Analysts – just like anyone – will almost certainly find themselves faced with a less-than-stellar teacher or boss. As a result, figuring out how to navigate these situations is an important part of their development.

Problems? What Problems?

You know who talks a lot about their problems? Not Analysts. In fact, 83% of Analysts say that most people complain too much about their problems.

But that doesn't mean that people with these personality types don't *think* about their problems, and they certainly don't shy away from challenges. 61% of Analysts say they're excited by the idea of being responsible for solving problems, and 85% say they enjoy tackling difficult challenges.

A core strength of Analysts is their faith in their problem-solving abilities. Analyst personalities tend to express the highest intellectual self-confidence of any Role, and this gives them the willingness to try their hand at things that may be hard. Taken too far, this can turn into cockiness – which is rarely an asset, whether in relationships or in other spheres. But as long as Analysts balance their intellectual self-assurance

with their innate curiosity, these personality types can find success and even enjoyment in the face of challenges both large and small.

Diplomats – Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Longing for Connection

Diplomat personality types – Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP) – care about helping and connecting with others. They prioritize being kind and generous, and in general, they'd rather cooperate than compete. Empathy seems to come naturally to these personalities. It can almost seem as if their hearts and minds resonate with other people's emotions.

These types aim to understand themselves and others. They often have deep insights into human nature, and they can use these insights to influence the people around them. Fortunately, Diplomat personality types tend to do this with care. They are sensitive to other people's feelings, and they want to nudge the people around them in positive directions.

Striving for Change

Diplomats have a deep belief in the ideals of humanism – altruism, compassion, and understanding. These personality types believe it is possible to create a kinder world, and they strive to do so every day.

The Intuitive trait fuels this optimism. Paradoxically, though, it also makes these types hyper-sensitive to wrongdoing. This sensitivity provides Diplomat personalities with the motivation they need to tackle injustice, which is important. If left unchecked, however, this personality trait can trigger self-righteousness or single-mindedness.

In general, Diplomats are motivated by principles rather than practicality. This helps them to stay true to their big dreams and ideas. That said, these types may have trouble enacting plans that are pragmatic rather than passion-driven. Diplomats can be tempted to ignore day-to-day tasks in favor of their big dreams and ideas. As these personalities mature, however, they often learn to balance these necessary tasks with the big-picture thinking they enjoy.

A Higher Purpose

Among friends and family, Diplomat personalities can range from quietly caring to brightly gregarious. Unfortunately, their open hearts can make them vulnerable when others are inconsiderate. That said, these types wouldn't have it any other way. Someone must trust first, and Diplomats will almost always volunteer.

These personality types see magical beauty where others see the humdrum of daily life. This trait attracts many Diplomats to creative expression. These types can be passionately inspired by music, writing, cuisine, theater – or many other creative pursuits.

Diplomats want to bring progress and beauty to the world around them. These types are led by a sense of higher purpose, and they care about serving the greater good. As a result, activism, spirituality, healing, and volunteering are common interests for these personality types.

The Need to Belong

For Diplomats, authenticity and connection aren't just buzzwords. These concepts – which might seem vague or wishy-washy to other types – form the bedrock of

Diplomats' lives. This explains why relationships matter so much to these personality types – and not just *any* type of relationship, but rather real, meaningful bonds.

When asked about their ideal social life, only 8% of Diplomats would like to spend most of their time alone. Instead, the majority of Diplomats express a desire for a partner and a few good friends. These personalities may also worry more about loneliness than other types, with nearly two thirds of Diplomats saying they worry about being lonely in their old age.

For many Diplomats, a central challenge of their lives is to balance their need for authenticity with their need to belong. More than any other personality Role, Diplomats say that the need to belong often motivates them to do things they otherwise wouldn't. This sort of behavior might not bother other types, but it poses a real dilemma for Diplomats. Being fake can feel literally painful to these types, who long to be loved and accepted for who they are, not for their ability to fit in.

For Diplomats, an important part of self-development is learning to be real – even if they fear that doing so won't make them popular. The irony is that many Diplomat personalities only feel a deep sense of belonging and connection once they learn to approach relationships as their whole, true selves.

What is Success, Anyway?

If your life goals are to earn pots of money, land an impressive job, buy a fancy car, and be better than everyone else – well, you're probably not a Diplomat.

But that isn't to say that Diplomats don't have their own type of ambition. 85% of Diplomats say it's important to them to make a lasting impact on other people, outside of their family and closest friends. In other words, these personality types

want to make a lasting difference in the world – which is no small feat. This might explain why Diplomats are second only to Analysts in saying that they sometimes set impossibly high standards for themselves.

Perhaps because they have such a lofty view of success, Diplomats are the Role least likely to consider themselves successful. It's important to note that the great majority of people with these personality types still say they'd be upset if they never became successful. As a result, many people with these types may feel as if they're constantly striving toward ideals and expectations that they'll never meet.

To address this sense of inadequacy, many Diplomats find they must let go of comparisons to other people. 79% of Diplomats say they consciously compare themselves to others either often or very often. By releasing these comparisons, Diplomats can free themselves to do things their own way, in their own time – rather than fretting over whether they're successful yet.

Time to Leap

You know that expression, “Leap and the net will appear”? Diplomat personality types can fall into the trap of thinking they've leapt – metaphorically speaking – when they're actually still perched at the ledge. Because these personalities have such active mental lives and imaginations, they can forget that thinking about starting a business isn't the same as actually starting a business, or that watching videos of dancers isn't the same as throwing themselves into a pirouette.

For many Diplomats, the secret to tackling their greatest challenge is simply to take action. Of course, that's easier said than done. The majority of Diplomats say they overthink simple tasks – so you can only imagine how much they might overthink major life decisions or their most precious dreams.

Fortunately, Diplomats tend to have a deep intuitive sense of what is right for them. Many of these personality types find that by tuning into this wisdom – and honoring it – they can find satisfaction and meaning in their everyday lives, no matter what challenges arise along the way.

Sentinels – Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Character and Competence

Sentinels – Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ) – are cooperative, practical, and grounded. They feel comfortable with who they are, and they take pride in their good character and their competence. These personality types seek order, security, and stability, and they tend to work hard to maintain their way of things. This leads to a deserved reputation as the cornerstone of any group or organization, from family to church to the office and the factory floor.

Careful and consistent, Sentinel personalities tend to be self-motivated. This means that they rarely need external inspiration to be productive and focused. They work hard and aim never to let anyone down, and they expect other people to embrace this same ethic as well. Given a choice, these personality types prefer to collaborate within a clear set of rules. Following proven methods makes more sense to them than swanning around in search of innovation. Their motto is, “If it works, don’t break it.”

Steady Progress

That said, Sentinels are hardly unimaginative. They simply take inspiration from the past rather than the future. These personality types remain loyal to established best practices and traditions, whether that’s the best way to make a pizza crust or the

most efficient way to write an algorithm. This enables them to make steady, consistent progress – which is exactly what they enjoy. Sentinels would much rather guide a single project to completion than start (and abandon) a flurry of interesting ideas.

Sentinel personalities thrive in environments that have clear hierarchies and rules. Whether or not they're in a formal leadership role, they care about setting a good example, and they gain great satisfaction from guiding a well-functioning group. This can make them excellent teachers, managers, and community officials, as well as caring parents and hosts.

Guidance and Wisdom

In their personal lives, Sentinels want to offer stability and wisdom to others. They see it as their duty to give their families safe, happy lives that prepare them for the real world. An appreciation of strong relationships allows these personality types to share generously with those they respect and love. Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make sure they hold up their end of the bargain. Birthdays, dinner parties, and camping trips are delightful events under their enthusiastic direction.

These personality types are happiest without drama – though they can occasionally be stubborn. In particular, inconsistent people can test Sentinels' patience. It can be difficult for Sentinel personalities to accept people who lack their conscientiousness. Fortunately, they often serve as engaged and caring mentors to those who wish to grow in that direction.

Love and Care

Sentinels are the personality Role least likely to say they fall in love easily – but don't let that fool you. Sentinels may not spout love poems, but they do express affection and admiration – they just do it a little differently than other personality types. Sentinels often show their love in practical ways, such as checking the tires on their partner's car or making them a nutritious dinner. To other types, these actions might not look romantic, but Sentinels do these things with love and care.

In all of their relationships, Sentinels want to make contributions. This attitude informs how they treat not only their nearest and dearest but also their acquaintances, neighbors, and coworkers. These aren't the personality types who neglect their responsibilities or leave the office kitchen a mess – in fact, they're often the types who quietly clean up other people's messes, both literal and metaphorical.

Of course, Sentinels wouldn't *mind* being recognized for the ways they help others, but these personalities rarely demand attention. Instead, they work behind the scenes to make everyone's lives run as smoothly as possible, even if that means taking on unglamorous tasks like remembering to buy toilet paper or handling their family's income taxes. They may not be obvious with their feelings, but Sentinels do care and care deeply – you just have to know how to spot it.

Due Diligence

Sentinels have a core set of principles that they bring to their academic and professional pursuits. These principles include diligence, honesty, and respect. The result is that Sentinel personality types tend to work hard, striving to meet deadlines, and generally get things done. This can be seen even from a relatively young age –

Sentinels are far more likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school.

These personality types have a clear vision of what it means to do things “right,” and they take great pride in living up to these standards. Sentinels are rarely willing to cut corners and do shoddy work – even if doing so would help them get ahead. They are less likely than any other Role to say that they could compromise some of their principles to advance their career.

Above all, Sentinels stand out for their ability to stick with their work until it’s done – even if the work is tedious or rote. These personality types are far less likely than others to say that they often abandon work in favor of doing something more interesting and fun, and they’re also less likely to say that they get distracted from what they’re working on. For Sentinels, productivity is a bit of a superpower – and they get great satisfaction from exercising their ability to get things done.

Planning Ahead

Sentinels know the value of a well-made plan. Compared to other Roles, Sentinel personalities are far more likely to say they’d rather prepare for problems rather than tackle them as they arise. And Sentinels aren’t afraid to think up every contingency that might arise – as long as they can do something to avert disaster, that is.

Of course, we can’t prepare for everything – although if anyone could, it would be a Sentinel. Like everyone else, these types must occasionally face unforeseen problems. Learning to roll with the punches, so to speak, is an important part of their personal development. Over time, Sentinels can learn to distinguish between when they should stick with their plans and when they’d do well to change course. And

when they do so, these personality types can press through even the most challenging of circumstances, bringing together determination and adaptability.

Explorers – Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

On the Fly

Explorers – Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP) – tend to be self-reliant and quick-thinking. These personality types don't mind handling uncertain situations on the fly – in fact, they live for those types of situations. Explorers' flexibility helps them to adapt to the moment, even if they don't feel particularly prepared.

These types tend not to be obsessed with precise detail – unless they're really in the zone, in which case they can muster a level of precision and focus that would make a seasoned engineer blush with envy. Usually, they prefer workability and usefulness to perfection. Explorer personalities enjoy learning different tools and techniques, from rotary saws to sheet music to emergency response strategies.

Living for Change

Explorers can change their minds with minimal regret or second-guessing. People in this Role dislike monotony, and they may stray from their obligations in order to try new things. If these personality types sometimes leave business unfinished, let clutter build up, or misplace important things – it's because they've moved on to something fresh.

These types enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. They love delving into something interesting, but their interest tends to wane as soon as something becomes "mandatory." An

Explorer personality might design and build their own dream house, but end up procrastinating on simple repairs after a few years.

Social Ingenuity

This free-form attitude can make Explorer personalities socially dynamic as well. Their spontaneity draws them to appealing strangers and interesting experiences. When things get in the way of a good time, they apply their ingenuity to get around it. Explorers want to see what happens next!

Explorers enjoy being on the leading edge of things – whether that means having the latest technology, trying out fashion trends, or checking out the newest restaurant in town. Many Explorer personalities enjoy sharing these findings with others, and they take pride in introducing their friends and loved ones to the latest and greatest things. The result is that time spent with Explorers is almost never boring or repetitive – and Explorers wouldn't have it any other way.

Explorers in Love

Explorer personality types have a reputation for constantly being on the move – and some people might wonder whether this restlessness applies to their romantic relationships as well. According to our research, however, relatively few Explorers (32%) say they're easily bored by romantic relationships that are stable and predictable. In fact, Analysts and Diplomats are significantly more likely to agree with this statement.

So, what *are* Explorers like in romantic relationships? First, Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that falling in love scares them. These personality types thrive in unpredictable situations, and what is falling in love if not unpredictable? The

early phases of a relationship are energizing for these types – full of new experiences and fresh discoveries.

It's true that Explorer personalities are somewhat more likely than other Roles to avoid commitment. Still, the majority of Explorers – 63% – say they usually seek commitment in their relationships. And overall, Explorers are slightly more likely than average to say that intimate relationships have increased their maturity more than anything else. So, while Explorers might have a reputation for being commitment-phobes, it's clear that these personality types see the deeper value of long-term relationships – and, more often than not, this is exactly what they're looking for.

Doing the Work

Explorers are highly spontaneous, connecting with their environment in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. But when they need to work on something that's frustrating or unexciting – well, that can prove something of a challenge.

This may show up in how Explorer personality types approach their academic and professional lives. Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school. They're also less likely to say that it was easy for them to do well in school. Many school environments are relatively prescriptive, filled with required courses and standardized curricula. As a result, Explorer personalities often find themselves forced to sit through classes that just don't excite them – which, for these types, can be unmotivating. Unfortunately, this can persist in their professional lives as well – after all, most jobs require at least some degree of routine, unglamorous work.

This isn't to say that Explorers are slouches – far from it. When they're working on something they're passionate about, these personality types can move heaven and earth. And, over time, they often find ways to deal with the necessary evils – in other words, the unexciting tasks – that make work and life run more smoothly.

Perhaps it's most accurate to say that Explorers look for ways to balance work with leisure. They're the Role least likely to say they make themselves finish all of their tasks before they allow themselves to relax. While some personality types might brand this behavior as laziness, this isn't necessarily the case. Explorers' ability to balance work with fun can help them avoid burnout. Ultimately, this can help them to enjoy more fulfillment – and yes, a surprising degree of productivity – in their lives.

The Power of Risk

51% of Explorers say they take risks simply for the fun of it – far more than any other personality Role. This might sound reckless, and indeed it can be. But, done responsibly, risk-taking can be one of the best ways to learn new things, solve tricky problems, and grow as people. As Explorers know, we can only make so much progress in life if we stay in our comfort zones.

As long as they temper this trait with a degree of self-control, comfort with risk can be one of Explorers' greatest strengths. It can motivate them to open up in their relationships and empower them to seek out new academic and professional opportunities.

These personality types don't resign themselves to the "lives of quiet desperation" that Henry David Thoreau famously wrote of in *Walden*. Instead, Explorers can use their own brand of bravery to free themselves from conventionality and create lives that work for them.

Strategies

The word “strategy” suggests a course of action. In our use, Strategy describes how personality types act in response to the world around them and how they might choose to accomplish things.

Strategies express themselves primarily in two ways: social style and resistance to stress. Social style entails how other people factor into an individual’s Strategy and to what degree. One example might involve whether a person prefers working in a team or alone.

Resistance to stress includes the degree of impact that a stressful situation might have on an individual and their efforts, as well as how resilient they might be when trying to restore themselves after a challenging event. An example of this might involve whether a person quits after a jarring setback or presses forward.

The Energy aspect (Introverted/Extraverted) brings to each combination a social piece. When individuals pursue their goals or satisfy their needs and wants, to what degree will they involve other people? Do they want to achieve things independently, or are they collaborators and team players? Extraverted personality types often wish to have more people around, and Introverts tend to prefer doing things more independently.

But the Energy aspect also speaks to risk and taking leaps of faith. Extraverts tend to be more adventurous, and they are brimming with enthusiasm for the activities in their lives – especially if they involve other people. Introverts feel a pull toward lone activities and are usually calmer and quieter, preferring quiet and solitude or smaller, more intimate groups when possible. Introverted personality types are not as interested in adventures as their Extraverted counterparts.

The Identity aspect (Assertive/Turbulent) describes levels of confidence and resistance to stress. It helps us understand what might motivate someone. Are they being pulled along by their self-confidence, or are they pushed to excel because they are perfectionists focused on preventing mistakes and failures?

Assertive personalities are much less likely to worry about things – even results. Their motivation may involve boldly realizing the potential that they assume they have. They are less concerned with the opinions of others and may stand up to their critics – not to impress them but to “correct” them. Turbulent personalities are self-conscious, cautious, and perfectionistic. They may go one of two ways. They may push themselves to high levels of success to avoid disappointment in themselves, or they may opt out of doing something because of the potential for stress and the chance of failure.

In summary, Strategies combine the Energy aspect and the Identity aspect. Together, they describe how individuals respond to life and reflect their preferred ways of doing things. When merged, the Energy and Identity personality traits influence many areas of life, including social preferences, confidence, stress, and risk-taking, to name a few.

The Strategy layer shows our preferred ways of doing things and achieving goals. There are four strategies:

Confident Individualism – Introverted (I) and Assertive (-A)

Substance Over Superficiality

Confident Individualists tend to trust in themselves. They enjoy their own company and don't mind spending time alone to pursue their interests. Over time, this can give these personalities an impressive range of skills and interesting ideas.

But these types take pride in their skills for their own sake, not to impress others. They tend not to see the point in social displays and bragging. While they're proud of who they are, these personality types don't always feel the need to prove themselves to anyone else. They prefer substance to superficiality and personal honesty to playing along.

Confident Individualists are motivated by their inner world rather than outside expectations. They're opinionated, but they aren't excessively worried about what others think. These personality types express their thoughts unapologetically. They're rarely pressured into agreeing with others – even if agreeing would be more convenient.

Self-Assurance and Self-Reliance

If left unchecked, this relaxed self-assurance can lead to complacency. These personality types' live-and-let-live attitude goes both ways: They don't push others to change, and in return, they don't particularly want anyone to push them to change. At times, Confident Individualists may miss information and opportunities that challenge their views because they simply don't place much importance on others' approval.

In their personal relationships, these types tend to be strong and honest. Their loyalty and affection are genuine rather than forced. These personalities only express respect and care if they really feel them. Fortunately, if they do feel them, they see no reason to hide how they feel.

No matter how strong their relationships, these types also value self-reliance. They can handle difficult situations well because they tend to be emotionally secure and resistant to stress. Although these personalities rarely seek the spotlight, their quiet examples of determination and honesty can be nothing short of inspiring.

Confident Individualists in Love

Confident Individualists tend to be a bit choosy about their closest confidants. This is especially true when it comes to finding a romantic partner. Perhaps because Confident Individualists know how to find contentment and fulfillment even when they're single, they're in no rush to settle for a partner who's less than a good match.

These personality types may also be less likely to stay with a partner who lets them down. Confident Individualists are less likely than any other personality Strategy to say they often give second chances to those who fail to fulfill commitments to them. Again, perhaps because of their strong intrinsic sense of worth, these types don't necessarily feel compelled to stay in a relationship that isn't working out.

Confident Individualists are the Strategy least likely to say they believe in soulmates. They're also the least likely to say they know a lot of couples whose marriages they envy, or would aspire to have. And it might not come as a surprise, then, that they're the most likely to say they don't want to get married.

It would be inaccurate, however, to assume that Confident Individualists are lone wolves with no interest in committed intimate relationships. The majority of these personality types – 79% – *do* express an interest in getting married. A similar percentage say they're unafraid of being committed to a single partner for the rest of their lives. It's true that Confident Individualists are independent, and they probably won't get into a relationship just for the sake of being in a relationship. That said, these types often do have an interest in romantic connection – they just want to find the right person before they become attached.

Unlikely Leaders

Confident Individualists bring their love of independence into their academic and professional pursuits. They're more likely than any other Strategy to say that learning as part of a group is distracting rather than helpful. As you can imagine, group projects can be frustrating for these personality types – whether at school or in the workplace.

This isn't to say that Confident Individualists *can't* work well with others – far from it. But if given a choice, these types would prefer to operate independently and figure things out on their own. At school, these personalities may be drawn to independent study opportunities. At work, they may try to develop a specific area of expertise that allows them to make their own decisions and do most of their tasks on their own.

From this description, Confident Individualists might not sound like natural leaders, but that isn't necessarily the case. Just over half of these personality types say they're inclined to seek out leadership and management roles. This is well less than their Extraverted peers, but it's still a majority. In addition, nearly 70% of these types say

they have excellent leadership skills. A quick look at famous Confident Individualists includes real-life leaders (Bill Gates) as well as fictional ones (Gandalf).

Confident Individualists tend to hone their ideas and skills on their own, and they often prefer to work alone. That said, these personalities may be willing to take up the reins of leadership if that's what is necessary to turn those ideas and skills into real-world progress.

The Right Mindset

Confident Individualists are more likely than any other personality Strategy to say that control over their mindset is the most important factor in determining their happiness. On average, they rank their mindset as a more significant factor in their happiness than their financial situation, their friends and family, their job, or their health.

This statistic reveals a great deal about Confident Individualists. These personality types believe in their personal effectiveness and their individual worth, and they know how important it is to maintain this mindset. As long as they balance this self-conviction with a willingness to learn from others, Confident Individualists' positive mindset can become a self-fulfilling prophecy, helping these personalities to not only achieve great things but also find lasting happiness.

People Mastery – Extraverted (E) and Assertive (-A)

Bold and Confident

Personality types with the People Mastery Strategy are known for their ability to handle stress. This helps them to act boldly and maintain confidence, even in the face of challenges or criticism.

Thanks to this confidence, people with this Strategy feel energized and at ease in social situations. They seek social contact as well as stimulating and challenging experiences. These personalities like traveling to see things, people, and places, and trying something new – even things they don't end up liking can be exciting for them.

Nothing to Prove?

If they don't keep themselves in check, though, People Masters can become too confident. These personality types tend to be insulated against self-doubt and the need to prove themselves. As a result, they don't always test, or even consider, their own limits or ambitions.

Taken to the extreme, this can create a pattern of comfort-seeking. They may even roll their eyes at people who chase more intimidating goals. At the other end of the spectrum, these personality types can ignore sensible caution, landing themselves in extraordinary and dangerous situations.

At times, People Masters may not be considerate to those who aren't able to maintain such a comfortable boldness. But this doesn't have to be the case, by any means. By taking others into account, these personalities can actually help to draw other people out of their shells in a way that's energizing and empowering.

Finding Balance

Fortunately, most People Masters fall somewhere in the middle. Ideally, they embrace healthy ambition while finding social fulfillment and connection. Social interaction plays a big part in People Masters' happiness. Although these personality types are self-confident, they still appreciate praise and recognition. They don't need

people's approval, but they still crave friends and loved ones with whom to share their lives.

These types may be opinionated, but they don't always worry about having others agree with them. This can help these personalities to be moderate even in disagreements because their ego and confidence aren't at stake the way they often are for Turbulent Strategies. People Masters are not fond of grudges, and at heart, they want to bring people together to make things happen.

These types often stand out for their charisma and self-assurance. As long as they don't use their talents to steamroll or put down others, these personality traits can be quite appealing. These types have little fear of rejection, and they love including others. This can make these personalities wonderful friends, loved ones, and colleagues, who always aim to energize those around them.

People Masters in Love

According to our research, People Masters seem to fall in love a bit more frequently than the other Strategies. They're also less likely to say that falling in love scares them. It's easy to imagine why this is the case – People Masters' Extraversion leads them into situations where they're likely to meet new people, and their Assertive personality trait helps them to feel confident about the prospect of new relationships.

Some might wonder whether this would make People Masters less reliable than other personality types when it comes to being a good partner. Is it possible that these types' self-assurance would make them complacent or uncommitted once they're actually *in* a relationship? Not necessarily: About half of People Masters say it's necessary to go out of their way to please someone they love, and this response

puts them on par with other types. In addition, People Masters are the Strategy least likely to say that long-term commitments make them anxious.

In other words, although People Masters' confidence and social ease might make them sound like players, these types can be as committed and eager to please their partners as anyone else. And being in a relationship with a People Master can be a wonderful thing – even for people who are completely different. After all, People Masters' social energy and their can-do take on life can be infectious in the best possible way.

Speaking Up

People Masters don't tend to filter their opinions. These personality types say what they think, and they think what they say. As with nearly any trait, this can be a strength or a weakness.

People Masters are often seen as straight-shooters who can be trusted to speak honestly. In academic and professional settings, many teachers, classmates, colleagues, and managers appreciate this quality. After all, if used appropriately, candor is a powerful way to connect with other people. The “what you see is what you get” nature of a People Master personality can be refreshing, whether in the classroom or the workplace.

But there's a difference between being candid and being rude – and at times, People Masters may toe that line. In academic settings, this can put them at odds with their teachers and classmates. And in professional settings, these personality types may gain a reputation for being inconsiderate, arrogant, or even ruthless.

Learning to speak honestly *without* speaking over other people is a step on many People Masters' path to personal development. Fortunately, once they master this balance, People Masters can unleash the many gifts they bring to their schooling and their work. In particular, People Masters can excel at dealing with awkward or tense interpersonal situations – whether that's getting a group project back on track or delivering bad news to a customer in a straightforward but considerate way.

Going for It

79% of People Masters say they see problems as opportunities. These personality types trust themselves to tackle hard problems – *and* to gain insight and experience from the process. Ideally, this conviction becomes a self-fulfilling prophecy, with People Masters taking on ever harder challenges and learning important lessons along the way.

What sets People Masters apart isn't just their confidence, however. It's also their willingness to team up with others. These personalities know that we tend to be more effective when we collaborate and ask for help. People Masters can be especially good at creating opportunities for the people around them to use their strengths. And that may just be one of the secrets to People Masters' success.

Constant Improvement – Introverted (I) and Turbulent (-T)

Sensitive Souls

Constant Improvers tend to be sensitive and introspective. They are often deep individuals who enjoy having their own space and freedom. In general, these personality types feel more comfortable on their own than mixed up in the judgment of the real world.

This may be because they share the two personality traits most representative of sensitivity to their environment – Introversion and Turbulence. As a result, they may find it stressful to deal with tense environments or new situations. In these moments, Constant Improvers can be deeply uncomfortable – although they may not want to let on how they really feel. In reaction, these personalities might retreat inward, react defensively, or try to escape the situation altogether. Alternatively, they might give up their own wants or needs in an effort to keep the peace.

Driven by Doubt

Constant Improvers tend to experience self-doubt. They have a strong drive, but it comes paired with a strong fear of failure. These personality types invest a great deal of their identity in their successes. As a result, even a minor misstep or embarrassment can be crushing.

On the upside, this vigilance offers these personality types a knack for sensing trouble. This can be quite useful in situations that need to balance risk and reward – whether a financial investment or a romantic opportunity. When faced with a potential risk, these types look for ways to prevent problems. Although it slows them down in the short term, this approach can prevent longer-term issues.

Constant Improvers direct much of their attention toward their personal interests. They strive to master hobbies, careers, or new means of self-expression. This level of dedication can create impressive, beautiful results.

People with Constant Improvement personality types can be perfectionistic, dedicating tremendous time and energy to their pursuits. Unfortunately, if they put too much pressure on themselves, this approach can backfire. For example, Constant

Improvers may feel forced to abandon an endeavor because a single detail doesn't line up right.

Reality and Romance

At times, Constant Improvers may experience a nagging feeling that something is missing from their lives. It's worth noting that often this really is just a feeling, not a reflection of reality. These personality types have it in their nature always to be seeking something more – even if their lives actually are going just fine.

But as Constant Improvers assess their lives, wondering what might be missing, they may find themselves focusing on their romantic relationships – or lack thereof. These types are significantly less likely than their Assertive counterparts (also known as Confident Individualists) to say that they enjoy being single. And these personalities are more likely than Confident Individualists to say they often construct an ideal partner in their heads when they're single.

Although Constant Improvers may find themselves longing for romance, they don't necessarily find it easy to start up a relationship. They're less likely than other personality Strategies to say that they usually take the initiative in asking someone out. This makes sense, given that Constant Improvers can feel hesitant about putting themselves out there – and asking someone out is an incredibly vulnerable position to be in.

This might sound like bad news, but it doesn't have to be. As they grow and mature, Constant Improvers often learn how to transform their feeling that something is missing into positive energy – and by doing so, they not only discover gratitude for the good things in their lives, but also become proactive about making helpful

changes. This mindset shift can empower these personality types to find fulfillment in their relationships – as well as in every other aspect of their lives.

The “Right” Career?

Constant Improvers’ longing for “something more” extends to their professional lives. Just over a quarter of these types say that their career is a great fit for them – a rate of agreement that is less than the other Strategies.

This doesn’t necessarily mean that Constant Improvers are in the wrong careers for them – although they might wonder if they are. More than half of these personality types say they often think about switching careers, and they’re more likely than the other Strategies to say that they feel stuck in their current job.

This restlessness doesn’t have to be a bad thing. In fact, restlessness can be an incredible motivator to do great things. The trouble comes when Constant Improvers feel trapped: wanting to make a change, but suspecting they’re unable or helpless to do so. This feeling can have a number of roots, such as self-doubt or a general worry that other people don’t “get” them.

As in other areas of their lives, Constant Improvers who pursue personal growth often discover that their feeling of helplessness is exactly that – a *feeling*. This can be a powerful discovery. In its wake, these personality types are better able to harness their personal and professional strengths and deal with their feeling of “stuckness.” This may take the form of finding a new career, or it might involve advocating for themselves in their current workplaces so that they get more of their needs met. Either way, Constant Improvers often find that they have more agency in their professional lives than they’d realized.

The Strength of Sensitivity

In general, Constant Improvers care a great deal about what others think of them. This can trigger insecurity, to be sure, but when kept in balance, it can create some truly wonderful traits. These personalities are often curious about and sensitive to others' feelings. This can make them excellent listeners, friends, confidants, and partners.

Some types might think that sensitivity is synonymous with weakness, but Constant Improvers know that isn't the case. These personality types often exemplify how sensitivity and vulnerability can be hidden strengths. Their attunement to their own struggles and insecurities can help them to bond deeply with others. It can also motivate them to act with kindness and compassion.

Although they may not always realize it, Constant Improvers offer the world a wealth of gifts. Once they learn to trust themselves as much as they trust others' opinions, these personalities can shine.

Social Engagement – Extraverted (E) and Turbulent (-T)

Boldly Sensitive

Those with the Social Engagement Strategy are an interesting group. In some ways, Extraverted and Turbulent personality traits conflict with each other. Extraversion leads to risk-tolerance and boldness, and Turbulence leads to self-doubt and sensitivity.

This can mean that Social Engagers tend to do what comes naturally first and think about it later. In this way, they are almost an exaggeration of their underlying personality traits. This may sound like a bad thing, but it doesn't have to be.

Social Engagers venture into the world with enthusiasm. They enjoy being the center of attention and enjoy social status. At times, this may mean that they hide their true selves to impress other people, pretending to be someone else in order to be liked. Fortunately, Social Engagers' genuine interest in others often shines through, helping these personality types to create authentic connections with the people around them.

Social Engagers in Love

Romantic relationships aren't always the easiest – hence Shakespeare's observation that "the course of true love never did run smooth." You might think that Social Engagers' self-doubt would cause them to play it safe when it comes to the rough waters of love, but that isn't the case. These personality types tend to dive headlong into relationships – they're more likely than any other Strategy to say they fall in love easily. And they're also less likely to say they enjoy being single.

Social Engagers are far from passive about their romantic lives. These personalities care deeply about pleasing their partners – in fact, they're the Strategy most likely to believe they need to go out of their way to please the people they love. Social Engagers are deeply devoted, willing to pour all of their affection and care into their partner.

But not everyone is willing – or able – to do this in return. Social Engagers may feel it acutely if their partner doesn't seem equally affectionate or devoted. This can be especially challenging because these personality types care so deeply about receiving praise and admiration. As a result, they might feel hurt by a partner who is reserved in expressing their affection.

As they go through life, many Social Engagers discover that not everyone is as expressive as they are – and that's okay. These types may need to use their social

acumen to connect with the ways their partners *do* share love. For example, they may realize that their partner expresses affection through physical touch, spending time together, or even helping out around the house. Once they attune themselves to the ways other personalities demonstrate their love, Social Engagers can find incredible fulfillment and joy in their romantic relationships.

Working It

Social Engagers may find themselves drawn to lines of work that involve plenty of human interaction. The service industry can be a natural fit for these personality types, as can nearly any job that involves helping customers solve problems. Social Engagers are energized by the opportunity to talk with others, and they're especially invigorated when they can tell that they've actually made someone's day a little better.

This isn't to say that Social Engagers are anything less than ambitious. In their own way, these personalities do care about being successful. Everyone has a unique definition of "success," of course, but many Social Engagers feel especially successful when they receive recognition, such as awards, promotions, or positive feedback on their work. These types tend to be motivated by a desire to impress and please others – not only because they enjoy praise, but also because they genuinely value the good opinion of their bosses, coworkers, and customers. And of course a salary increase is always nice, too.

Social Engagers' ambition and desire to please can make them wonderful employees and colleagues. At times, however, these personality types often discover a need to pause and make sure they're being true to themselves as well. Their personal development path may lead them to consider their own values and needs – and make sure that their professional lives line up with these values and needs.

That said, these types know that their career is just one aspect of their lives. 74% of Social Engagers say they're always looking for new hobbies to get into – more than any other personality Strategy. Whether those hobbies include volleyball, viticulture, or volunteering, these types care about being well-rounded. Paradoxically, this well-roundedness can help them to find more enjoyment in their careers as well as in other aspects of their lives.

The Highs and the Lows

Social Engagers can experience highs and lows – sometimes within a matter of minutes. Their Extraversion can push their Turbulent need for success into overdrive. Meanwhile, their Turbulent personality trait can trigger almost instant self-doubt. Although these types are capable of taking quick action in a way that seems decisive, they may find themselves plagued by uncertainty afterward.

As they grow, many Social Engagers learn how to use this unusual combination of traits to their advantage. Their Extraversion can help them move past the self-doubt that comes with the Turbulent trait, enabling them to expand their comfort zones even when it isn't easy. Meanwhile, their Turbulent trait can help them to be more considerate in their boldness. The result is that these personality types can hold many contradictory traits in harmony, being both fun and responsible, active and reflective.

This push and pull can be stressful, but it's part of this Strategy's charm. These personality types chase their goals relentlessly, but they also indulge their desires and seek out fun. Thanks to this balance, they can lead happy and fruitful lives – sharing adventures and accomplishments with others whenever possible. Whatever direction these personalities pull, they are sure to pull the crowd with them.

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